# The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show (The Love Doc Podcast): Official Episode Archive

Verified public show notes across 125 published episodes — Hosted by Dr. Sarah Hensley & Co-Host Raina Butcher

### *Where's Dr. Sarah? A Quick Update from Raina*

Published: 10 Nov 2026

Guest podcast appearances, travel, and two TikTok events—it's been a busy week for Dr. Sarah Hensley! Raina checks in to explain this week's podcast break and share a little excitement about what's happening behind the scenes. We'll be back next week with more conversations about attachment science, relationships, and breakups. Until then, revisit a favorite episode or catch up on one you missed. Peace, love, and perspective.

### *Is Your Inner Critic Keeping You Stuck? The Power of Self-Compassion | E17*

Published: 03 Nov 2026

What if being harder on yourself is keeping you stuck? In Episode 17 of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley explores self-compassion, internalized shame, and how your inner critic can shape your relationships, motivation, and emotional well-being. If you struggle with perfectionism, overachievement, or feeling like you're never enough, this conversation offers a different way to approach growth—one that makes room for both kindness and accountability.In this episode, we explore: How shame shows up across anxious, dismissive avoidant, and fearful avoidant attachment styles. Why high achievement doesn't always lead to fulfillment. The difference between self-compassion and making excuses. How defensiveness and blame can get in the way of relationship repair. Why Dr. Hensley is rethinking shadow work. Ways to respond to mistakes with compassion while taking responsibility and setting boundaries.

### *Abandonment Anxiety & Avoidant Shutdowns: Q&A with Dr. Sarah Hensley | E16*

Published: 27 Oct 2026

In this community Q&A episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley answers your questions about abandonment anxiety, emotional shutdown, boundaries, and the relationship patterns that keep repeating. She explores the gap between understanding your attachment style and building the skills to respond differently when emotions run high.Topics include: Navigating the pain of abandonment without chasing connection. Emotional suppression and its impact on intimacy. Setting boundaries when a partner withdraws or avoids repair. Making sense of an ex moving on quickly. Replacing "I'll do better" with specific, actionable changes Questions were submitted by members of the Dr. Sarah Hensley Clients and Community Facebook group—making this episode a conversation driven by the experiences and concerns of the community. Dr. Hensley will continue pulling from your submissions to feature your biggest questions on the podcast—because your growth, your clarity, and your healing matter here.

### *Moving Forward: Healing From Narcissistic Abuse | Part 3 of 3 | E15*

Published: 20 Oct 2026

How do you heal after a narcissistic relationship—and begin to feel ready to date again? In the third and final episode of our three-part series about narcissistic relationship partners, we explore healing from narcissistic abuse and navigating the dating landscape after getting out. Host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher discuss rebuilding self-trust, reclaiming your sense of worth, and approaching new relationships with clearer boundaries. From recognizing red flags to discovering what a healthy connection can look like, this conversation is about moving forward at your own pace without losing yourself along the way. Catch up on parts 1 and 2 for the full series.

### *When You Start Hiding the Truth: Signs of Narcissistic Abuse | Part 2 of 3 | E14*

Published: 13 Oct 2026

Have you stopped telling friends what happens in your relationship because you're embarrassed—or afraid of what they'll say? In part two of our three-part series on narcissistic relationship partners, Dr. Sarah Hensley explores the signs of narcissistic abuse and how these patterns can overlap with insecure attachment. From emotional punishment and control to the contrast between public charm and private behavior, this episode takes a closer look at relationship dynamics that can be difficult to recognize when you're living through them. Available Tuesday at 5:30am ET . Catch up on part one, then join us as the conversation continues.

### *What IS a Narcissist? Key Traits & Relationship Patterns | Part 1 | E13*

Published: 06 Oct 2026

What is a narcissist—and how does narcissism differ from insecure attachment? In the first episode of a three-part series on narcissism, Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher explore narcissistic traits, the differences between grandiose and vulnerable narcissism, and the patterns that can emerge in relationships. From entitlement and the need for admiration to manipulation, gaslighting, and control, Sarah explains the psychology behind these behaviors. Together, the hosts discuss the narcissistic abuse cycle—idealization, devaluation, discard, and hoovering—and how intermittent reinforcement can keep people caught in a trauma bond. Combining psychological research with personal experiences, this conversation lays the foundation for understanding narcissism, recognizing harmful relationship patterns, and making sense of experiences that leave you questioning yourself.

### *Fearful Avoidant + Fearful Avoidant: Why They Connect Deeply and Fight Hard | E12*

Published: 29 Sep 2026

Can two fearful avoidants make a relationship work? When both partners have fearful avoidant attachment, the connection can feel unusually deep—until conflict triggers an intense fight, a sudden shutdown, or a reversal of who is chasing whom. In newest episode, Dr. Sarah and Raina explain the fearful avoidant–fearful avoidant (FA–FA) relationship cycle. They discuss why these partners often feel so understood at first, how fear of betrayal can turn a disagreement into a painful fight, and how this pattern differs from a fearful avoidant–dismissive avoidant relationship. You'll also hear why understanding your partner's perspective does not mean agreeing with it, and how recognizing the cycle can help couples repair conflict and build a more secure connection.

### *Fearful Avoidant + Dismissive Avoidant: The Most Painful Relationship Dynamic | E11*

Published: 22 Sep 2026

Why are fearful-avoidant and dismissive-avoidant partners so magnetically attracted to each other—only to become trapped in criticism, withdrawal, resentment, and disconnection? In this episode, Dr. Sarah Hensley breaks down the fearful-avoidant/dismissive-avoidant relationship dynamic and explains how couples can interrupt the painful push-pull cycle before it destroys their relationship. You'll learn: -Why fearful and dismissive avoidants are intensely attracted to each other -How the honeymoon phase turns into a pursue-withdraw conflict cycle -Why dismissive avoidants shut down—and why that activates fearful avoidants -How criticism, emotional flooding, defensiveness, and unresolved conflict create resentment -The dating red flags associated with both attachment styles -Why conventional couples therapy can sometimes make this dynamic worse -How neutral communication, emotional processing, mentalization, boundaries, and structured conflict repair can help -Whether one partner can become the secure anchor and change the relationship Dr. Hensley also shares a real-life conflict-repair example and explains why lasting regulation requires processing your emotions—not simply forcing yourself to calm down. Whether you identify as fearful avoidant, dismissive avoidant, emotionally unavailable, or simply feel stuck in a push-pull relationship, this episode offers practical insight into understanding your attachment patterns, resolving conflict, and building a more secure connection.

### *Attachment Styles & Relationships: Q&A with Dr. Sarah Hensley | E10*

Published: 15 Sep 2026

Dr. Sarah Hensley answers your questions about attachment styles and relationships in this audience-led Q&A. Join Sarah and Raina as they explore real-life relationship concerns through the lens of attachment science, offering perspectives on understanding yourself and your connections with others. Questions were submitted by members of the Dr. Sarah Hensley Clients and Community Facebook group—making this episode a conversation driven by the experiences and concerns of the community. Dr. Hensley will continue pulling from your submissions to feature your biggest questions on the podcast—because your growth, your clarity, and your healing matter here.

### *Beyond Attachment Quizzes: A First Look at Our New Relationship Tool | E9*

Published: 08 Sep 2026

Something new is in the works at Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services—and in this episode, Dr. Sarah Hensley and Raina are giving you the first sneak peek. For months, the team has been developing a new project designed to take Dr. Hensley's relationship coaching and attachment science to an entirely new level. We can't reveal everything just yet, but here's what we can share. Imagine having Dr. Hensley's coaching framework and relationship tools in one place—along with the ability to assess your attachment patterns using scientifically grounded data, track your own progress over time, and even begin measuring changes within your relationship and partner dynamic. Instead of another online attachment style "quiz" that gives you a label and sends you on your way, this project is being built around real relationship science, measurable progress, and actual behavior change. In this episode, Dr. Hensley and Raina pull back the curtain on: • The new project currently being developed behind the scenes • Why Dr. Hensley wanted to create something beyond traditional attachment quizzes • How attachment and relationship progress could actually be measured over time • The possibility of tracking progress for both you and your partner • How Dr. Hensley's coaching program and tools will fit into the experience • The bigger vision for where relationship coaching—and relationship science—could go next There's still a lot we can't share yet. But this is your first look at what's coming next. Subscribe to The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show to follow the project as it develops and be among the first to hear what's coming.

### *The Science of Attachment: How It Predicts Who You Love & How You Love | E8*

Published: 01 Sep 2026

Why are you attracted to certain people? Why do some relationships make you feel secure while others trigger anxiety, distance, or fear? And why do the same relationship patterns seem to repeat—even when the person changes? The answer may be found in your attachment system. In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley breaks down the science of attachment in a way that's easy to understand—and explains just how much your attachment style can predict about your intimate relationships. Dr. Hensley explores how attachment influences who you choose as a partner, what you're attracted to, how you experience emotional intimacy, how you respond to conflict and disconnection, and the behaviors that emerge when your attachment system is activated. You'll learn attachment styles—secure, anxious preoccupied, dismissive avoidant, and fearful avoidant—can experience the exact same relationship very differently, and why understanding your attachment style goes far beyond simply giving yourself a label. Attachment isn't just about how you behave in relationships. It's an operating system influencing how you interpret, experience, and respond to love. If you've ever wondered "Why do I keep choosing the same type of person?" "Why do I react this way in relationships?" or "Why does my partner respond so differently than I do?"—this episode will help you begin connecting the dots. The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show explores the science behind love, attachment, attraction, relationships, and human behavior.

### *Inside the Lindsay Clancy Case: A Forensic Psychologist Weighs In | Dr. Leslie Dobson | E7*

Published: 25 Aug 2026

In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and Raina Butcher are joined by Dr. Leslie Dobson, a forensic clinical psychologist, speaker, and author, for an in-depth discussion of the Lindsay Clancy case—a case that has raised difficult questions about mental health, postpartum psychiatric disorders, criminal responsibility, memory, and intent. Bringing both a psychological and forensic perspective to the conversation, Dr. Dobson helps Dr. Sarah and Raina examine the known details surrounding the case and explore some of its most complicated questions. What role could severe postpartum mental illness have played? What happens to memory during a psychotic episode? How do forensic psychologists evaluate a person's mental state at the time of an alleged crime? And how do clinicians distinguish between psychological explanations and legal responsibility? Together, they discuss postpartum psychosis, dissociation, memory impairment, competency, criminal responsibility, and the psychological factors forensic experts consider when evaluating cases like this one. They also examine aspects of the Lindsay Clancy case that remain difficult to reconcile and why understanding someone's psychological state can be far more complicated than labeling their actions as simply rational or irrational. This conversation is not about reaching a verdict. It's about looking beyond headlines and social media commentary to better understand the psychology, forensic considerations, and unanswered questions surrounding an extraordinarily complex and tragic case.In this episode: The psychology behind the Lindsay Clancy case Postpartum depression vs. postpartum psychosis How psychosis can affect perception, behavior, and memory What a forensic psychological evaluation actually examines Mental illness, intent, and criminal responsibility Why memory loss can occur during severe psychiatric episodes The details of the case that raise difficult psychological questions How experts evaluate whether behavior is consistent with a claimed mental state The limitations of analyzing a case without personally evaluating the defendant Content Warning: This episode discusses child deaths, alleged homicide, suicide attempt, and severe postpartum mental health issues. * We apologize for technical difficulties resulting in lower quality audio in this episode. We'll have the bugs worked out for next time!

### *Breaking Down the Lindsay Clancy Case: The Psychology Behind the Tragedy | E6*

Published: 18 Aug 2026

Dr. Sarah Hensley takes a psychological look at the Lindsay Clancy case, examining the complex questions surrounding postpartum mental health, psychotic episodes, memory, and criminal responsibility. What happens to the brain during a psychotic episode? Can someone experience psychosis and later have little or no memory of what occurred? And how might severe postpartum psychiatric symptoms affect a person's perception of reality, decision-making, and behavior? Drawing on her background in psychology, Dr. Hensley breaks down the psychological concepts relevant to the case while also examining details that raise difficult questions. She discusses postpartum psychosis, memory disruption during psychotic episodes, altered states of reality, and the distinction between understanding a psychological explanation and excusing a horrific act. Dr. Hensley also explores aspects of the Lindsay Clancy case that, from a psychological perspective, don't seem to fit neatly together—and why those inconsistencies matter when trying to understand what may have happened.In this episode, we discuss: The psychology of psychotic episodes Whether psychosis can affect or disrupt memory Postpartum psychosis and other serious postpartum mental health concerns How someone's perception of reality can change during severe psychiatric episodes The psychological questions surrounding the Lindsay Clancy case Details of the case that are difficult to reconcile The difference between psychological explanation, legal responsibility, and accountability This is a nuanced discussion of an incredibly tragic case involving the deaths of three children. Our goal is not to diagnose Lindsay Clancy or determine guilt or innocence, but to explore the psychology relevant to the case and the questions it raises. Content Warning: This episode discusses child deaths, alleged homicide, suicide attempt, and severe postpartum mental health issues.

### *Growing Up With an Attachment Expert: Grief, Love & Life as Gen Z | Gabby Hensley | E5*

Published: 11 Aug 2026

What is it really like to grow up as the daughter of an attachment expert? In this deeply personal episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley is joined by her daughter, Gabby Hensley, for an honest conversation about childhood, grief, relationships, and what it means to find security as a Gen Z young adult. Gabby opens up about losing her biological father, how she has learned to cope with grief as she's gotten older, and the ways that loss has shaped her perspective on life and relationships. She also shares what it was like growing up with Dr. Hensley as her mom—and how years of conversations about attachment theory, emotional regulation, boundaries, and relationship patterns have influenced the way she approaches love today. Together, they explore what secure attachment actually looks like in real life, the relationship struggles facing Gen Z, and what parents may not realize about the way their children experience love, loss, and connection. It's a vulnerable mother-daughter conversation about grief, growing up, breaking relationship patterns, and learning what healthy love really feels like.

### *Why People Cheat: The Psychology of Infidelity, Guilt & Healing After Betrayal | E4*

Published: 04 Aug 2026

Infidelity is one of the most devastating forms of betrayal—but why do people cheat? Is it always about love? Do people who are unfaithful actually feel guilt and remorse? If they do, how long does that guilt last? And perhaps the biggest question of all: Can a relationship truly heal after betrayal? In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley explores the psychology of infidelity through the lenses of attachment theory, neuroscience, trauma, and relationship psychology. Rather than offering simplistic answers, she examines the emotional, psychological, and relational factors that contribute to cheating, what genuine remorse looks like, and what it actually takes for couples to rebuild trust after betrayal. Whether you've been cheated on, struggled with infidelity in your own relationship, or simply want to understand why it happens, this episode offers evidence-based insight, compassion, and practical guidance. In this episode: Why people cheat—even in seemingly happy relationships Is infidelity always about sex, or is there something deeper? Do people who cheat truly experience guilt, shame, and remorse? How long does guilt typically last, and what influences it? The neuroscience and psychology behind betrayal How infidelity impacts the nervous system and creates betrayal trauma Can trust be rebuilt after cheating? What healthy reconciliation actually requires from both partners When healing together is possible—and when it may not be Healing after betrayal isn't about pretending it never happened. It's about understanding what happened, deciding what comes next, and learning whether trust can be rebuilt on a stronger foundation. If this conversation helps you better understand betrayal, relationships, and emotional healing, subscribe for more episodes on attachment styles, trauma recovery, mental health, and healthy relationships.

### *Anxious Preoccupied Attachment: Why Chasing Love Pushes People Away | E3*

Published: 28 Jul 2026

Why does the more someone with anxious preoccupied attachment longs for love, reassurance, and connection, the more likely they are to experience the very abandonment they fear? In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley explores one of the most heartbreaking paradoxes in attachment psychology: the anxious preoccupied attachment style. Learn how the intense fear of rejection can drive behaviors like overthinking, people-pleasing, excessive reassurance-seeking, and emotional hypervigilance—behaviors that often overwhelm relationships and unintentionally push others away. Rather than confirming that they are "too much," these relationship patterns are often rooted in early attachment wounds, inconsistent caregiving, and a nervous system that has learned to equate uncertainty with danger. In this episode, you'll learn: What anxious preoccupied attachment really is Why fear of abandonment becomes a self-reinforcing cycle How reassurance-seeking and emotional pursuit affect relationships Why partners may withdraw in response to anxious behaviors The neuroscience behind attachment anxiety Practical steps toward developing a more secure attachment style Whether you identify with anxious attachment or you're trying to understand a loved one, this episode offers compassionate, science-backed insights into breaking free from the cycle of insecurity and building healthier, more secure relationships. If you found this episode helpful, subscribe to The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show for weekly conversations on attachment theory, trauma recovery, emotional health, and relationship psychology.

### *The Truth About Fearful Avoidants: Why They Send Mixed Signals in Relationships | E2*

Published: 21 Jul 2026

What if the person giving you the most confusing mixed signals isn't playing games—but is operating from a deeply ingrained survival strategy? In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley explores the psychology behind fearful avoidant attachment, one of the most complex and misunderstood attachment styles. Learn why fearful avoidants can crave deep intimacy one moment and withdraw the next, why their behavior often seems unpredictable, and how childhood trauma, betrayal, and attachment wounds shape their relationships. You'll discover: Why fearful avoidants send mixed signals The psychology behind approach-avoidance behavior How trauma influences adult relationships The difference between fearful avoidant and dismissive avoidant attachment Why love and fear become intertwined How healing attachment wounds can create healthier, more secure relationships Whether you're trying to understand your own attachment style or make sense of someone else's behavior, this episode offers research-backed insights into one of the most misunderstood relationship dynamics. If this episode helped you better understand attachment and relationships, like, subscribe, and share to support more evidence-based conversations on psychology and emotional health.

### *What If We've Been WRONG About Emotionally Unavailable People? | Dismissive Avoidant Explained | E1*

Published: 14 Jul 2026

Season 3 is officially here! We've missed you all, but we're back and better than ever! Welcome to the premiere episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show . What if we've been wrong about emotionally unavailable people all along? For years, emotionally unavailable partners have been labeled as cold, uncaring, or incapable of love. But what if the psychology tells a very different story? In this Season 3 premiere, Dr. Sarah Hensley explores the science of attachment theory, the psychology behind emotional unavailability, and why the dismissive avoidant attachment style is so often misunderstood. You'll discover how childhood experiences, nervous system adaptation, and subconscious protective strategies can create emotional distance—not because someone doesn't care, but because connection has become associated with vulnerability. Whether you've struggled in a relationship with a dismissive avoidant partner, identify with avoidant attachment yourself, or simply want to better understand relationship psychology, this episode offers practical insight grounded in psychology rather than stereotypes. If you're ready to understand relationships on a deeper level, you're in the right place. Welcome to an all-new season of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show—where psychology meets practical strategies to help you build healthier relationships, improve emotional regulation, and create lasting secure attachment. Like, subscribe, and share this episode with someone who's trying to understand emotionally unavailable relationships.

### *STAY TUNED.....*

Published: 16 Jun 2026

We’ve officially wrapped Season 2 and are taking a short pause as we put the finishing touches on our brand-new studio. This is a moment of reset, refinement, and preparation for what’s coming next. Thank you for being part of the journey so far—stay tuned, because Season 3 is going to bring bigger conversations, new guests, deeper insights, and a whole new level of what this show is becoming. Big things are on the way.

### *SEASON 2 FINALE: Q&A From the Dr. Sarah Hensley Clients and Community Facebook Group*

Published: 09 Jun 2026

Season 2 comes to a close with a special Q&A episode featuring questions submitted by members of the Dr. Sarah Hensley Clients and Community Facebook Group. Throughout this season, we've explored relationships, attachment styles, trauma, healing, communication, and personal growth—and for our finale, we're once again turning the conversation over to you. In this Season 2 finale, Dr. Hensley answers some of the most thoughtful and frequently asked questions from our community, offering practical insights, psychological perspectives, and real-world guidance on navigating the challenges of love, dating, relationships, and emotional healing. Whether you're working through attachment wounds, trying to build healthier connections, or simply seeking a deeper understanding of yourself and others, this episode delivers valuable takeaways straight from the conversations happening within our community every day. Thank you for being part of Season 2. Your questions, stories, and support continue to make this podcast a place for learning, healing, and growth. We can't wait to continue the journey with you in Season 3! Dr. Hensley will continue pulling from your submissions to feature your biggest questions on the podcast—because your growth, your clarity, and your healing matter here.

### *Episode 52, Season 2: Why We Get Attached to People We've Never Met: Parasocial Relationships*

Published: 02 Jun 2026

Parasocial relationships are everywhere in the age of social media. From influencers and creators to celebrities and online personalities, we have more access than ever to the lives of people we've never actually met. While these one-sided connections can provide entertainment, inspiration, and even a sense of belonging, they can also become unhealthy when they begin to replace real-world relationships, emotional intimacy, and authentic connection. In this new episode, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher explore the psychology behind parasocial relationships, attachment styles, and the emotional needs that make these bonds feel so powerful. They discuss how loneliness, trauma, unmet attachment needs, and the human desire for connection can increase vulnerability to unhealthy emotional investment in online figures. As social media algorithms become increasingly effective at capturing our attention, understanding the difference between healthy engagement and emotional dependency has never been more important. Join us as we examine the mental health implications of parasocial relationships, the impact of social media on attachment and connection, and how to cultivate healthier, more fulfilling relationships in an increasingly digital world.

### *Episode 51, Season 2: How Trauma Lives in the Mind & Body — And Shapes Your Relationships*

Published: 26 May 2026

Trauma doesn’t just live in the mind — it lives in the body, nervous system, and the relationship patterns we carry into everyday life. In the newest episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher explore how unresolved trauma, childhood wounds, emotional neglect, abandonment, chronic stress, and painful relationship experiences become stored in both the brain and body, shaping the way we think, feel, communicate, and connect with others. They discuss how trauma responses like anxiety, emotional shutdown, hypervigilance, people-pleasing, fear of abandonment, and avoidant behaviors can silently impact emotional intimacy, trust, conflict, and attachment in relationships. This conversation breaks down the connection between trauma, attachment styles, emotional regulation, nervous system dysregulation, and subconscious behavioral patterns, while also exploring what healing truly looks like. Dr. Hensley and Raina discuss trauma processing, triggers, fight/flight/freeze/fawn responses, self-awareness, and how building emotional safety and secure attachment can help break unhealthy relationship cycles. If you’ve ever wondered why certain relationship patterns keep repeating or why emotional connection can feel difficult, this episode offers insight into how trauma manifests in both the mind and body — and how healing can transform your relationships and your life.

### *Episode 50, Season 2: Q&A From Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services Clients and Community Facebook Group*

Published: 19 May 2026

My ex wants to come back, but can trust really be rebuilt? I believe I'm setting boundaries, but is it really just avoidance? My workaholic, rarely present husband says he's done with our marriage. How will I navigate 50/50 custody of our young children? On the newest episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher answer questions straight from Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services Clients and Community Facebook Group. Dr. Hensley will continue pulling from your submissions to feature your biggest questions on the podcast—because your growth, your clarity, and your healing matter here.

### *Episode 49, Season 2: The Habits of Secure Couples: Psychology-Backed Traits of Healthy & Lasting Relationships*

Published: 12 May 2026

What makes secure couples different from everyone else? In this week's episode, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher break down the most common traits found in healthy, emotionally secure relationships through the lens of psychology, attachment theory, communication, and emotional intelligence. From shared routines to giving your partner the benefit of the doubt, Dr. Hensley and Raina explore the behaviors that create long-term relationship security and emotional safety. Whether you struggle with anxious attachment, avoidant attachment, relationship anxiety, or simply want to build a healthier connection, this episode will help you recognize what secure love actually looks like in real life. Learn the green flags of emotionally healthy partners, how secure couples communicate during conflict, and the daily habits that strengthen intimacy, trust, and lasting connection.

### *Episode 48, Season 2: Don't Let Attachment Style Confirmation Bias Sabotage Your Relationships*

Published: 05 May 2026

Why do you keep finding “proof” that your partner is pulling away or can’t be trusted? In this episode, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher explore how Confirmation Bias shapes your relationship reality through the lens of Psychology and attachment theory. Your attachment style—anxious, avoidant, or secure—acts as a filter, influencing what you notice, how you interpret behavior, and the meaning you assign to it. We break down how these patterns reinforce themselves: anxious attachment scans for rejection, avoidant attachment looks for reasons to disconnect, and both can create self-fulfilling cycles. You’ll learn how to recognize these cognitive blind spots, challenge automatic assumptions, and shift toward healthier, more secure relationship dynamics.

### *Episode 47, Season 2: Why Smart People Stay in Toxic Relationships (And Can’t Walk Away)*

Published: 21 Apr 2026

Why do intelligent, self-aware people stay in relationships that hurt them? In this episode, we break down the psychology behind this paradox, exploring how attachment theory, trauma bonding, and subconscious emotional patterns keep people stuck in unhealthy dynamics. Host Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher unpack how early attachment styles shape the way we give and receive love, often overriding logic and self-worth. You’ll learn why chemistry can feel stronger in toxic relationships, how intermittent reinforcement creates addictive emotional cycles, and what it really takes to break free. This conversation is a must-listen for anyone trying to understand their relationship patterns, heal from past wounds, and build healthier, more secure connections moving forward.

### *Episode 46, Season 2: Entrepreneurship Isn’t Easy - Navigating Growth, Stress & Change*

Published: 14 Apr 2026

New week, new set of challenges. When you own and run your own business, the hurdles are ever-present. In this episdode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher open up on the real, unfiltered journey of building a business—and what happens when growth demands change. From the emotional highs of rapid success to the uncertainty and pressure that come with evolving a brand, they explore the often unseen challenges of entrepreneurship. The conversation dives into Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services’s pivotal decision to move toward a rebrand, unpacking the fears, identity shifts, and tough choices that come with redefining a mission while staying true to its core purpose. Blending personal insight with psychological perspective, this episode offers an honest look at resilience, reinvention, and what it truly takes to grow—both as a business and as individuals behind it. Don't worry, only the name is changing!

### *Episode 45, Season 2: Break Free From Toxic Patterns – Krista Williams on Healing & Authenticity*

Published: 07 Apr 2026

In this week's episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher sit down with Krista Williams - coach, podcaster, and author - for a deeply honest conversation on relationships, personal growth, and what it truly means to live as your authentic self. Blending psychology and attachment theory, they explore how emotional wounds, past relationships, and internal narratives shape the way we show up in love, life, and success. Krista shares her journey of moving on from failed relationships, navigating major life transitions, and redefining success beyond external validation. Together, they unpack how to break free from unhealthy patterns, heal attachment wounds, and create a sense of inner peace rooted in self-awareness and authenticity. This episode offers both insight and practical perspective for anyone seeking to grow emotionally, build healthier relationships, and step more fully into who they truly are. Check out more from Krista Williams: @almost30podcast Website: https://itskrista.com Links on the website to purchase her book, Almost 30

### *Episode 44, Season 2: The Psychology of Being a Lion with Sean Whalen*

Published: 31 Mar 2026

Strap in for the newest episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, where host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher are joined by Sean Whalen, founder and CEO of Lions Not Sheep, to explore what it truly means to know yourself—and why radical accountability is the foundation for growth. Blending insights from psychology and attachment theory, Dr. Hensley and Sean challenge listeners to confront the patterns, beliefs, and emotional defenses that shape their relationships, while also examining the role of motivation in driving real, lasting change. Dr. Hensley and Sean explore how unresolved attachment styles influence behavior, the role of ownership in breaking toxic cycles, and how true motivation is built through discipline, self-awareness, and accountability—not just fleeting inspiration. They also highlight why self-awareness is essential for both mental and physical health. This episode is a direct call to stop avoiding, start owning, and step into a more grounded, secure, and motivated version of yourself. There's a lion in all of us. Be sure to check out Sean and Lions Not Sheep at the following links: SEAN WHALEN Lions Not Sheep - Home– Lions Not Sheep ® @lionsnotsheep Facebook: @swhalen

### *Episode 43, Season 2: Growing Pains of a Purpose-Driven Brand: Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services’s Next Chapter*

Published: 24 Mar 2026

This week on The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, join host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher as they pull back the curtain on the rapid growth of Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services brand and the growing pains that come with scaling a mission-driven business. From increasing reach and adding team members to expanding facilities, this conversation explores what it really takes to grow without losing your foundation. As Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services continues to evolve, Dr. Hensley and Raina share the excitement (and exhaustion) of growth while reflecting on the importance of staying grounded in the core mission—helping people heal, build secure relationships, and create lasting change.

### *Episode 42, Season 2: Beyond the Alpha Mindset: The Psychology of Self-Awareness and Success with Dave Rossi*

Published: 17 Mar 2026

In the latest episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher are joined by entrepreneur and strategist Dave Rossi to explore the psychology of success through the lens of self-awareness, attachment, and emotional intelligence. Challenging the typical “alpha male” narrative and the traditional concept of masculinity built on dominance and competition, Dave shares a philosophy rooted in inner work, accountability, and psychological growth. The discussion includes how attachment theory, relationship patterns, and self-awareness influence leadership, entrepreneurship, and personal fulfillment, and why sustainable success is less about outperforming others and more about understanding yourself. This conversation dives into psychology, personal development, authentic leadership, and high-performance mindset, offering a powerful reframing of what it truly means to succeed in both relationships and business. About Dave Rossi Dave Rossi is a Silicon Valley entrepreneur, coach, and author known for blending personal transformation with leadership and mindful living. Early in his career, he built and led successful companies, generating multimillion-dollar revenues, yet he found external success hollow without inner fulfillment. The death of close personal friend in 2012 resulted in a downward spiral that led to divorce, loss of business and home, and health deterioration - and prompted a deep life shift that now informs his work as a teacher and author. He is also the CEO of CIQU Construction and speaks on topics like conscious leadership, emotional mastery, and what he calls “The Omega Man” — a model of success rooted in self-awareness rather than aggressive achievement. Dave is the author of The Imperative Habit and Alphas Die Early, available on his website. You can find out more about Dave at the following links: Website: Dave Rossi Global | Book Author - Life coaching

### *Episode 41, Season 2: Q&A From Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services Client and Community Facebook Group*

Published: 10 Mar 2026

In this special Q&A episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher answer real questions straight from Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services Clients and Community Facebook group. Dr. Hensley and Raina tackle issues ranging from understanding why dismissive avoidants (DA) may struggle with honesty, establishing healthy boundaries without escalating conflict, to gaslighting, the differences between verbal abuse and emotional abuse, and practical strategies for communicating attachment styles in a way that avoidant partners can actually hear. This episode explores the nuanced psychology behind avoidant behavior and relational patterns. Grounded in psychology but focused on real-world application, this episode offers insight, validation, and actionable guidance for anyone trying to build secure relationships, improve communication, and navigate attachment dynamics with clarity and self-respect.

### *Episode 40, Season 2: Choosing Safe Support in a Saturated Coaching Market*

Published: 03 Mar 2026

The world of relationship coaching, particularly attachment theory, is becoming an increasingly saturated market - and that's not necessarily a bad thing. But if you're searching for help, it means you should do your homework. In this week’s episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher explore how to choose safe, ethical, and effective support in today’s saturated coaching market. With attachment styles and relational trauma becoming mainstream topics, it’s critical to understand who you’re trusting with your emotional well-being. Not all guidance is created equal, and discernment matters. Dr. Hensley and Raina break down the importance of vetting a coach’s education, training, credentials, and real-world experience before investing your time, money, and vulnerability. Learn what questions to ask, how to identify evidence-based relationship support, and how to protect your growth while navigating the expanding landscape of attachment theory coaching. This episode is not an indictment of other coaches or professionals in the field—it’s an empowering conversation about informed choice, ethical practice, and finding qualified support for lasting relationship transformation.

### *Episode 39, Season 2: Holistic Healing for Menopause & Perimenopause with Dr. Nicole Rothman*

Published: 24 Feb 2026

"The Change." For years, that's how a certain age in a woman's life was known. But we know it's FAR more than that. In this powerful new episode, Dr. Nicole Rothman joins The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show to unpack the truth about holistic healing and its transformative role in women's health. From perimenopause to menopause, Dr. Hensley, Dr. Rothman, and Raina explore how hormonal balance, stress regulation, gut health, sleep optimization, and mind-body medicine can dramatically improve symptoms like anxiety, weight gain, brain fog, fatigue, and mood swings. Dr. Rothman breaks down integrative and functional medicine approaches to menopause relief, empowering women to take control of their hormones naturally and confidently. If you're navigating perimenopause symptoms, looking for holistic menopause support, or seeking evidence-based strategies for optimal women's wellness, this episode delivers practical tools, cutting-edge insight, and real solutions for thriving—not just surviving—midlife. Check out more from Dr. Rothman at the following links: Website: https://drnicole.com/ Book: https://amzn.to/3OcWofU Facebook: @rothmanhealthsolutions and @drnicolerothman1

### *Episode 38, Season 2: Jeffrey Epstein and the Cult of Power: The Psychology of Elite Corruption*

Published: 17 Feb 2026

It's an uncomfortable and disturbing topic, but one that cannot be ignored. What makes evil people tick? And why do others turn a blind eye to evil, let alone participate? On this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher examine the psychological forces behind power, influence, corruption, and moral collapse through the lens of Jeffrey Epstein — exploring the psychology of cults, extreme wealth, elite networks, and the belief that one is above the law. How does vast wealth and access to the elite distort identity, fuel narcissism, and erode accountability? Dr. Hensley and Raina break down the psychological mechanisms that allow individuals in positions of power to rationalize exploitation, manipulate social systems, and cultivate environments of secrecy and control. From cult dynamics and coercive influence to grandiosity, moral disengagement, and group complicity, this episode dives into the psychology of evil and the dangerous mindset that can emerge when money, status, and unchecked power converge. If you're interested in criminal psychology, elite power structures, narcissistic traits, and the social psychology of corruption, this conversation offers a compelling, research-informed perspective on how people descend into darkness — and why others enable it.

### *Episode 37, Season 2: The Celebrity Psyche: Identity, Attachment & the Cost of Being Seen*

Published: 10 Feb 2026

What really happens to the human psyche when fame, money, and constant validation collide? In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher break down the celebrity psyche—exploring the psychology of fame, identity, relationships, narcissism, attachment styles, and the mental health challenges that come with life in the spotlight. From imposter syndrome and addiction to power dynamics, validation addiction, and public vs. private identity, they examine why celebrity relationships often implode and how fame reshapes the brain, behavior, and sense of self. Blending clinical psychology, real-world examples, and cultural analysis, this conversation pulls back the curtain on celebrity mental health, trauma, ego, and the emotional cost of being adored by millions—and what everyday people can learn from it.

### *Episode 36, Season 2: The Psychology of Success: Mindset, Motivation, and Overcoming Fear of Failure*

Published: 03 Feb 2026

In this week's episode, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher break down the psychology of success and the mindset patterns that consistently show up in high achievers. They explore the emotional and psychological traits of successful people, including resilience, self-discipline, emotional regulation, and long-term thinking. A major focus is the power of action vs. inaction—why taking imperfect action beats overthinking, procrastination, and fear every time. Dr. Hensley and Raina also discuss the importance of surrounding yourself with like-minded, motivated people, how your environment shapes behavior, and why proximity to driven individuals accelerates growth. The conversation dives into failure as a learning tool, teaching listeners how to navigate setbacks, extract lessons, and build confidence through adversity. Finally, they tackle the fear of failure, how it sabotages success, and practical strategies to overcome it. This episode reframes success as a psychological process—one built through mindset, habits, accountability, and consistent action rather than talent alone.

### *Episode 35, Season 2: Balancing Career and Family for Working Moms w/ guest Rebecca Olson*

Published: 27 Jan 2026

In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher are joined by Rebecca Olson, a certified life coach specializing in working moms, mental health, and work–life balance. Together, they explore the psychological and emotional challenges that arise when women transition into motherhood while maintaining ambitious careers. Through a psychology-based and relationship-focused lens, the conversation covers time management, identity shifts, attachment dynamics, boundaries, burnout, and redefining success during different seasons of life. Rebecca shares practical tools for protecting mental health, strengthening relationships, and reducing guilt and overwhelm—especially for high-achieving women navigating motherhood, partnership, and personal growth. This episode is ideal for working moms, professionals, parents, and anyone interested in mental health, relationships, and personal development. Be sure to check out Rebecca's services as well as Dr. Hensley's in the links below. Bio Rebecca is an international life coach and podcast host who helps career-focused parents stop feeling overwhelmed and "not enough" so they can be present with their kids while crushing their career goals. Through her coaching programs and podcast, Ambitious and Balanced Working Moms, Rebecca has helped thousands of parents learn to feel confident in who they are, what they want and the value they bring to their company and family. She teaches an inside- out approach to creating work-life balance that gives individuals 100% control over their time, energy and success. Rebecca is known for straight-talking and big earrings. She lives in the San Francisco Bay Area with her husband and two kiddos. When not coaching or speaking, she loves playing ultimate frisbee and drinks lots of tea. LinkedIn : https://www.linkedin.com/in/rebolson/ Instagram : https://www.instagram.com/rebeccaolsoncoach Website : https://www.rebeccaolsoncoaching.com/ Podcast : https://www.rebeccaolsoncoaching.com/podcast Facebook : https://www.facebook.com/rebeccaolsoncoaching Freebie The Working Mom’s Daily Kickstart: A simple morning practice to stay ahead of stress and overwhelm – so you feel in control of your time, your mindset, and your priorities. https://www.ambitiousandbalanced.com/daily-kickstart

### *Episode 34, Season 2: Quit Complaining! Why We Do It, and Why It's Dangerous*

Published: 20 Jan 2026

In this week's episode, host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher discuss the dangers and uselessness of something we're all guilty of - complaining. Drawing from the teachings and knowledge of one of her most influential mentors, Dr. Suzanne Segerstrom, Dr. Sarah delves into the reasons we complain, the ways the brain can be positively or negatively re-wired through repetitive thought, and the detrimental psychological and even physiological manifestations of complaining, worrying, and negative thought.

### *Episode 33, Season 2: Tapping Into Your Secure Energy in 2026*

Published: 13 Jan 2026

Join us this week as host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher explore what it truly means to cultivate secure energy as we move into 2026. Secure energy is built through clear boundaries, self-trust, and authentic self-expression. Dr. Hensley discusses how securely attached individuals establish and maintain boundaries without guilt, show up authentically and unapologetically themselves, and lead with respect and compassion while also maintaining their own integrity. The episode also addresses the often-misunderstood topic of looking good—not as a sign of vanity, but as a way of showing self-respect and discipline. Secure energy comes from acting in ways that reflect your values, even when it risks disappointment or disconnection. By understanding what secure behavior patterns look like, listeners can learn how to stop performing for acceptance and start showing up as their real selves—grounded, regulated, and relationally sound. This episode offers a practical roadmap for embodying secure energy in daily life, relationships, and self-image as we step into 2026 with clarity and confidence.

### *Episode 32, Season 2: The Dismissive Avoidant Woman*

Published: 06 Jan 2026

Episode 32 of the Love Doc Podcast focuses specifically on the dismissive avoidant woman. Dr. Hensley begins by clarifying that attachment style itself is not gender specific—men and women develop dismissive avoidance for the same core reasons rooted in early emotional neglect, premature independence, or caregivers who discouraged emotional expression. However, while the wound is the same, the expression can look different in women due to socialization and relational roles. Research consistently shows dismissive avoidants learned early that vulnerability was unsafe or unnecessary, leading them to rely heavily on self-sufficiency and emotional distance in adulthood, particularly inside romantic relationships. What makes the dismissive avoidant woman distinct is how that avoidance often shows up through caretaking and distraction rather than work or hobbies alone. While many dismissive avoidants become workaholics or hobby-driven, dismissive avoidant women commonly hyper-fixate on their children—becoming deeply intertwined in their kids' schedules, activities, and identities, often using parenting as a socially acceptable way to avoid marital intimacy. Dr. Hensley also addresses sexuality, noting that dismissive avoidant women are frequently less interested in sex with their partners and will use stress, exhaustion, parenting demands, or busyness to avoid intimacy, because intimacy equals vulnerability. While dismissive avoidance looks similar across genders at its core, this episode highlights the specific nuances that tend to appear in women—and how those patterns quietly impact romantic connection over time.

### *Episode 31, Season 2: Beyond the Noise: Empathy in the Midst of Tragedy — Dr. Hensley on Erika Kirk's Journey*

Published: 30 Dec 2025

In this week's episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley addresses the intense public scrutiny and speculation surrounding Erika Kirk following the tragic death of her husband, Charlie Kirk. Rather than engaging in political debate, Dr. Hensley centers the conversation on the human cost of grief lived in the public eye — the emotional toll of watching children struggle to understand the loss of their father, the burden of mourning while being scrutinized, and the cruelty of internet culture that often confuses speculation with truth. Dr. Hensley also explores the broader cultural issue of conspiracy thinking and outrage-driven media, including accusations and narratives amplified for clicks — notably those promoted by figures such as Candace Owens. This episode is ultimately a call back to our shared humanity, reminding listeners that empathy should not be conditional upon political alignment. At its core, this conversation challenges us to pause, soften, and recognize that behind every headline is a grieving family still learning how to survive an unimaginable loss.

### *Episode 30, Season 2: The Pain of the Anxious Preoccupied*

Published: 23 Dec 2025

In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley takes listeners inside the inner world of the Anxious Preoccupied attachment style—an attachment style marked by a profound longing and need for love, reassurance, and an almost constant subconscious fear of being left. At the core of the anxious preoccupied is the wound of abandonment. Dr. Hensley explains how individuals with this attachment style often grow up receiving intermittent reinforcement of love—care that is inconsistent, unpredictable, and emotionally unreliable. The brain adapts by becoming overly attuned to signs of connection or disconnection, wiring the nervous system for anxiety, rumination, and emotional pain when the closeness to the one they love feels threatened. This early conditioning is why many anxious preoccupied individuals later experience love as addictive, consuming, and essential for emotional survival rather than a place of co-regulation. Dr. Hensley goes on to unpack how this attachment style often expresses itself through chronic people-pleasing and self-abandonment. In an effort to prevent loss, anxious preoccupied individuals frequently minimize their own needs, over-function in relationships, and prioritize others' comfort at the expense of their own emotional well-being. Drawing from attachment research, neuroscience, and clinical insight, this episode explores how the nervous system equates separation with danger—and why even subtle relational cues can trigger intense distress. Most importantly, Dr. Hensley offers validation and hope, emphasizing that this pain is not a character flaw, but an adaptive response to early relational wounds—and that with awareness, nervous system healing, and earned security, the anxious preoccupied can learn to experience love without losing themselves in the process.

### *Episode 29, Season 2: Navigating Autism with Dr. Theresa Lyons*

Published: 16 Dec 2025

Dr. Sarah Hensley and Raina Butcher sit down with Dr. Theresa Lyons, Yale-trained scientist, medical strategist, and autism parent, to explore what truly happens after an autism diagnosis. This conversation speaks directly to the shock, grief, confusion, and information overload so many parents experience. Dr. Lyons is the creator of the Navigating Autism (Navigating AWEtism) platform and YouTube channel, built to help families move beyond "wait and see" and into empowered, research-informed decision-making. Together, they unpack how autism is currently diagnosed, why the process can feel overwhelming and fragmented, and how parents can begin to make sense of the science without losing themselves in it. What makes this episode especially powerful is its balance of research and humanity. Dr. Lyons shares how diving deeply into the scientific literature helped her shift from fear to strategy—exploring areas such as the gut-immune-brain connection, sensory regulation, sleep, and emerging interventions being studied in the autism space. At the center of the conversation is the nervous system of the parent and the family system as a whole, with Dr. Hensley and Dr. Lyons openly acknowledging the emotional toll autism can take on marriages, identity, and mental health, while offering reassurance that parents deserve support, clarity, and hope—not just for their child, but for themselves. This episode is a grounded, compassionate guide for families navigating autism with both science and soul.

### *Episode 28, Season 2: Running on Empty: Understanding Emotional Burnout*

Published: 09 Dec 2025

In this deeply validating and eye-opening episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and Raina Butcher tackle an issue that is quietly suffocating millions of people; emotional burnout. They break down why so many individuals, especially women, are reaching a breaking point. Dr. Hensley introduces listeners to the scientific concept of allostatic load, the cumulative wear and tear on the body caused by chronic emotional stress. Whether you're navigating overwhelming responsibilities at work, carrying the mental load of a household, juggling the emotional needs of children, or fighting for connection in an insecurely attached relationship, the body registers every single demand. And eventually, it keeps the score. Dr. Hensley dives into the physiological reality of what happens when the emotional gas tank runs dry. She explains how constant stress dysregulates hormone production—particularly cortisol, adrenaline, and estrogen-progesterone balance—leading to symptoms like brain fog, irritability, emotional numbness, sleep disruption, inflammation, lowered immunity, hair loss, weight fluctuations, and difficulty accessing joy. Raina shares her own experiences with emotional overload, offering listeners a relatable window into what it feels like when your body quietly whispers… then suddenly screams… that enough is enough. Together, they illuminate how burnout is not a personal failure but a biological response to chronic, unrelenting demand. But this conversation isn't just about naming the problem—it's about offering a path forward. Dr. Hensley teaches listeners how to increase their emotional capacity by building a bigger "gas tank," strengthening the nervous system through consistent, intentional regulation practices, realistic boundaries, appropriate rest cycles, and emotional processing skills. She reminds listeners that while humans are adaptable, we were never designed to live in perpetual survival mode. Our nervous systems were built for presence, connection, slowness, joy, and manageable stress—not the endless mental gymnastics required of modern life. This episode is heartfelt, honest, and profoundly hopeful, offering not just insight but compassion for everyone walking through the heaviness of emotional depletion.

### *Episode 27, Season 2: Your Questions Answered from Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services Facebook Clients & Community*

Published: 02 Dec 2025

In this special Q&A edition of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley returns to the heart of her community—the Love Doc Clients & Community Facebook group—to answer your most pressing, vulnerable, and deeply human questions. Every month, you submit honest reflections about your relationships, your attachment patterns, your pain points, and your breakthroughs… and Episode 27 is dedicated entirely to responding to the topics you care about most. Inside this episode, Dr. Hensley explores a wide range of themes pulled directly from your submissions. From navigating partners who shut down emotionally, to learning how to regulate your nervous system during conflict, to understanding why certain attachment patterns keep repeating even when you know better—this conversation is grounded in psychology, compassion, and real-life relational experience. If you've ever thought, "Someone else has to be going through this… right?"—this episode will remind you that you're not alone. The questions come from real people inside the Love Doc community, and every answer is meant to support you in building healthier, more secure connections. Every month moving forward, Dr. Hensley will continue pulling from your submissions to feature your biggest questions on the podcast—because your growth, your clarity, and your healing matter here.

### *Episode 26, Season 2: Inside the Pain of the Fearful Avoidant*

Published: 25 Nov 2025

This episode takes listeners into the complex and often misunderstood inner world of the Fearful Avoidant, and this conversation is especially powerful because both Dr. Hensley and Raina share openly from their own lived experiences as former FA's. This episode blends psychology, attachment science, and deeply personal storytelling as the hosts break down why the Fearful Avoidant carries some of the most profoun, and most painful emotional wounds out of all the attachment styles. Together, they explore how the FA's lifelong push-pull pattern begins in childhood, where one or both caregivers were emotionally inconsistent, unpredictable, or unavailable. Many Fearful Avoidants grew up in homes where they had no idea which version of their caregiver they would get on any given day—loving and attentive, or distant, overwhelmed, unstable, or even frightening. This led the FA child to live in a constant state of hypervigilance, subconsciously scanning the environment for emotional danger. At a very young age, they began asking a silent but devastating question: "If the people who are supposed to love me can't show up for me consistently… who ever will?" Dr. Hensley digs into why this early inconsistency wires the FA nervous system for contradiction: craving closeness while bracing for pain, longing for love while fearing it may not be real or safe. The episode highlights how this attachment style becomes the most emotionally aware—attuned to every shift, every tone, every expression—yet often feels the least emotionally secure. That heightened awareness becomes both their superpower and their deepest source of suffering. Throughout the discussion, Dr. Hensley and Raina reflect on their former FA behaviors. These stories help listeners feel seen, understood, and far less alone. The episode also unpacks how emotional pain lands differently for the Fearful Avoidant—often as intense overwhelm that triggers shutting down, lashing out, or pushing away the very person they love. Yet behind these behaviors lies a person with deep emotional intelligence who never learned consistent emotional safety. By the end of the episode, listeners gain a compassionate and clear understanding of why the Fearful Avoidant is both deeply sensitive and deeply guarded, highly intuitive yet profoundly unsure of their own worthiness, and why healing requires a blend of emotional safety, self-awareness, and stability. This episode offers a rare blend of science and lived experience that will give every fearful avoidant, or the partner of a fearful avoidant, a deeper sense of understnading and compassion for this attachment style.

### *Episode 25, Season 2: Plant-Based Interventions for PTSD & CPTSD*

Published: 11 Nov 2025

In this episode, Dr. Hensley dives into the rapidly growing field of plant-based trauma interventions and what current research is beginning to reveal about their potential to support healing from PTSD and Complex PTSD (CPTSD). She begins by breaking down the key differences between PTSD — which often develops from a single traumatic event — and CPTSD, which develops from long-term emotional, relational, or developmental trauma. Dr. Hensley also highlights the strong correlation between CPTSD and Fearful Avoidant attachment, explaining how chronic trauma impacts the nervous system's capacity for closeness, trust, and emotional stability. Drawing from her background as a researcher and scientist, Dr. Hensley brings her signature ability to translate complex research into clear, digestible insight. She examines emerging studies exploring cannabis as a trauma-informed intervention, including how it interacts with the endocannabinoid system and why certain compounds may support emotional regulation, memory reconsolidation, and nervous system downregulation in trauma recovery. She discusses what the evidence suggests, what remains inconclusive, and what to consider when exploring cannabis in a therapeutic context rather than recreational use. The episode then shifts into the evolving research surrounding psilocybin, a naturally occurring psychedelic compound. While Dr. Hensley has not personally conducted research in either of these areas, she has deeply analyzed the current scientific literature, offering a balanced and grounded perspective on what early clinical trials are demonstrating — particularly regarding emotional processing, neural flexibility, self-compassion, and the ability to access emotions that may otherwise be suppressed. This conversation is not about endorsement, persuasion, or advocating a particular treatment — but rather education, curiosity, and informed awareness. The research in this field is still developing, but it is undeniably promising for the future of trauma recovery and attachment repair.

### *Episode 24, Season 2: The Science Behind Healing*

Published: 04 Nov 2025

In this follow-up to last week's deeply personal episode with her dear friend Ashley, Dr. Sarah Hensley takes listeners on a profound exploration into the science behind healing — continuing the conversation that began with her story of faith. While her previous episode centered on her personal healing journey through Christ, this week Dr. Hensley expands on how faith and science beautifully intertwine — because, as she believes, faith is the very foundation of science itself. This episode speaks directly to those who want to understand the scientific how — the psychological and neurological processes that underlie emotional healing. Dr. Hensley unpacks the science of the brain, emotional regulation, and the rewiring of neural pathways that allow us to create new, healthier responses to emotional pain, conflict, and relational distress. She emphasizes that knowledge alone isn't power — it's the application of knowledge through capacity building that truly transforms us. Healing, she explains, happens when we move from intellectual understanding into embodied emotional processing. In classic "Love Doc" fashion, Dr. Hensley cuts through the noise of overcomplicated therapeutic frameworks by focusing on simplicity and mastery. She reveals how her own programs are built around just two core emotional skills — the essential foundations needed to effectively process emotions and build true relational resilience. Throughout the episode, Dr. Hensley gives credit to the pioneering scientists and psychologists whose decades of research paved the way for her work. She honors their contributions while also highlighting where she found critical gaps in the existing research — gaps that inspired her to develop her own trademarked emotional processing framework. By the end of this episode, listeners will understand not just what emotional healing is, but how it happens — from a neurological, psychological, and practical standpoint. If you've ever wanted to grasp the real, science-backed process behind transformation — and learn the same tools Dr. Hensley teaches her clients every day inside her practice — this episode is a must-listen.

### *Episode 23, Season 2: The Wisest Person Dr. Hensley Has Ever Met*

Published: 28 Oct 2025

In this powerful and deeply moving episode, Dr. Sarah Hensley introduces listeners to someone who has been quietly woven into the fabric of her story for many years—her dear friend Ashley Endenstrom. If you've been a loyal listener, you've likely heard Dr. Hensley mention Ashley many times, often referring to her as the vessel that led her to seek a relationship with Jesus. The episode begins with Ashley courageously sharing her personal testimony—one shaped by heartbreak, unwavering faith, and profound redemption. From the pain of failed relationships to being told she would never bear children, and even the devastating loss of a child, Ashley's story is nothing short of miraculous. Today, she is the proud and joy-filled mother of five healthy children, all conceived naturally. Her journey is one of hope, perseverance, and the transformative power of faith. As the conversation unfolds, Dr. Hensley opens up about the pivotal season in her life when God placed Ashley in her path. It was a time marked by unimaginable pain: the loss of her ex-husband, navigating grief with her children, her mother's cancer diagnosis, a turbulent relationship with a dismissive avoidant partner, and even a painful fracture in her friendship with Raina. Through Ashley's steadfast faith and presence, God worked powerfully—restoring, healing, and holding space for Sarah in ways that would change her life forever. Throughout the episode, Ashley offers multiple Bible verses that beautifully reflect the unwavering love and grace of Christ, weaving scripture into real-life moments of redemption and resilience. Dr. Hensley also reflects on the many pieces of wisdom Ashley has poured into her life over the years—what she lovingly calls "Ashleyisms." These are the heartfelt phrases, profound one-liners, and gentle truths that have anchored Sarah in some of her most difficult seasons. Many of these sayings have become personal touchstones for Dr. Hensley, quietly shaping her faith, her healing, and the way she shows up in her practice and in her life. Listeners will hear all three women's personal faith journeys and how they have grown and deepened over the years—and how their relationship with Christ has enriched every part of their lives. Important Note: This episode is deeply Christian-based and speaks openly and candidly about faith in Jesus Christ. Both Raina and Dr. Hensley believe in creating an inclusive space for everyone while honoring their personal spiritual journeys. If this message doesn't align with your beliefs, feel free to skip this episode with love and respect. For those who are seeking a closer connection with God—or are simply curious about what that might look like—this episode offers a heartfelt invitation to experience Christ's love. Ashley's gentle wisdom, combined with Dr. Hensley and Raina's shared reflections, create a deeply intimate conversation about faith, healing, and divine love. The central message of this episode is beautifully simple yet profoundly true: God is Love. And if you are searching for more in your life—more peace, more meaning, more connection, more healing—our hope is that you'll open your heart to the possibility of that love. Links to books referenced in episode: "Experiencing God" -- https://a.co/d/buOZbDD "The Inner Voice of Love" -- https://a.co/d/gOhSRJ1

## *Episode 22, Season 2: When the Spark Fades: Healing Sex, Shame, and Connection After Kids with special guest Dr. Rebecca Eudy*

Published: 21 Oct 2025

In this powerful and deeply intimate episode, Dr. Sarah Hensley sits down with licensed couples and sex therapist Dr. Rebecca Howard Eudy, author of the newly released book "A Guide to Great Sex After Kids ," to talk about one of the most quietly painful topics many couples face—what happens to intimacy after children. Together, they pull back the curtain on the real, research-backed struggles couples encounter as they try to reconnect sexually amid exhaustion, identity shifts, and the invisible weight of modern parenting. Dr. Eudy, like Dr. Hensley, draws on attachment science to explain how emotional safety is the foundation of erotic safety. When partners feel unseen, unvalidated, or emotionally disconnected, the body interprets closeness as pressure rather than pleasure. Dr. Eudy and the host discuss how postpartum changes, stress, and shifting roles can quietly activate old attachment wounds—anxious partners fearing rejection, avoidant partners withdrawing under the weight of expectation—and how rebuilding emotional intimacy often becomes the key to reviving sexual desire. They also dive head-on into the topic of sexual shame, a quiet force that can fracture even the strongest partnerships. Dr. Eudy beautifully normalizes that nearly everyone carries some form of sexual trauma—whether from past relationships, body image conditioning, or religious and cultural scripts—and she reminds listeners that this doesn't make anyone broken. Instead, she frames it as an invitation to heal. Through gentle language and tangible examples, she shows how curiosity, self-compassion, and vulnerability can transform shame into connection. Another core theme of the episode is self-exploration—both emotional and physical. Dr. Eudy highlights the importance of learning your own body again after children, reclaiming desire through self-pleasure, and maintaining openness about what truly feels good. Masturbation, body awareness, and honest communication aren't just acts of indulgence, she explains—they're pathways back to self-ownership and authenticity, the very things that sustain long-term intimacy. By the end of the episode, Dr. Hensley and Dr. Eudy remind listeners that great sex isn't just about chemistry or technique; it's about the emotional and relational ecosystem in which that intimacy lives. When couples learn to meet one another's emotional needs, regulate their nervous systems, and release the weight of shame, they don't just revive their sex lives—they rediscover safety, joy, and connection in every corner of their relationship. This conversation is a must-listen for anyone who has ever wondered where their spark went—and who's ready to bring it back, with compassion, science, and a renewed sense of wholeness. Please checkout Dr. Rebecca Eudy and her newly released book at: Rebeccaeudy.com Instagram @ rebeccahowardeudy.com Book: https://www.amazon.com/Parents-Love-Guide-Great-After/dp/1683738551

### *Episode 21, Season 2: The Pain of the Dismissive Avoidant*

Published: 14 Oct 2025

In this powerful and deeply illuminating episode host Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher dive into one of the most misunderstood emotional landscapes in attachment science: the inner world of the Dismissive Avoidant. For decades, the dismissive avoidant has been stereotyped as cold, unfeeling, and incapable of emotional depth. But Dr. Hensley dismantles that myth with compassion and scientific clarity. Beneath their carefully constructed armor lies some of the deepest, oldest pain of all the attachment styles—a pain so profound that many DA's have learned to dissociate from it entirely just to survive. Dr. Hensley traces these wounds back to their roots in childhood. Many dismissive avoidants grew up in environments where emotional needs were consistently minimized, ignored, or even shamed. A child who learns that their emotional world is unsafe or "too much" often adapts by shutting it down altogether. That shutdown becomes their survival strategy—one they unknowingly carry into adulthood. But here's the truth that often goes unseen: that shutdown is not the absence of feeling; it is the presence of invisible pain. Pain from years of not being held emotionally. Pain from learning early on that vulnerability equals danger. Pain that becomes so overwhelming that the only way to cope is to turn it off. Inside adult romantic relationships, this creates a painful paradox. The DA's partner often experiences the excruciating sting of their distance—their tendency to pull away when connection deepens, their inability to express what's going on internally, their preference for solitude over closeness. But underneath that distance is a nervous system that is terrified of being emotionally seen as too much or dismissed for feeling. Their detachment isn't because they don't care. It's because the pain is simply too much to face. Dr. Hensley and Raina explore how healing for dismissive avoidants isn't about "learning more." It's about learning how to build capacity around feeling safely for the first time. And when they do heal—when they slowly reconnect with the parts of themselves they've locked away for years—many report experiencing real joy for the first time in their adult lives. Joy in connection. Joy in trust. Joy in finally coming home to themselves. As Dr. Hensley shares, this journey requires a gentle, measured, and safe container—one that honors their pace rather than overwhelms it. That's exactly why Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services Hybrid Group Coaching Program has become a powerful healing space for so many dismissive avoidants. The program allows participants to remain anonymous if they choose, and the information is micro-dosed in digestible layers, so DA's can process at their own speed without pressure or exposure. In fact, many FA/DA couples who've gone through Dr. Hensley's program report breakthroughs they once thought were impossible. Whether you love someone with a dismissive avoidant attachment style—or you are one—this episode offers both scientific insight and a path forward. Pain may have shaped their past, but it does not have to define their future.

### *Episode 20, Season 2: Monthly Q&A – Questions from Our Private Facebook Community*

Published: 07 Oct 2025

In this month's special Q&A edition of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley opens the floor to you—our loyal listeners and members of the Love Doc Clients & Community Facebook group. After reading through dozens of insightful and deeply personal questions submitted by the community, Dr. Hensley sits down to answer as many as she can in one heartfelt episode. These are real questions from real people—many of whom are courageously navigating the complexities of insecure attachment, emotional neglect, and the challenges of modern relationships. As expected, a major theme emerges: the Dismissive Avoidant attachment style—that emotionally elusive, often misunderstood blueprint that so many of you struggle to make sense of. Why do they retreat just as things start to feel close? Can they truly change? What does healing look like with someone who seems emotionally unavailable? Dr. Hensley dives deep into these questions, unpacking the psychology of avoidance while also addressing broader themes such as self-abandonment, boundary setting, and nervous system regulation in love and partnership. If you've ever found yourself asking, "Why do I love people who can't meet me halfway?"—this episode will feel like a conversation you've needed for years. And if you're not yet part of the free, private Love Doc Clients & Community group, consider this your invitation to join a supportive, trauma-informed space where you can connect, ask questions anonymously, and receive guidance grounded in science and compassion. Join the group here. Month after month from here on out Dr. Hensley will be answering your most pressing questions directly on the podcast. Keep your questions coming—because your healing matters here.

### *Episode 19, Season 2: Attachment Across the Generations: How Our Past Shapes Our Present*

Published: 30 Sep 2025

In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley dives into a thought-provoking exploration of how attachment styles have been shaped and reshaped across multiple generations. While research in this area is still developing, Dr. Hensley shares her insights, blending the data we do have with her own professional expertise and observations from years of working with clients. Together, she and Raina reflect on how cultural norms, economic conditions, and parenting trends have influenced the way each generation both experiences and passes down attachment. We begin with The Greatest Generation aka the Silent Generation (1928–1945), who were shaped by the Great Depression and World War II. Their attachment strategies often leaned toward survival, self-sacrifice, and stoicism—traits that helped them endure hardship but often left emotional needs unspoken. This foundation directly influenced the Baby Boomers (1946–1964), who grew up in a time of post-war prosperity, suburban expansion, and cultural shifts. While this generation had greater stability, many were raised by emotionally distant parents still carrying war scars, creating a paradox of material abundance alongside emotional gaps. Next, we move to Generation X (1965–1980), often called the “latchkey kids.” With both parents working and divorce rates climbing, many Gen X children learned independence early but often struggled with consistent emotional attunement at home. This set the stage for Millennials (1981–1996), who came of age in a rapidly globalizing world of technology, economic instability, and shifting social values. Millennials were raised with more open conversations about emotions but also felt the weight of high expectations, student debt, and uncertain futures—all of which influence how they form and sustain attachments today. Finally, we turn to Gen Z (1997–2012) and Gen Alpha (2013–present), the most digital-native generations. Gen Z has grown up amidst political polarization, social media pressures, and the mental health crisis, shaping a cohort that is both highly self-aware and often highly anxious. Gen Alpha, still in childhood, is being raised by Millennials who are more intentional about emotional intelligence, attachment security, and breaking cycles—but also parenting in a world defined by technology, climate concerns, and shifting cultural landscapes. Dr. Hensley and Raina bring compassion and clarity to this conversation, showing how the ripple effects of one generation’s experiences can echo for decades. At the heart of the discussion is a message of hope: while each generation carries wounds, each also has the opportunity to break cycles, build secure attachments, and create healthier family units for the future.

### *Episode 18, Season 2: Holding onto Hope in the Midst of Pain*

Published: 23 Sep 2025

In this week’s episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley and Raina lean into one of the most powerful forces we can carry with us through life’s darkest seasons—hope. So often, when we walk through trauma, loss, or deep relational pain, it feels as though hope is the first thing to vanish. Whether we’re wrestling with the aftermath of PTSD and CPTSD, navigating heartbreak, or enduring circumstances that seem impossible to recover from, hopelessness can take root quickly. But science and lived experience both show us something remarkable: hope has the ability to transform the nervous system, soften the impact of trauma, and ignite the possibility of change. Dr. Hensley and Raina dive into the differences between hope and faith, exploring how these two forces weave together. Faith, they share, is the unseen—it’s trusting in something bigger than ourselves. Hope, however, is the present—it’s the silver lining we can cling to even in the middle of heartbreak, the light that helps us breathe through the shadows. Together, faith and hope create a bridge between what is and what can be. Through raw honesty and deeply personal stories, both hosts open up about seasons in their own lives when hope was the only thing they had to hold onto. Their reflections remind us that while pain may shape us, it doesn’t have to define us. When hope enters the room, everything begins to shift—our perspective, our choices, and the way we show up for ourselves and others. This episode is more than just a conversation; it’s an invitation. An invitation to believe that even in the hardest, most heartbreaking circumstances, hope can still bloom. And when it does, it has the power to rewire our brains, reframe our stories, and restore our joy.

### *Episode 17, Season 2: Restoring Human Decency: Choosing Kindness in a Divided World*

Published: 16 Sep 2025

In the aftermath of heartbreaking tragedy and the loss of Charlie Kirk, our nation is once again faced with a sobering reality: we are not just battling political division, but something much deeper—an erosion of human decency. In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Joy step away from political rhetoric to reflect on what it truly means to be human, to choose kindness, and to build bridges rather than walls. Together, they explore how acts of violence and hatred are not simply social or cultural issues, but signs of spiritual warfare. Scripture reminds us that “we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities and powers” (Ephesians 6:12). These moments of darkness reveal the demonic forces at work in our world—seeking to divide, destroy, and corrupt. Yet even in this brokenness, we are called to be light-bearers, choosing love, compassion, and healthy discourse over bitterness and blame. Dr. Sarah and Raina also speak to the growing epidemic of mental illness and intrusive, demonic thoughts that plague so many in today’s society. They remind listeners that behind every belief, every action, and every worldview is a story. When we approach others with curiosity and empathy rather than condemnation, we open the door to true understanding and healing. This episode is a heartfelt call to return to human decency—to remember that kindness matters, that every person carries wounds we cannot see, and that disagreement does not have to mean division. By grounding ourselves in faith, leaning into compassion, and recognizing the spiritual battle we are all in, we can begin to heal not only our relationships but also the heart of our nation. If you’ve been searching for a message of hope, love, and unity in a time of confusion and grief, this conversation will encourage you to anchor yourself in what matters most: faith, empathy, and the unwavering power of human decency.

### *Episode 16, Season 2: Breaking Free from Fear: How to Stop Letting It Run Your Life and Ruin Your Relationships*

Published: 09 Sep 2025

Fear is one of the most powerful forces shaping our choices, our relationships, and the way we show up in the world. In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Joy dive deep into the psychology of fear, how it hides beneath the surface of our nervous system, how it gets wired in early experiences, and how it quietly dictates our patterns in love, conflict, and connection. Fear often masquerades as self-protection. It convinces us to shut down instead of lean in, to control instead of trust, to react instead of respond. Left unchecked, fear doesn’t just cause anxiety, it erodes intimacy, sabotages our communication, and keeps us locked in cycles that feel impossible to break. Drawing on nearly two decades of attachment science and relational psychology, Dr. Sarah explains how fear is tied to our nervous system’s survival responses and why “pushing through it” rarely works for long. But this conversation goes beyond science. Raina and Dr. Sarah also explore the deeper spiritual dimensions of fear, bringing their strong Christian faith into the dialogue. They reference scriptures like “God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and a sound mind” (2 Timothy 1:7), highlighting how God’s design for us is rooted not in bondage to fear but in freedom, love, and courage. Together, they weave psychology and spirituality into a holistic understanding of why fear shows up, and how we can begin to release it. Most importantly, this episode doesn’t just name the problem, it offers a path forward. Dr. Sarah and Raina share practical steps for loosening fear’s grip on your life, from nervous system capacity-building strategies, to reorienting your mindset, to leaning into the promises of God. You’ll learn how to recognize when fear is running your decisions, how to cultivate safety within yourself, and how to start showing up in relationships with greater faith, confidence, and emotional resilience. If fear has been dictating your choices, your relationships, or your sense of self-worth, this episode is an invitation to step into a different story, one of courage, clarity, and connection.

## *Episode 15, Season 2: The Power of Play in Healing, with Special Guest Lauran September*

Published: 02 Sep 2025

What if one of the most powerful tools for healing, intimacy, and joy has been with us since childhood? In this inspiring episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and Raina sit down with actress, creative consultant, and self-published author Lauran September to explore the transformative role of play in our relationships, our creativity, and our spiritual healing. Drawing from her book, "Playful Healing," and her rich background in acting and improv, Lauran invites us to rediscover play as a sacred doorway back to joy, self-expression, and connection. Research has long shown that play is not just a pastime for children, it is essential to human flourishing at every age. Play therapy, for instance, has been used for decades as a way to process trauma, unlock hidden emotions, and reconnect people with their inner child. In this episode,the hosts and Lauran illuminate how those same principles can be applied to our adult lives and romantic partnerships. When we allow ourselves to be playful with our partners, we move beyond performance and routine, opening the door to intimacy, laughter, and deep emotional safety. The conversation doesn't stop at relationships; it goes deeper into the spiritual essence of play. As Lauran shares, play is at the heart of who we are as creators, as lovers, and as human beings. It softens the nervous system, nourishes the soul, and reminds us that life is not just about survival, it's about delight, spontaneity, audacity and authentic expression. Through personal stories, professional insights, and spiritual reflections, Dr. Hensley, Raina and Lauran explore how engaging in playful acts can help us heal old wounds, reawaken joy, and reconnect with the divine spark of creativity that lives within us all. If you've ever felt weighed down by the seriousness of life or the heaviness of unresolved pain, this episode is an invitation to return to wonder. To laugh. To explore. To play. Because when we let ourselves play, we're not just entertaining ourselves, we're healing, connecting, and remembering who we truly are. You can find Lauran September on Tik-Tok @artisfaewellness and Instagram @ancientheart333

## *Episode 14, Season 2: Mending Hearts & Homes: The Power of Mediation with Joe Dillon of Equitable Mediation*

Published: 26 Aug 2025

In this uplifting episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley and Raina welcome Joe Dillon, co-founder of Equitable Mediation Services and a seasoned expert in divorce mediation. As a powerful continuation of our Family Court Series, this episode offers listeners a beacon of hope—clear, compassionate alternatives to conventional court separation and custody disputes. Joe brings both personal insight and profound expertise to this conversation. Inspired by his own experience as a child of divorce who witnessed the emotionally devastating effects of lawyer-driven litigation, Joe's mission is rooted in preventing similar trauma from impacting other families. With over 17 years of private mediation practice under his belt—and an MBA in finance, plus training from prestigious institutions such as Harvard, MIT, and Northwestern—he combines emotional intelligence and financial savviness to guide couples toward fair, collaborative outcomes. One of the most compelling parts of the discussion centers on the "interest-based negotiation" model Joe champions—an approach that shifts focus from entrenched positions to underlying needs and shared goals. Joe explains how mediation fosters "win-win" agreements and dramatically reduces costs and emotional damage compared to traditional litigation, which he notes can reach as high as $200,000—the equivalent of a four-year college education. This episode also shines a spotlight on Joe's pioneering role in virtual mediation—a service he launched in 2011, well before many embraced remote alternatives during the pandemic. His practices empower families across numerous states (California, New York, New Jersey, Illinois, Pennsylvania, Washington State) to engage in thoughtful, structured mediation from any location. Throughout the episode, Joe extends tangible resources: from free courses, helpful blogs, and consultation options available through Equitable Mediation, to advice on designing "roommate agreements" when post-divorce couples find it necessary to continue co-habitating for financial or logistical reasons. This episode explores why mediators aren't just facilitators—they're peace architects, helping couples untangle complex emotional and financial decisions in ways that protect children, relationships, and dignity. Why This Episode Matters for Our Listeners Offers a Practical Alternative to Litigation Through Joe's personal journey and his data-backed approach, listeners can discover a kinder, more constructive path out of marriage or parent-child tension that preserves both stability and civility. Reduces Financial and Emotional Toll As Joe highlights, mediation not only lowers the fiscal burden of divorce but also shields families—especially children—from the trauma of court conflict. Accessible Anywhere, Anytime Joe's virtual-first model makes mediation accessible regardless of geography, fitting seamlessly into modern, busy lives. Provides Real-World Tools and Empowerment From negotiation frameworks to free educational content and flexible agreements, this episode equips listeners with knowledge, hope, and actionable steps. Episode 14 isn't just another episode—it's a lifeline for families navigating the storm of separation. Joe Dillon will show you that healing, fairness, and hope are possible—even when the path seems steep. Mediation isn't just a process; it's a bridge to a new chapter defined by cooperation and compassion. You can find Joe and all his services at https://www.equitablemediation.com/

### *Episode 13, Season 2: Love on Autopilot: The Hidden Dangers of Using AI in Your Relationships*

Published: 19 Aug 2025

In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley dives into one of the most timely and overlooked threats to modern love: the use of artificial intelligence in romantic relationships. While AI has incredible benefits in education, work, and even self-development, when it crosses into the territory of our most intimate connections, the risks are profound. Dr. Hensley unpacks the psychological cost of outsourcing our communication, validation, and even emotional expression to machines, revealing how this can quietly erode both our sense of self and the trust between partners. Through the lens of attachment science, Dr. Hensley explores how AI dependency interacts with each attachment style in unique but equally damaging ways. For the anxious-preoccupied, AI can become a dangerous validation trap, another addictive tool to soothe insecurity temporarily, but one that deepens dependency rather than fostering true relational safety. For the fearful-avoidant, AI may fuel cycles of hyperfixation and overthinking, intensifying inner conflict and emotional spiraling when they lean into their anxious side. And for the dismissive-avoidant, AI can become a shield that distances them further, providing ready-made responses that bypass vulnerability, intimacy, and the emotional presence their partners need. Dr. Hensley also sheds light on the broader psychological consequences of allowing machines to mediate human love. When we turn to AI for reassurance, scripted intimacy, or conflict resolution, we bypass the messy, imperfect, yet profoundly human work of building trust and resilience with another person. Over time, this reliance can stunt emotional growth, dilute authenticity, and undermine the very skills necessary for a healthy, secure partnership. Ultimately, Dr. Hensley reminds listeners that human connection is our deepest need and most vital resource. AI can be a useful tool in many aspects of life, but when it comes to love, discernment and moderation are essential. True intimacy requires presence, honesty, and vulnerability, things no algorithm can replicate. This episode is both a cautionary tale and a call to return to the raw, real, irreplaceable art of human connection.

### *Episode 12, Season 2: Mastering the Conscious Mind: The Key to Directing Your Life and Relationships*

Published: 12 Aug 2025

In this eye-opening episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley takes listeners deep into the fascinating world of the conscious mind—what it is, how it works, and why learning to harness its power is one of the most important skills you can develop for both personal growth and relationship health. Building on the foundation she laid in Season 1, Episode 2 on the subconscious mind, Dr. Hensley explores how the conscious and subconscious interact, and how we can use the part of the mind we can control to influence the part we often think we can't. From a scientific perspective, the conscious mind is the realm of active thought—the internal narrator, the "little voice in your head," the part of you that reasons, decides, and chooses. Dr. Hensley explains how this mental space is rooted in specific regions of the brain, such as the prefrontal cortex, which is responsible for decision-making, self-control, and planning. Unlike the subconscious, which runs much of our behavior on autopilot, the conscious mind allows us to pause, evaluate, and redirect our thoughts and actions. This distinction is critical in relationships, where automatic patterns—often rooted in attachment wounds—can derail connection if left unchecked. Dr. Hensley draws on both neuroscience and attachment theory to show how training the conscious mind can dramatically shift the way we respond to relational triggers. She highlights studies demonstrating that when we intentionally engage the conscious mind—through mindfulness, deliberate self-reflection, and reframing—we can rewire neural pathways, reduce emotional reactivity, and replace destructive cycles with healthier patterns. This process, known as neuroplasticity, is not just theoretical; it's the scientific foundation for real, lasting change in how we love, communicate, and resolve conflict. Listeners will learn practical strategies for strengthening the conscious mind's influence over the subconscious, from daily awareness practices to cognitive-behavioral techniques that Dr. Hensley uses in her coaching work. She explains how developing this skill allows us to respond thoughtfully instead of reacting impulsively, creating more safety, trust, and intimacy in our relationships. By taking charge of the thoughts we feed our subconscious, we can literally train our brains to default toward healthier beliefs, more secure attachment behaviors, and a deeper sense of connection. If you've ever felt like you were stuck on emotional autopilot or powerless against old patterns, this episode will give you the tools and understanding to reclaim control. And for a full picture of how the mind works, don't forget to revisit Season 1, Episode 2, where Dr. Hensley unpacks the subconscious mind and its powerful role in shaping our lives. Together, these episodes offer a roadmap for aligning your thoughts, beliefs, and actions—helping you create the life and relationships you truly want.

## *Episode 11, Season 2: Betrayal by the Dollar: The Hidden Wounds of Financial Infidelity*

Published: 05 Aug 2025

In this raw and eye-opening episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Joy Butcher dive deep into one of the most overlooked yet devastating forms of betrayal in romantic relationships: financial infidelity. Continuing their powerful financial series, Episode 11 unpacks the hidden dynamics behind the misuse of money in intimate partnerships — not just as a resource, but as a tool of control, secrecy, and even revenge. With real-life stories, personal reflections, and clinical insight, this episode offers clarity, compassion, and guidance for those silently suffering in relationships where money is used as a weapon instead of a shared value. The episode begins by examining financial control and coercion — two insidious forms of financial infidelity that leave many partners emotionally paralyzed and psychologically trapped. Whether it's one partner dictating all financial decisions, withholding access to accounts, or using money to manipulate behaviors and choices, the hosts expose how financial power plays erode trust, dignity, and a sense of partnership. Many victims of this type of control feel emotionally blackmailed into staying, even when they desperately want to leave. Dr. Hensley and Raina highlight how the shame, fear, and isolation surrounding financial coercion often go unnoticed — yet the consequences are long-lasting and deeply damaging to a person’s mental health and autonomy. The conversation then moves into secret spending, a subtler but equally destructive form of financial infidelity. From hidden credit cards to secret online purchases, the hosts unpack how these actions become betrayals of both financial trust and emotional intimacy. Often rooted in guilt, resentment, or unmet needs, secret spending fractures the foundation of honesty that secure relationships are built on. Listeners will hear why this behavior often creates a growing emotional gap — one that’s harder to repair than many realize. Dr. Hensley offers a compassionate take on the underlying insecurities and attachment wounds that often drive this type of behavior, providing listeners with language to recognize and address it in their own relationships. The episode culminates in a candid and courageous discussion on revenge spending, the reactive, emotionally-charged use of money in the aftermath of a major relationship rupture. Whether it's a response to a heated argument or triggered by a partner’s request for separation or divorce, revenge spending becomes a way to assert power or express hurt. Dr. Hensley and Raina both open up about their childhood experiences with financial conflict — Sarah recalling the volatility of her father’s financial behaviors, and Raina reflecting on how her mother’s money choices strained her parents’ marriage both during and excspecially post divorce. These powerful personal stories shed light on how early money dynamics shape our adult relationships and sense of self-worth. They also reflect on their own romantic relationships, sharing moments where money became a source of pain, confusion, and reflection. To close the episode, Dr. Hensley offers practical and preventative guidance for couples looking to protect their relationship from financial betrayal. She shares thoughtful, research-based strategies to establish financial transparency, healthy boundaries, and ongoing dialogue about money as a shared value rather than a hidden battlefield. With warmth and wisdom, this episode affirms that while financial infidelity can feel like an invisible rupture, healing is possible with honesty, accountability, and mutual respect. If you've ever felt like money was used against you instead of with you in a relationship — or if you're simply ready to build healthier financial habits with your partner — this episode is a must-listen.

### *Episode 10, Season 2: Money, Marriage & Faith: What If It's Not About the Money? With Special Guest Clint Jasperson*

Published: 29 Jul 2025

What if your fights about money… aren't actually about money? In this honest and eye-opening episode, Dr. Sarah Hensley sits down with special guest Clint Jasperson, Certified Financial Planner™, RICP®, and father of two, to explore the hidden layers beneath financial stress in romantic relationships. Clint brings a unique blend of expertise in psychology, education, and financial planning, helping clients and couples build clarity, confidence, and purpose into their financial lives. Together, they discuss how your relationship with money—shaped by childhood, values, trauma, and attachment wounds—often determines how secure or strained your romantic partnerships feel. From feeling unseen or unsupported to power struggles around spending, saving, or planning for the future, financial tension is one of the leading causes of disconnection and divorce. Clint shares his team's approach at Thrivent and PDW, where financial security is rooted in meaning—not just numbers. They help clients navigate everything from day-to-day planning to estate transitions and legacy goals, through a values-based model grounded in provision, contentment, and joy. This episode goes beyond traditional financial advice and into the deeper psychological and emotional realities of how couples can heal, unite, and build lives that feel aligned, safe, and full of purpose. In this episode, you'll learn: Why your money story starts in childhood—and how to change it The emotional toll of financial imbalance in relationships How to create a shared financial vision rooted in your values Why "financial compatibility" is more about safety than status How faith and generosity can reshape your relationship with money This conversation is especially powerful if you've ever felt like one partner carries the financial load, or if you and your spouse just can't seem to get on the same page. It's a blend of financial strategy, emotional insight, and healing truth. You can find more information about Clint and his services via his LinkedIN page at: https://www.linkedin.com/in/clintjasperson or follow him on Instagram @barnabas.374

### *Episode 9, Season 2: Your Burning Questions Answered – Straight from Our Private Community*

Published: 22 Jul 2025

In this special Q&A episode, Dr. Sarah Hensley opens the floor to you—our loyal listeners and members of the Love Doc Clients & Community Facebook Group. After reading through dozens of thoughtful, heartfelt questions submitted by group members, Dr. Hensley sits down to answer as many as she can in one episode. These are real questions from real people—many of whom are navigating the painful complexities of insecure attachment, emotional neglect, and modern relational dynamics. Unsurprisingly, many of the questions center around the dismissive avoidant—an attachment style that continues to confuse and captivate so many of you. Why do they pull away when you get closer? Can they change? What does healing even look like with someone who seems so shut down? Dr. Hensley dives into all of this and more, shedding light on the misunderstood emotional blueprint of the dismissive avoidant partner while also addressing broader topics like boundary setting, nervous system regulation, and self-abandonment in relationships. If you've ever felt alone in your experience or wished for more clarity about your patterns and pain points, this episode is for you. And if you're not already part of the free, private Love Doc Clients & Community Group, this is your invitation to join a supportive, trauma-informed space where you can connect, ask questions anonymously, and receive guidance rooted in attachment science. Join the group here . We're excited to make this monthly Q&A a regular part of the podcast, so stay tuned—and keep your questions coming. Your healing matters here.

## *Episode 8, Season 2: Meet Coach Elizabeth: Coaching with Joy, Purpose, and Compassion*

Published: 15 Jul 2025

In this heartfelt and inspiring episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley introduces listeners to one of the core members of her coaching team—Coach Elizabeth, a certified relationship coach under Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services. With a deeply rooted background in both education and psychology, Coach Elizabeth brings a unique and powerful blend of empathy, wisdom, and joyful presence to every coaching interaction. Having taught students at every grade level from kindergarten through 12th grade, her transition into relationship coaching felt like a natural extension of her lifelong passion for helping others grow, heal, and thrive. Dr. Hensley and Coach Elizabeth dive into a rich conversation about how coaching beautifully bridges the worlds of therapy and education. With their shared experience in academic settings, both women reflect on how effective coaching often mirrors the best aspects of teaching—offering guidance, structure, curiosity, and support, all while encouraging personal discovery and transformation. Elizabeth's warm, non-judgmental approach is deeply inspired by the groundbreaking work of Dr. Allan Schore, whose research on joy-based attachment and right-brain emotional regulation highlights the healing potential of emotionally attuned relationships. Elizabeth coaches from a place of deep compassion and trust, creating a secure space where clients feel safe to explore, evolve, and reconnect with themselves and their partners. Throughout the episode, Dr. Hensley poses thoughtful questions about what Coach Elizabeth sees most often in her coaching practice—especially regarding attachment styles and their impact on modern relationships. Coach Elizabeth offers her insight into the most common patterns she sees in her clients and shares her favorite attachment style to coach (you might be surprised!). She also reflects on one of her most memorable client success stories, offering an inspiring glimpse into how powerful the journey of healing and connection can be with the right support. The conversation naturally flows into topics around life-coaching balance, and how both women strive to model sustainable emotional care—both for their clients and themselves. To close, listeners are given a deeper look into Coach Elizabeth's extensive training and passionate philosophy. Elizabeth Pomeroy holds a Master's degree in Counseling from Asbury University and is certified directly by Dr. Hensley in attachment-based relationship coaching. She is formally trained in trauma-informed care, attachment theory, and the science of human interaction. With a calming presence and deep emotional insight, Elizabeth specializes in healing attachment wounds, nurturing healthy communication patterns, and integrating faith-based healing strategies where desired. She believes wholeheartedly that humans are wired for connection—but sometimes need guidance navigating the complexities of love. Her coaching is grounded, joyful, and deeply transformative, helping clients bridge the gap between where they are in their relationships and where they long to be.

## *Episode 7, Season 2: When the Past Keeps Bleeding In: The Science & Stories of Retraumatization*

Published: 08 Jul 2025

In this raw and revealing episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley and Raina dive deep into the rarely understood—but widely experienced—phenomenon of retraumatization. What actually happens to the brain and body when we're retraumatized? Why does it sometimes feel even more painful than the original event? Dr. Hensley walks us through the neurobiological process of retrauma, explaining how trauma is stored in the brain differently than typical memories—lodged in the amygdala and body rather than neatly filed in the hippocampus. So, when a familiar cue triggers that trauma, we often relive it with the same intensity as the original moment—except now it's stacked on years of previous pain. From a clinical and evolutionary perspective, Dr. Hensley explains how the human nervous system is wired to remember pain for survival. "When you've been traumatized over and over, especially in relationships or systems of power, your body becomes hypersensitive—it's not just hypervigilance; it's your body trying to keep you alive," she shares. The repeated trauma essentially short-circuits our ability to regulate emotions or assess danger accurately. The nervous system begins to perceive safety as foreign, and threat as familiar—especially when our trauma stems from people we loved or trusted. The conversation takes a personal turn as both Dr. Hensley and Raina open up about recent experiences of being retraumatized—Raina through an emotionally manipulative exchange with a co-parent, and Dr. Hensley through a recent betrayal that echoed a childhood wound. They both reflect on how these moments didn't just "remind" them of earlier traumas—they reactivated them, sparking physical symptoms like shaking, shutdown, and dissociation. These aren't overreactions—they're biological responses to perceived survival threats, and they're devastatingly real. The episode also links retrauma to insecure attachment patterns, especially those who find themselves in repeated dynamics with narcissistic or dismissive avoidant (DA) partners. "People with insecure attachment often unconsciously seek out what's familiar, not what's safe," Dr. Hensley explains. "That's how the retrauma cycle continues—we don't just remember pain, we recreate it." The cycle becomes especially dangerous when one's nervous system is so accustomed to chaos that anything resembling peace feels threatening. They discuss how the body learns to expect harm in love and how, without awareness and healing, retrauma becomes a repeating loop. Lastly, the episode ties into Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services's ongoing Family Court Series, highlighting the retraumatizing impact of legal systems. From both personal experience and client stories, Raina and Dr. Hensley reveal how courtrooms can become breeding grounds for PTSD—especially when survivors are forced to continually interact with their abusers, relive past harm, or defend their truth in a system that doesn't always protect them. Even the mere mention of court in a co-parenting text or email can trigger days of dysregulation and panic. This is a must-listen for anyone who's ever wondered why they "overreact" to certain people, places, or patterns—or why healing sometimes feels so hard. Dr. Hensley and Raina blend science with soul in an episode that's as validating as it is empowering.

## *Episode 6, Season 2: Due Process Denied: Inside the Broken Family Court System with Attorney Christine Miller*

Published: 01 Jul 2025

Episode 6, Season II | Family Court Series - "Due Process Denied: Inside the Broken Family Court System with Attorney Christine Miller" In this gripping and eye-opening episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley sits down with Christine Miller, a seasoned attorney turned fierce advocate for family court reform—and the visionary founder behind Judge-Y, a groundbreaking platform and upcoming app designed to bring transparency and accountability to the courtroom. Christine opens the episode by sharing her reaction to Meg Miller's heartbreaking case from last week's episode, shedding legal insight into how red flags were missed, due process was denied, and ultimately how false allegations and judicial oversight led to the unjust removal of Meg's children. Her analysis is not just professional—it's deeply personal, fueled by a passion for justice and firsthand knowledge of a broken system. Having practiced family law for years, Christine reveals what drew her into the courtroom—and what eventually pushed her out. She shares unfiltered truths about how the system is failing the very people it claims to protect, particularly children, who often become collateral damage in custody battles riddled with bias, lack of oversight, and limited accountability. What You'll Hear in This Episode: Why due process is almost non-existent in family court—and how judges often take the bench without reading motions or evidence How false allegations can lead to devastating outcomes with little recourse or protection Why perjury is rarely prosecuted, unlike in criminal court, leaving parents vulnerable to manipulation The financial exploitation of families through prolonged litigation, draining them emotionally and financially The urgent need for judicial accountability, and why Christine believes judges should be held to higher standards Dr. Hensley's powerful proposal: Should family court rulings be decided by a jury of 12 peers, just like in criminal court? Christine also introduces her trailblazing platform, Judge-Y—a public review system and upcoming app that provides families with access to verified information and firsthand experiences with local judges and attorneys. Judge-Y is built to empower families with knowledge and help prevent the kind of injustice that is currently far too common. As the episode concludes, Christine reminds us that a significant portion of the population will encounter the family court system, often walking away with little more than trauma, financial devastation, and fractured families. She lays out bold ideas for reform—because without systemic change, we are perpetuating a cycle of harm that echoes for generations. To connect with Christine Miller: YouTube: Its Miller Time Louisville Learn more or share your own story at Judge-Y

### *Episode 5, Season 2: Stripped: A Family Court Crisis With special guest Meg Miller from @standwithmeg*

Published: 24 Jun 2025

In the gripping and heart-wrenching first installment of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show Family Court Series, Dr. Sarah Hensley is joined by advocate and mother Meg Miller, founder of the movement and platform Stand with Meg, for a raw and unfiltered conversation about the hidden horrors of the U.S. family court system. This isn't just a discussion — it's an expos on the deeply rooted corruption that continues to devastate protective parents, especially survivors of abuse who turn to the system for help and are instead retraumatized, discredited, and often punished for speaking the truth. Meg shares her personal and still-unfolding journey, one that has left her emotionally, financially, and physically depleted. Despite doing what most would consider the "right" thing — seeking legal protection for her children from her abuser — she found herself on the receiving end of a system that silences and punishes victims. After years of legal warfare, Meg's five children were forcibly taken from her and placed in the custody of the very man she tried to protect them from. The pain is palpable. Her story is far from unique — it mirrors the experiences of countless women (and some men) who enter courtrooms hoping for justice and emerge broken, confused, and further victimized. Together, Dr. Hensley and Meg pull back the curtain on the disturbing pattern of custodial reversal, judicial bias, financial gatekeeping, and the dangerous misuse of parental alienation claims — all tools often weaponized against the protective parent. They also explore the ways in which family court proceedings are insulated from public accountability, allowing unethical practices to continue behind closed doors with little to no oversight or due process. This episode is not just about Meg's story. It is about the thousands of parents who have DM'd her, commented on her posts, and stood in solidarity under the hashtag — parents who are navigating the same heartbreaking system, terrified for their children's safety and feeling voiceless and unseen. It's about the culture of silence that surrounds the family court system, where even speaking out can put a parent at risk of losing everything. This conversation is as emotional as it is enraging — and it is a must-listen for anyone who has ever questioned why so many abuse victims hesitate to leave a marriage and go to court. Tune in to bear witness, to learn, and to stand with Meg — and for all those fighting silently for their children in a system that too often protects power over people, we see you, we hear you, and we speak for you! To support and follow Meg Miller find her on all social media platforms @standwithmeg and standwithmeg.com.

### *Episode 4, Season 2: What Can I Say? - (Buffer Episode)*

Published: 17 Jun 2025

In this deeply personal and unfiltered buffer episode, Dr. Hensley steps outside of the usual series format to speak her truth — not as a therapist or a coach, but as a woman, a wife, and a mother who has carried the weight of a private storm for far too long. After over a year of silent suffering, Dr. Hensley finally opens up about a painful and highly sensitive situation involving someone from her husband's past — someone who, in Dr. Hensley's words, "tried to break up my family." While protecting the identities of everyone involved, she lays bare the emotional toll of false allegations and the emotional warfare and pain that it causes. This episode isn't about gossip — it's about truth, healing, and power. For anyone who has ever been falsely accused…For anyone who's watched someone come for their family…For anyone who's had to choose peace over retaliation…This episode is for you. Dr. Hensley shares not only what happened, but what she learned — about herself, about forgiveness, about faith, and about the unshakable strength of her marriage. She's no longer staying silent. She's setting the record straight, not just for her own peace, but for every listener who's ever been hurt by false allegations and someone else's unresolved pain. Though she considered taking legal action, Dr. Hensley chose instead to protect her peace — and that of her family — knowing that true power is often in what you don't do. But she makes it clear: this was her grace-filled response the first time. If it happens again, her words are raw and unflinching — "I will go scorched earth." This emotional episode is more than a tell-all — it's a spiritual reset, a message of hope, and a call to rise above bitterness and let your pain become your platform. It's also a teaser for what's coming next — a new series that dives even deeper into the corruption that lies in certain legal systems. At its core, "What Can I Say" is a love letter to anyone who has ever been deeply wounded by someone who never took accountability — and a reminder that you can find peace, stand firm in your truth, and come out even stronger on the other side when someone deeply hurts you and your family. The overall message in this epsisode is: The truth always reveals itself. Forgiveness is not weakness — it's wisdom and freedom. And.....Love always wins!

### *Episode 3, Season 2: Sex & Intimacy Series: Spiritual Intimacy: The Missing Link in Modern Romance*

Published: 10 Jun 2025

In this deeply honest and soul-stirring episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley and Raina peel back the layers of what it truly means to be intimate—not just physically, but spiritually. In a world that often hyper-focuses on sexual chemistry and physical connection, they invite listeners into a conversation that challenges the status quo: that spiritual intimacy may be the true foundation of lasting love. With their signature blend of clinical insight, lived experience, and heartfelt faith, the hosts unpack why couples today are more disconnected than ever—despite being more sexually “liberated”—and how spiritual intimacy may be the missing link we’re all searching for. Drawing from Dr. Hensley’s personal walk with God and the spiritual bond that laid the groundwork for her own marriage, she shares how emotional and sexual intimacy became truly fulfilling only after she and her husband connected spiritually. Raina adds perspective on how her own partnership was radically transformed when she and her husband began prioritizing a higher purpose and shared values above all else. They candidly discuss how true spiritual intimacy starts with your individual relationship with the divine—however that may look for you—and expands outward into how you love, serve, and connect with your partner. They don’t shy away from the controversy, either. Why is it that so many modern couples resist bringing God or spirituality into their relationships? Is it fear of judgment, past religious trauma, or a misunderstanding of what "spiritual" even means in the context of love and sex? Dr. Hensley and Raina explore the resistance to spirit-centered connection and offer a reframed understanding of spirituality—not as a rigid doctrine, but as a living, breathing connection to purpose, vulnerability, and sacred partnership. They boldly affirm that for them, and countless others, God is the center of their love stories. As the Bible says in Ecclesiastes 4:12, “Though one may be overpowered, two can defend themselves. A cord of three strands is not quickly broken.” This episode offers practical and inclusive ways couples can cultivate spiritual intimacy—regardless of religious background. Yes, that might mean praying or reading scripture together, but it could also look like meditating side by side, having purpose-driven conversations, serving others together, co-creating goals aligned with shared values, or holding space in silence during moments of pain and doubt. It's about nurturing the soul of your relationship. Because sex, when detached from a sense of deeper meaning or higher connection, can feel empty or misaligned. But when intimacy is built on a spiritual foundation—rooted in mutual reverence, intention, and transcendence—it becomes something sacred. Tune in for an episode that may just change how you view intimacy forever. Whether you’re single, dating, or married, this conversation is a call back to the deeper connection you were created for, a spiritual one!

### *Episode 2, Season 2: Sex & Intimacy Series: Pleasure, Not Shame - STD Truths, Healing, and Sexual Empowerment with The Yoni Nutritionist*

Published: 03 Jun 2025

In this powerful and much-needed episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley is joined by a trailblazer in the world of sexual wellness—Adrienne, better known as The Yoni Nutritionist. As a vaginal health nutritionist and sexual health advocate, Adrienne specializes in helping women get to the root of chronic yeast infections and supports both women and men in understanding and managing herpes (HSV) and human papillomavirus (HPV) diagnoses with compassion, knowledge, and zero shame. Together, Dr. Hensley and Adrienne bust some of the biggest myths surrounding STIs and STDs—like the false belief that your sex life is over after a diagnosis or that these infections only happen to people who are “irresponsible.” Spoiler: they don’t, and it isn’t. With over two-thirds of the population carrying HSV-1 and a staggering number of individuals living with HPV unknowingly, it’s time we normalize the conversation around sexual health and stop tying our self-worth to a lab result. Adrienne walks us through what informed, empowered intimacy looks like after an STI/STD diagnosis. From navigating conversations with partners to understanding the role of nutrition and stress in flare-ups, this episode offers both emotional reassurance and practical steps. Whether you’re currently dealing with symptoms, supporting a partner, or simply want to learn more about your own body, this is the kind of sexual health education we all should have received. Listeners will also gain insight into the often-overlooked connection between the gut microbiome and vaginal health, and how dietary and lifestyle changes can play a significant role in both prevention and symptom management. Adrienne offers a refreshing, body-positive perspective that invites us to release shame, reclaim our sexual agency, and embrace the truth: having an STI or STD does not make you “damaged goods.” You are still fully worthy of love, desire, and pleasure. You won’t want to miss this incredibly affirming and informative conversation. To connect with Adrienne and learn more about her work, visit her at www.yoninutritionist.com or follow her on Instagram or TikTok at @yoninutritionist.

### *Episode 1, Season 2: Sex & Intimacy Series: Attachment in the Sheets*

Published: 27 May 2025

Welcome to Season II of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show with Dr. Sarah Hensley, kicking off with a powerful new series: Sex and Intimacy. In this opening episode, “Attachment in the Sheets,” Dr. Hensley dives headfirst into how our attachment styles show up behind closed doors — and why understanding these patterns can completely shift the way we experience sexual connection. Dr. Hensley begins by unpacking the anxious-preoccupied (AP) attachment style in the realm of sex. APs are often the chameleons of intimacy, hyper-attuned to their partner’s needs and desires but rarely in touch with their own. Their deepest fear of abandonment can lead them to override personal boundaries, agree to things that don’t feel good, or mold their sexual expression entirely around what they think their partner wants. This form of self-abandonment might feel like love or closeness in the moment, but it slowly erodes the AP’s internal sense of safety and sexual autonomy. Next, the fearful-avoidant (FA) style takes center stage — a deeply complex and often contradictory experience in the bedroom. FAs may begin with high emotional awareness and sensitivity to their own needs and desires, but that clarity can quickly get hijacked by old patterns of fear of betrayal or fear of vulnerability. For some, especially after trust has been broken, physical intimacy becomes a place of shutdown. Others may still engage sexually, while emotionally checking out, using physical closeness to mask the deeper disconnection they feel inside. Lastly, Dr. Hensley explores the dismissive-avoidant (DA) style — often the most misunderstood when it comes to sex. For many DAs, sex becomes the one “acceptable” avenue for intimacy, even though emotional vulnerability remains off-limits. This creates a paradox: they may initiate or enjoy sex, but still struggle to feel safe, connected, or fully present. Alternatively, DAs may avoid sex entirely, perceiving it as another emotional demand or pressure they’re unwilling — or feel unable — to meet. Throughout the episode, Dr. Hensley weaves in the science of what’s happening in the body — including key hormonal responses that men and women experience during and after sex, such as the bonding power of oxytocin and the physiological patterns of stress and arousal. She emphasizes that without emotional safety and secure attachment, our sexual experiences can easily become performative, disconnected, or fraught with unmet needs. This episode is an invitation to reframe how we view sex — not just as an act, but as an emotional experience shaped by our history, attachment wiring, and our ability to feel seen, safe, and truly wanted. If you’ve ever wondered why intimacy can feel so difficult at times — this episode is a must-listen.

### *Stay Tuned for Season 2*

Published: 20 May 2025

Hey y'all! We decided to take a week off between the end of Season I and the begining of Season II. Stay tuned for next week's new series on sex and intimacy where we will have some special guest. We are so excited to start season II with fresh ideas and new perspective! Love you guys!

### *Episode 52, Season 1: The Little Ways We Show Up for Our Partners*

Published: 13 May 2025

Episode 52 – The Little Ways We Show Up for Our Partners This episode explores one of the most powerful yet often overlooked truths in romantic relationships: it’s the small, consistent acts of connection that build true intimacy. Dr. Sarah Hensley breaks down how everyday micro-moments—like offering a kind word, turning toward your partner when they speak, or expressing gratitude for ordinary tasks—become the building blocks of lasting emotional closeness. Rooted in psychological science and attachment theory, Dr. Hensley explains how emotional bonds are formed and strengthened through quiet, consistent presence rather than grand, infrequent gestures. These subtle interactions—what we choose to notice, how we respond, and the tone we use—send powerful signals of care, attunement, and respect. When these small moments are neglected, emotional distance grows, often without either partner realizing it. Listeners will gain a deeper understanding of how love is shaped in the moment-to-moment choices we make in daily life. The success of a relationship doesn’t hinge on extravagant efforts, but on the willingness to show up in the “now”—especially when it’s inconvenient or uncomfortable. Ultimately, The Little Ways We Show Up for Our Partners is a powerful reminder that love is reciprocal. It’s the accumulation of everyday choices—done with intention—that fosters lasting connection, emotional safety, and relational success. Ultimately, The Little Ways We Show Up for Our Partners is a powerful reminder that love is reciprocal. It’s not built in the highlight reels—it’s built in the in-between. In the everyday. And when both partners learn to consistently show up for each other in these little ways, the relationship doesn’t just survive—it thrives.

## *Episode 51, Season 1: The High Cost of Low Standards*

Published: 06 May 2025

Episode 51 – The High Cost of Low Standards In this deeply personal and powerful episode, Dr. Sarah Hensley explores a truth most of us don't want to admit but absolutely need to hear: settling for less than we deserve in our romantic lives doesn't just hurt emotionally—it impacts us psychologically, physically, and even spiritually. "The High Cost of Low Standards" isn't just about dating someone who doesn't check every box. It's about the real toll relational self-abandonment takes on our nervous system, our self-worth, and our ability to thrive. Dr. Hensley dives into the science of relational trauma, sharing how repeatedly tolerating disrespect, inconsistency, or emotional unavailability can lead to chronic stress responses in the body. Elevated cortisol, sleep disturbances, and even autoimmune flare-ups are common for clients who've lived for years in relationships that keep them in a perpetual state of anxiety. You'll hear relatable examples from both host who developed digestive issues, hormonal imbalances, and chronic fatigue—all stemming from the emotional labor of loving someone who wasn't loving them back. Both of them still struggling after almost ten years of deep dived healing work. Research from the fields of psychoneuroimmunology and attachment science backs this up: unhealthy relationships literally make us sick. Dr. Hensley breaks down how unresolved attachment wounds, particularly from childhood, can subconsciously condition us to lower the bar and internalize the belief that bare minimum is all we're worthy of. She speaks candidly about how early templates of love—whether from an emotionally immature parent or a chaotic home environment—can train our nervous systems to find familiarity in dysfunction. And when we don't heal those internal blueprints, we keep recreating them in adult partnerships, confusing chaos for chemistry and silence for safety. As always, Dr. Hensley ends with both compassion and a call to action. You are never stuck. Your nervous system may be wired for survival, but it can be rewired for secure love. You can raise your standards without fear of losing connection—because what's truly meant for you won't be threatened by your growth. Whether you've been chronically undervalued or simply unsure how to ask for more, this episode will remind you: it's not too late to choose better. Healing is available, and so is the kind of love that doesn't cost you your peace.

## *Episode 50, Season 1: Healing from the Emotionally Immature Parent*

Published: 29 Apr 2025

Episode 50: Healing from the Emotionally Immature Parent In this milestone 50th episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley opens with a candid observation she's seen time and time again in her coaching practice: setting boundaries with emotionally immature parents—or in-laws—can feel even more excruciating than setting them with a romantic partner. Why? Because the first place we ever learned about love, safety, and connection was at home. And when the very people who were supposed to nurture our emotional needs couldn't meet us where we were, it doesn't just wound our childhoods—it quietly bleeds into how we love, trust, and show up in our adult relationships. Dr. Hensley breaks down the deep psychological impact that growing up with an emotionally stunted parent can have. It can create chronic self-doubt, hypervigilance, an unstable sense of self-worth, and a blueprint of attachment where emotional neglect feels "normal." Many of us unconsciously seek romantic partners who mirror the emotional patterns we grew up with—partners who are distant, unavailable, or inconsistent—because it's the only intimacy our nervous system recognizes. Without realizing it, we are often trying to "finish the story" with someone else that was left incomplete by our earliest caregivers. In a deeply personal segment, Sarah and her cohost Raina share their own raw stories: Sarah's painful experience navigating a relationship with an emotionally immature father, and Raina's difficult upbringing with a mother who was emotionally unstable due to her own unhealed trauma. They open up about how these early wounds shaped the choices they made in their first romantic relationships—often chasing emotional closeness where it was chronically withheld. They also reflect on how these experiences made them fiercely intentional about how they parent today, choosing to break the cycles of emotional disconnection by offering the attunement and presence they didn't always receive themselves. But healing from these wounds isn't just about recognizing the past; it's about actively choosing to reparent yourself. Dr. Hensley explains that "reparenting" means becoming the steady, loving caregiver to your own inner child—the one who was ignored, invalidated, or left to navigate big emotions alone. Through conscious practices of self-compassion, emotional validation, boundary setting, and nurturing rituals, you can literally rewire your attachment system. Inner child work, Dr. Hensley explains, is about meeting yourself in those abandoned spaces—learning to sit with your unmet needs rather than running from them, and offering yourself the empathy, care, and consistency you deserved all along. If this episode resonates deeply with you—if you recognize yourself in these patterns and you're ready to stop letting old wounds dictate your present relationships—Dr. Hensley invites you to explore Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services's coaching programs and resources. Healing is possible, and it begins with the brave decision to show up for yourself in a way no one else ever could. Rebuilding your emotional foundation through reparenting and inner child work isn't just transformational—it's the first step toward the secure, fulfilling love you were always worthy of.

## *Episode 49, Season 1: Work/Relationship Balance with Special Guest Josee Tremblay, Author of "Us and Yet and Yet"*

Published: 22 Apr 2025

Episode 49: Work/Relationship Balance with Special Guest: Josee Tremblay, Author of Us and Yet and Yet In this powerful episode, Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher sit down with special guest Josee Tremblay, a mechanical engineer and author of Us and Yet and Yet, to discuss one of the most common but rarely addressed struggles in modern relationships—how to strike a healthy balance between work and intimacy. Josee shares her journey as a woman navigating a male-dominated industry and how her career led her to a deeper understanding of feminine and masculine energies within romantic partnerships. Her personal experiences inspired her to write a book that speaks directly to high-achieving women who feel the strain of “doing it all” and crave a better connection with their partners at home. The conversation dives into how career-driven women—especially those in high-stress, high-performance roles—often find themselves stuck in masculine energy even after they clock out. Josee, Dr. Hensley, and Raina all reflect on how they’ve had to intentionally shift into their feminine energy in their personal lives to create space for their partners to naturally step into their masculine roles. Dr. Hensley explains how this energetic polarity is essential to maintaining desire, harmony, and emotional connection in long-term relationships. The episode highlights the subtle but significant ways that career ambition, daily responsibilities, and over-functioning behaviors can affect the relational dynamic. Josee also brings depth to the conversation by exploring the archetypes she covers in her book, shedding light on how different energy patterns and identities show up in relationships. Whether it’s the Overachiever, the Perfectionist, or the Self-Sacrificing Giver, each archetype holds insight into how we unconsciously operate when under stress or pressure. Dr. Hensley connects this framework to attachment theory, highlighting how dismissive avoidants in particular—whether male or female—struggle the most with balancing work and relational life. She explains that DAs often turn to work, tasks, or hobbies as a way to feel effective, valued, and in control—especially when emotional intimacy feels vulnerable or unsafe. This can manifest in surprising ways, such as a stay-at-home mom who over-schedules the kids to avoid deeper connection with her partner. Throughout the episode, listeners are encouraged to reflect on their own patterns and consider how attachment styles, emotional wounds, and internalized beliefs about productivity impact their relationships. Dr. Hensley emphasizes that healing begins with self-awareness—and that shifting from “doing” to “being” is a powerful act of love, both for ourselves and our partners. Whether you’re a high-powered professional, an entrepreneur, or someone simply juggling the demands of life and love, this conversation will leave you with tangible insights on how to show up more present, connected, and whole in your relationship.

### *Episode 48, Season 1: The Vagus Nerve*

Published: 15 Apr 2025

Episode 48: The Vagus Nerve In this powerful and informative episode, Dr. Sarah Hensley unpacks one of the most essential—yet often overlooked—players in our healing journey: the vagus nerve. As a social psychologist and attachment expert, Dr. Hensley explains how the vagus nerve functions as the primary communication superhighway between the brain and body, deeply influencing our emotional regulation, sense of safety, and ability to connect with others. She breaks down the science in an accessible, real-world way—helping listeners understand why a dysregulated nervous system keeps them stuck in survival mode, attracting unhealthy patterns and perpetuating attachment wounds. Dr. Hensley dives into the role the vagus nerve plays in attachment and trauma, especially for those with insecure styles like anxious-preoccupied, dismissive-avoidant, and fearful-avoidant. When we've experienced relational trauma—whether through emotional neglect, inconsistency, or outright betrayal—our nervous system becomes hypervigilant. The vagus nerve responds by defaulting into fight, flight, freeze, or fawn states, often without us realizing it. That's why you might feel a "gut instinct" to run or shut down in the presence of intimacy, or why calmness can feel foreign after years of chaos. Dr. Hensley explains how we cannot simply "think" our way into secure attachment—we must regulate our way there, starting with the body. Throughout the episode, listeners are guided through practical, research-backed ways to tone and stimulate the vagus nerve. From cold exposure and deep diaphragmatic breathing to humming, prayer, laughter, and safe eye contact—Dr. Hensley outlines exercises that create real shifts in the nervous system over time. She emphasizes that healing is not a linear path of "just letting go" or "getting over it"—it's a deep reconnection with your body's felt sense of safety. She also shares how vagal tone is essential in being able to pause, reflect, and choose differently in moments of relational trigger—rather than spiraling into panic, protest, or withdrawal. If you've ever wondered why healing feels so hard—or how to finally feel safe in love—this episode is your science-meets-soul roadmap.

### *Episode 47, Season 1: The Law of Attraction*

Published: 08 Apr 2025

Episode 47: The Law of Attraction In this soul-stirring episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley dives deep into the often-misunderstood concept of the Law of Attraction—unpacking it not only through the lens of her professional and personal experience, but also through her unwavering faith. Dr. Hensley opens the episode by grounding the conversation in her personal belief: that true, positive attraction begins with God. She welcomes listeners of all beliefs into the discussion, offering a space of inclusion and openness for anyone curious about how the Law of Attraction really works—and how it aligns with both science and faith. The Intersection of Faith and Physics Dr. Hensley explores how the Law of Attraction is deeply connected to Christianity and even supported by principles in quantum physics. On a quantum level, the human body and mind operate not just as passive observers but as active participants in shaping reality. She explains how, at a cellular level, we must believe wholeheartedly in the reality we want to experience—because that deep, internal conviction is what draws it to us. The energy we emit—through thoughts, feelings, and beliefs—resonates outward and co-creates our lives with God. From a Christian perspective, this energetic alignment mirrors what Scripture teaches: "As a man thinks in his heart, so is he" (Proverbs 23:7). Faith, in its truest form, is not passive hoping—it's believing in what's unseen as if it's already done. Rooted in God's Will Throughout the episode, both Dr. Hensley and her co-host Raina affirm that while the Law of Attraction is a powerful principle, its full strength is only realized when it's aligned with God's will. They believe wholeheartedly that God wants good things for your life—and when your desires align with His divine plan, the universe conspires to make them happen. Receiving the Blessing But attraction isn't just about thinking positive thoughts—it's also about being open to receive. Dr. Hensley discusses how we can unknowingly block blessings due to fear, doubt, or a subconscious belief that we're not worthy. Sometimes, the only thing standing between us and the miracle is our own resistance. The Power of Surrender and Perspective A key takeaway from this episode is the transformative power of surrender. True manifestation often comes in the letting go—when we release the need to control outcomes and instead trust in divine timing. Dr. Hensley invites listeners to move from a "What if the worst happens?" mindset to one of Even if. Even if things don't go the way we planned… Even if we experience loss or heartbreak… Even if we're in the midst of pain… We are still worthy. Still capable. Still divinely supported. This episode is a beautiful blend of science, spirituality, and psychology, offering encouragement for anyone who wants to attract abundance, love, peace, and purpose into their life—without losing sight of God's guiding hand. Tune in and learn how to co-create your life with faith, trust, and divine alignment.

### *Episode 46, Season 1: Meet Our Husbands*

Published: 01 Apr 2025

Episode 46: Meet Our Husbands In this special and heartfelt episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher introduce their listeners to two very important people in their lives—their husbands, Donald and Josh. Josh, Raina's husband, was a self-proclaimed perpetual bachelor. Neither he nor Raina had been married before, and they didn't tie the knot until they met in their 40s. Donald, Dr. Hensley's husband, had a different journey—having been married twice before. Despite their contrasting paths, both men had one thing in common: they had grown comfortable with independence and navigating life on their own terms. They both attirbuted to being able to find thier secure attachement through being comfortable being alone. During this candid conversation, Donald opens up about how his military service shaped both his struggles and his personal growth. Meanwhile, Josh shares how his experiences out west as a cowboy played a significant role in his emotional development. The couples also discuss the unique dynamics of their marriages—how they manage the demands of modern life, complex schedules, and blended families. Dr. Hensley and Donald talk about raising a household of children in what they call a modern-day Brady Bunch scenario, while Raina and Josh reflect on merging their lives, with Josh stepping into a marriage where Raina already had a son. This episode gives listeners an intimate glimpse into the real-life relationships of Dr. Hensley and Raina, highlighting the beauty and challenges of love, family, and commitment. They hope that by sharing their personal journeys, listeners will find reassurance that navigating modern relationships isn't always easy—but through patience, understnading, and showing each other grace marriage can be joyful, inspiring, and the ultimate relationship for personal growth.

### *Episode 45, Season 1: The Drop*

Published: 25 Mar 2025

Episode 45: The Drop In this deeply personal and reflective episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley explores "The Drop"—the inevitable moments in life when, after reaching great heights, we find ourselves falling back down. Inspired by the song The Drop by Forrest Frank, this episode delves into what it truly means to rise to success, only to be met with unexpected setbacks, challenges, and even betrayals. More importantly, Dr. Hensley unpacks how we handle these moments with humility, grace, and resilience. Dr. Hensley shares her own journey of rising to the top—how success can make it easy to be kind, loving, and open-hearted. But she also reminds listeners that no one is immune to life's trials, and 2024 tested her in ways she never expected. She opens up about a personal legal battle involving someone who intentionally harmed her family, as well as the devastating news that her mother's cancer has returned after nearly five years in remission. She speaks candidly about how these experiences deeply affected her and her family, and how easy it would be to let pain turn into bitterness. But Dr. Hensley emphasizes that suffering—while inevitable—does not have to define us. She challenges the common "white-knuckle approach" to hardship, where people try to fight through suffering by suppressing emotions, hardening their hearts, and carrying resentment. This, she explains, only makes the pain worse, as it places unnecessary stress on the nervous system and fuels a cycle of anger and defensiveness. Midway through the episode, Dr. Hensley shares a profound shift in perspective that changed her life: Instead of living in the fear of "What if?", she learned to embrace the mindset of "Even if." • What if the worst happens? -> Fear, anxiety, and suffering. • Even if the worst happens, I will stay faithful, calm, and gracious. This shift, she explains, allowed her to let go of fear and control, and instead trust that even in hardship, there is purpose, healing, and grace. As the episode closes, Dr. Hensley leaves listeners with a powerful reminder: Yes, suffering is part of life. Yes, the drop can feel unfair and even cruel. But it doesn't last forever. And more importantly, it shapes us, humbles us, and reminds us of the joy that comes from overcoming challenges with integrity and faith. If you find yourself in a drop—whether it's personal loss, betrayal, or a sudden setback—you are not alone. Healing is possible, and Dr. Hensley would be honored to be a resource in your journey. This episode is a must-listen for anyone navigating hardship and seeking a faith-driven, compassionate approach to resilience.

### *Episode 44, Season 1: How to Show Up as the Best Version of Your Most Authentic Self*

Published: 18 Mar 2025

Episode 44: – Showing Up as the Best Version of Your Most Authentic Self In this episode, Dr. Hensley explores what it truly means to be authentic—what authenticity is, what it is not, and how to cultivate it. She emphasizes that before we can fully show up as our authentic selves, we must first confront and understand our shadow self and suppressed traits. Dr. Hensley explains how our ability to be authentic starts with the messages we receive from caregivers in childhood. From a young age, we are taught which emotions and traits are acceptable and which should be hidden or suppressed. These early lessons shape how we navigate relationships and self-expression as adults. Next, she delves into how different insecure attachment styles suppress certain emotions, impacting their ability to be authentic, sometimes leading to poor relationship patterns. A major part of healing involves recognizing these suppressed traits without shame and allowing oneself to express them freely. Faith plays a significant role in this process, and Dr. Hensley shares her personal struggles with expressing certain traits. She opens up about how God's grace and mercy have helped her work through feelings of shame and embrace her true self. A key highlight of this episode is the perpetual people-pleaser, who struggles the most with authenticity. People-pleasers often self-abandon to maintain peace, suppressing their true needs and emotions. Dr. Hensley explains that the foundation of authenticity lies in self-trust and building a strong relationship with oneself. Toward the end, she discusses how boundaries are essential for authenticity. She shares a real-life example from her marriage, illustrating how she has learned to embrace her authentic self without guilt or fear. This episode is a must-listen for anyone struggling to show up as their authentic self. If you're ready to step into authenticity, Dr. Hensley's services can guide you on this journey. Visit Dr. Hensley's website at thelovedoc.com (now active)

### *Episode 43, Season 1: If They Don't Want to be Kept, Don't Keep 'Em*

Published: 11 Mar 2025

In Episode 43 of "Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services" podcast, titled "If They Don't Want to Be Kept, Don't Keep 'Em," Dr. Hensley delves into the common question she receives from clients: "How do I get my partner to [fill in the blank]?" She emphasizes that attempting to change a partner is futile and that true emotional security comes from recognizing that the only person one can change is oneself. Key Discussion Points: 1. Losing Oneself in the Effort to Change a Partner: She warns against the dangers of contorting oneself to induce change in a partner, often leading to a loss of personal identity and autonomy. This behavior can result in emotional exhaustion and dissatisfaction. 2. The Fallacy of Loving Someone Enough to Change Them: Dr. Hensley addresses the misconception that one can love someone into changing. She asserts that change must come from within an individual who is ready and willing; external pressure is ineffective and can be detrimental. 3. Coercion vs. Genuine Expression of Love: Attempting to force or manipulate a partner into meeting one's needs is not a true expression of love. Authentic love respects autonomy and encourages voluntary, mutual effort in the relationship. 4. Recognizing When a Partner Is Not Capable of Commitment: Dr. Hensley emphasizes the importance of acknowledging when a partner consistently demonstrates an inability or unwillingness to commit. Persisting in such situations leads to frustration and hinders personal growth. Subconscious Manipulation and Emotional Exhaustion: The episode delves into the subconscious manipulation involved in trying to retain a partner who is unwilling or unable to meet one's needs. This dynamic leads to emotional exhaustion and disrupts the nervous system, fostering dysfunction and instability in the relationship. Attachment Styles and the Push-Pull Dynamic: Dr. Hensley explores attachment styles, particularly the fearful-avoidant and dismissive-avoidant pairings, where push-pull dynamics are prevalent: • Fearful-Avoidant Attachment: Characterized by a desire for intimacy coupled with a fear of getting hurt, leading to ambivalence and mistrust in relationships. • Dismissive-Avoidant Attachment: Marked by a preference for independence and discomfort with closeness, resulting in emotional distance and a tendency to withdraw from partners. When individuals with these attachment styles pair together, a cyclical pattern of pursuing and distancing ensues, creating instability and dissatisfaction. Advice for Breaking the Cycle: Towards the end of the episode, Dr. Hensley offers guidance for those trapped in unfulfilling dynamics: • Toxic Hope: Recognize and release the unrealistic expectation that a partner will change, which perpetuates unhealthy attachment and prolongs suffering. • Radical Acceptance: Embrace the reality of the situation without resistance, acknowledging that one cannot control or change another's behavior. These concepts and more are elaborated upon in her new breakup course (now live and ready for purchse) , designed to help individuals cultivate inner safety and trust in their decision-making, empowering them to leave relationships that do not serve their well-being. Visit Dr. Hensley's website at thelovedoc.com (now active)

## *Episode 42, Season 1: Navigating Divorce*

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Episode 42 – How to Navigate Divorce In this powerful episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley takes a deep dive into one of the most difficult and life-altering experiences a person can face—divorce. With compassion, insight, and real-life experience from coaching hundreds of clients, she offers a roadmap for navigating the process in the healthiest way possible. When Is Divorce Acceptable? Dr. Hensley begins the episode by addressing a critical question: When is divorce justified? She makes it clear that while every marriage has challenges, certain circumstances—such as infidelity, emotional abuse, physical abuse, and neglect—are valid and acceptable reasons to leave a marriage. However, she also emphasizes that nothing in this episode should be taken as legal advice; instead, she shares wisdom based on her personal experience and extensive coaching work. Step 1: Accepting Your Partner's Decision One of the first steps in navigating divorce is accepting your partner's boundary if they have filed for divorce. Dr. Hensley stresses the importance of expressing your feelings openly and compassionately—whether or not you want the divorce—without becoming needy, pushy, or anxious. This approach allows for open communication and ensures that divorce isn't being used as a mere threat. Step 2: Creating Emotional and Physical Space She then explores the importance of creating both emotional and physical distance. This space provides clarity, helping individuals truly understand what life will be like post-divorce. By stepping back, people can gain perspective on whether they are seeking reconciliation out of genuine desire or simply fearing change. Step 3: Understanding the Legal Process A major portion of the episode is dedicated to the legal aspects of divorce. Dr. Hensley underscores the importance of securing a strong attorney and thoroughly understanding state-specific divorce and custody laws. She encourages listeners to seek individual legal counsel—even in seemingly amicable divorces—because legal protection is crucial in navigating financial and custody matters. Step 4: Communication During Divorce Dr. Hensley provides actionable strategies for communication during the divorce process. She explains how to maintain open dialogue without overstepping boundaries and gives specific language that can help avoid unnecessary conflict. She also discusses the challenges of co-parenting and offers guidance on ensuring children feel emotionally supported throughout the transition. Can a Marriage Be Saved? Halfway through the episode, Dr. Hensley shifts gears to discuss cases where marriages have been salvaged from the brink of divorce. She shares success stories from her coaching program, illustrating how the tools she teaches can help couples reconnect and repair their relationships. She also provides a realistic timeline for seeing meaningful change when both partners commit to the work. Attachment Styles and Divorce Next, Dr. Hensley examines how different attachment styles handle divorce—and where each one typically goes wrong: • Anxious-preoccupied individuals may cling to the relationship, struggle with self-worth, and resist letting go. • Dismissive avoidants may shut down emotionally, minimize the pain, and attempt to move on too quickly. • Fearful avoidants often experience inner conflict, cycling between wanting connection and pushing their partner away. She offers targeted advice for each attachment style, helping listeners recognize their patterns and make healthier choices during this transition. Breaking Free from Trauma Bonds One of the most challenging aspects of divorce is severing a trauma bond—especially in toxic or abusive relationships. Dr. Hensley outlines a key strategy she teaches in her coaching program: • Practicing radical acceptance of the situation. • Immersing oneself in the truth by writing out relationship issues and reading them daily. By consistently reinforcing reality, individuals can shift their mindset and begin the process of emotional detachment. Should You Wait Before Divorcing? For those who feel uncertain, Dr. Hensley advises taking true inventory of the relationship for 3 to 6 months before making a final decision. She stresses the importance of focusing on personal growth and reaching secure attachment before deciding whether divorce is truly the right path. Final Thoughts: The Legal and Emotional Reality of Divorce Dr. Hensley concludes the episode by revisiting the legal complexities of divorce, reiterating how critical it is to protect oneself legally—especially when children are involved. She acknowledges that divorce often brings out the worst in people, making legal representation essential. She also reminds listeners that while divorce is painful, it can also be an opportunity for renewal. Divorce as a New Beginning Dr. Hensley leaves listeners with a hopeful message: Divorce, while painful, is not the end—it's a blank canvas. It is a chance to rebuild, rediscover personal identity, and create a life aligned with one's values and desires. Though the process may be difficult, it also brings the possibility of newfound freedom, growth, and ultimately, happiness. This episode provides a compassionate, insightful, and practical guide for anyone navigating divorce—whether they are in the midst of it, contemplating it, or trying to heal from it.

## *Episode 41, Season 1: Friendship in Your Forties*

Published: 25 Feb 2025

Episode 41: Friendship in Your Forties Friendship, like any other relationship, can be complex to navigate—especially as you grow, heal, and move toward attachment security. In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher take a deep dive into how friendships evolve once you've reached emotional security, why some friendships don't survive, and what true friendship really looks like. While the title suggests a focus on friendships in your 40s, this episode is relevant for anyone, regardless of age, because friendship dynamics shift as we mature, heal, and redefine our boundaries. How Friendships Change with Attachment Security Dr. Hensley explains that once you achieve attachment security, your standards for friendship change. You become more intentional about the relationships you maintain, prioritizing mutual respect, peace, and personal growth. She breaks down what you will and won't stand for in friendships once you've reached this level of emotional health, including: • Setting Boundaries – You no longer tolerate one-sided friendships, lack of reciprocity, or emotional drain. • A No-Drama Policy – You disengage from gossip, toxicity, and unnecessary conflict. • Caring Less About What Others Think – You prioritize your inner peace over external validation. • Protecting Your Peace at All Costs – You release friendships that feel heavy, draining, or unsupportive. Personal Experiences & People-Pleasing in Friendships Both Dr. Hensley and Raina open up about friendships they've lost after achieving attachment security. Raina shares that she's still struggling with people-pleasing tendencies in her friendships, and Dr. Hensley helps her unpack the root cause—attachment wounds that make it hard to say no or risk losing connection. Dr. Hensley emphasizes that true friendship isn't about sacrificing your well-being to keep others happy. Instead, secure friendships allow for honesty, mutual respect, and space for each person to grow. The Evolution of Their Own Friendship Dr. Hensley and Raina reflect on how their own friendship has deepened as they've both grown in emotional security. What started as a friendship built on common interests has transformed into something much deeper—rooted in trust, honesty, and emotional safety. Dr. Hensley shares how, before reaching attachment security, she relied on a "Rolodex" of friends to vent to or help soothe her emotions. Now, using the self-regulation tools she teaches in her coaching practice, she no longer seeks friendships as a form of emotional outsourcing. Instead, she views friendship as a space for mutual support and respect, rather than an emotional dumping ground. Why Friendships End When One Person Becomes Secure One of the most eye-opening parts of the conversation is how friendships can mirror romantic relationships. Dr. Hensley explains that just like in romantic relationships, friendships often break down when one person becomes attachment secure and the other remains stuck in insecurity. She and Raina discuss a hard truth: • Some friendships don't end because of conflict; they end because one person grows and the other doesn't. • Not all friends want to see you succeed. True friendship isn't just about supporting someone in hard times; it's also about celebrating their wins without jealousy or resentment. Friendship Among Men & Friendships Lost in Divorce Dr. Hensley also touches on the unique struggles men face in maintaining friendships later in life. She explains that: • Men often struggle with emotional depth in friendships compared to women. • Many male friendships are activity-based, making it harder to find deep, emotionally secure friendships. • Divorce often leads to friendship losses, as mutual friends take sides or the shifting dynamic makes maintaining friendships more complicated. God's Role in Friendship & Letting Go As always, Dr. Hensley brings faith into the conversation, sharing how God's friendship has shaped her life. She acknowledges that God has both brought friendships into her life and removed others for her greater good. In the end, she encourages listeners to embrace the seasons of friendship—some friends are meant for a chapter, while others are meant for a lifetime. By letting go of friendships that no longer serve you, you create space for those that bring true peace, connection, and joy. Final Takeaway Friendships will evolve as you do. If you're healing, growing, and becoming more secure, it's natural for some friendships to shift, fade, or even end. But the friendships that remain—the ones built on mutual respect, trust, and joy—are the ones worth keeping. This episode is a must-listen for anyone navigating friendship changes at any stage of life. Whether you're redefining your boundaries, struggling with people-pleasing, or learning how to cultivate secure, meaningful friendships, Dr. Hensley and Raina's insights will help you approach friendship with clarity, confidence, and peace.

## *Episode 40, Season 1: The Bright Side of Suffering*

Published: 18 Feb 2025

The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show – Episode 40: "The Bright Side of Suffering." In this transformative episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley explores one of the most difficult yet essential aspects of the human experience—suffering. Rather than something to fear or avoid, she reframes suffering as a necessary force for growth, resilience, and transformation—but only if we allow it to serve that purpose. Why Do Some People Break While Others Rise? The Science of Suffering Dr. Hensley begins the episode by addressing a fundamental question: Why do some people experience post-traumatic stress while others experience post-traumatic growth? She discusses the psychological and neurological factors that determine whether suffering will lead to breakdown or breakthrough.She highlights a study that examined two different therapeutic approaches for trauma survivors: Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT): A structured, problem-focused therapy that helps individuals change negative thought patterns. Positive Psychological Interventions (PPI): A strengths-based approach that focuses on resilience, finding meaning in suffering, and reframing challenges in a positive light. The study revealed that individuals who underwent PPI showed greater post-traumatic growth compared to those who only engaged in CBT. This is because PPIs encourage individuals to see their pain as part of a bigger picture, whereas CBT primarily focuses on managing symptoms. Faith and the Power of Redemption in Suffering As the episode progresses, Dr. Hensley shares a deeply personal perspective on suffering—one rooted in faith. She explains how her own hardships have been catalysts for spiritual growth, helping her develop deeper trust and surrender.She reflects on the suffering of Christ, emphasizing that His sacrifice was the ultimate example of how pain can lead to redemption. Through faith, suffering can take on a greater purpose, allowing people to transcend their pain rather than be defined by it. The Role of Community in Healing Dr. Hensley stresses that healing from suffering is not meant to be done alone. She explores the importance of community and connection, explaining how isolation often prolongs suffering while healthy relationships create a safe space for healing and transformation. Whether through friendships, support groups, or spiritual communities, surrounding oneself with understanding and uplifting people can make all the difference. Attachment Styles and How They Influence Healing At the midpoint of the episode, Dr. Hensley shifts the discussion to attachment theory, explaining how different attachment styles process and cope with suffering: Anxious Attachment: Those with an anxious attachment style often get stuck in victimhood, replaying their pain and seeking validation to soothe their wounds. They struggle with letting go and moving forward. Avoidant Attachment: On the other hand, avoidant individuals tend to suppress and dismiss their suffering, refusing to acknowledge their pain. They may appear strong on the outside but often struggle with deep emotional disconnect. Dr. Hensley shares specific strategies for each attachment style to help them move through suffering in a healthier way. Somatic Healing: Moving Through Suffering with the Body One of the most crucial parts of healing, Dr. Hensley explains, is not just feeling emotions, but actually processing them through the body. She introduces somatic healing techniques—practices that help release stored trauma and emotions physically, since emotions are "energy in motion."She shares different methods to create safety in the body, including: Breathwork to regulate the nervous system Grounding exercises to reconnect with the present moment Movement-based practices like yoga, shaking, or dance to release stored emotional energy Dr. Hensley emphasizes that growth from suffering requires more than intellectual processing—it requires physical release and transformation. The Difference Between Therapy and Coaching in Healing As the episode nears its conclusion, Dr. Hensley breaks down the key differences between therapy and coaching when it comes to healing from suffering: Therapy: Primarily focuses on processing past trauma, offering a safe space to understand and work through emotions. Coaching: Takes a prescriptive and action-oriented approach, providing concrete tools to change behavior and rewire neural pathways for long-term transformation. Dr. Hensley explains that while therapy is invaluable for understanding pain, coaching is essential for creating real, lasting change—helping individuals take proactive steps toward rewiring their mindset, behaviors, and emotional responses. Final Takeaway: Growth is a Choice Dr. Hensley wraps up the episode with a powerful message: "Suffering is inevitable, but what you do with it is up to you. Will you let it break you, or will you let it build you into the highest version of yourself?" This episode is both deeply personal and profoundly practical, providing listeners with the tools, insights, and inspiration to embrace suffering as a stepping stone to greatness.

## *Episode 39, Season 1: The Tik Tok Ban: Part II*

Published: 11 Feb 2025

In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley expands on the ongoing TikTok ban debate, following the discussion from episode 37, when the ban was still pending. A lot has changed in a short time—including a dark period where TikTok temporarily disappeared—leaving creators, businesses, and everyday users in a state of uncertainty. Dr. Hensley begins by breaking down the Supreme Court ruling, expressing her surprise at how quickly the decision was made. She argues that the ruling did not fully consider the economic impact of losing TikTok, both directly for content creators and indirectly for businesses that rely on the platform for marketing. She also highlights which senators are currently working on legislative measures to protect TikTok, emphasizing their efforts to prevent the U.S. economy from suffering due to a potential ban. Dr. Hensley then explains Project Texas, TikTok's initiative to address U.S. security concerns by storing American user data domestically and increasing transparency through third-party audits. She expresses disappointment that the court did not take a more balanced approach—such as allowing more time for audits before making a ruling—rather than pushing for an outright ban. Dr. Hensley then shares her firsthand experience on a call with 50 TikTok creators and Senator Ro Khanna following the ruling. She gives a special shoutout to Ro Khanna for listening to creators' personal stories about how TikTok has changed their lives. Reflecting on her own journey, she speaks about how the platform has allowed her to grow her business, reach thousands of clients, and help people find and sustain healthy relationships. She then discusses the broader consequences of the ruling, including the potential legal risks for service providers like Apple and Google if they continued to offer TikTok for download. She explains how these companies could have, and still could, face legal challenges and financial penalties had they not complied with the ruling. Halfway through the episode, Dr. Hensley shifts to analyzing the deal that former President Trump negotiated to create a 75-day extension, delaying the enforcement of the ban. She explains the terms of this deal and the political maneuvering behind it. She also highlights the efforts of Senator Ed Markey, who advocated for an extension that would allow TikTok to remain operational while the government figured out how to protect national security. However, she notes that Senator Tom Cotton was the only person in Congress to oppose Markey's extension, standing firmly in favor of the ban. Dr. Hensley ends the episode with a powerful call to action, urging listeners to stand up for free speech and their First Amendment rights. She encourages everyone who values TikTok to sign the petition to repeal the ban, emphasizing that the fight is far from over. She reminds listeners that their voices matter and that advocating for their platform is essential in preserving digital freedom and economic opportunity. This episode is a must-listen for TikTok creators, business owners, and anyone invested in the future of digital content creation in the U.S.

## *Episode 38, Season 1: The Most Painful Relationship Dynamic*

Published: 04 Feb 2025

Episode 38: The Most Painful Relationship Dynamic In this deeply insightful episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley explores what she considers the most painful romantic dynamic outside of relationships with narcissists or those with personality disorders: the Fearful-Avoidant (FA) and Dismissive-Avoidant (DA) attachment pairing. Why Is This the Most Painful Dynamic? Dr. Hensley begins by breaking down the core traits of each attachment style: • Fearful-Avoidants (FAs) crave deep emotional intimacy but simultaneously fear it, oscillating between intense closeness and withdrawal. Their internal struggle stems from an upbringing marked by trauma, inconsistency, and trust breaks—often experiencing both love and fear from caregivers. • Dismissive-Avoidants (DAs), on the other hand, prioritize independence and emotional self-sufficiency. They typically shut down in the face of relational tension, having learned early on that vulnerability is unsafe and that they must rely on themselves. When these two attachment styles fall in love, the cycle of attraction and rejection becomes excruciatingly painful: • Push-Pull Dynamics: The FA constantly seeks reassurance, only to pull away when it feels too overwhelming, while the DA maintains emotional distance, reinforcing the FA's fears of not being able to trust anyone. • Emotional Misalignment: The FA interprets the DA's withdrawal as rejection, triggering intense anxiety and protest behaviors, while the DA feels overwhelmed by the FA's emotional needs and shuts down further. • Unresolved Childhood Wounds: Both partners unknowingly re-enact childhood patterns—FAs chase unresponsive caregivers, while DAs retreat to the emotional solitude they relied on as children. Why Are They Attracted to Each Other? Midway through the episode, Dr. Hensley delves into one of the most fascinating aspects of insecure attachment: shadow attraction—the unconscious draw toward partners who reflect our deepest fears, wounds, and unintegrated parts of ourselves. • The FA's Shadow: The fearful-avoidant deeply fears abandonment but is paradoxically drawn to emotionally unavailable partners (DAs) because they reinforce the FA's core belief: "I am not safe in love." Since thier emotions tend to be all over the place they are drawn to the emotional stabitity that the DA partner protrays. • The DA's Shadow: The dismissive-avoidant, though appearing independent, often harbors deep loneliness and suppressed emotional needs. They are magnetized by the FA's emotional intensity, as it represents the feelings they've long suppressed. Since their emotions tend to be more supressed they become enamored by the FA's openess to express emotional vulnerability. Dr. Hensley explains that insecurely attached individuals are attracted to their shadows because their subconscious mind seeks familiarity, even if it is painful. Healing requires recognizing this attraction as a mirror rather than a destiny. How Can This Relationship Work? Although this dynamic is inherently painful, Dr. Hensley assures listeners that healing and transformation are possible. She shares tools and strategies from her coaching practice that help break the toxic cycle and create a more secure bond. • For Fearful-Avoidants: Learning to regulate their nervous system and develop self-trust, so they are not constantly seeking reassurance from an emotionally unavailable partner. • For Dismissive-Avoidants: Developing emotional literacy and recognizing that avoiding emotions does not equal true independence. • For Both Partners: Understanding the trauma responses at play, fostering direct communication, and shifting the relationship from one of reactivity to intentionality. Dr. Hensley offers practical steps, including boundary-setting exercises, communication techniques, and self-reflection practices, while keeping some of her most transformative methods reserved for her private clients and programs. Because this is the most common and painful dynamic Dr. Hensley sees in her practice, this episode is a must-listen for anyone trapped in the FA-DA cycle. It provides both clarity and hope, offering a roadmap to understanding why these relationships feel impossible and how, with the right tools, they can evolve into something healthier. Whether you're struggling in this dynamic or simply want to deepen your knowledge of attachment, this episode is packed with raw insights, expert guidance, and real solutions—don't miss it!

## *Episode 37, Season 1: The Tik Tok Ban: Part 1*

Published: 28 Jan 2025

Episode 37: “The TikTok Ban” In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley takes a step outside her usual relationship-focused discussions to dive into a topic that’s deeply personal and timely: the TikTok ban. Known as her “home base,” TikTok is where Dr. Hensley’s journey began and where she built her most loyal community. She discusses why she believes TikTok is the best platform for amplifying organic voices without conditions or algorithms that stifle creators—a stark contrast to other social platforms. Dr. Hensley acknowledges the flood of misinformation surrounding the TikTok ban and emphasizes the importance of educating the public about what’s really happening. Drawing on her extensive research and the developments she’s followed closely, she outlines the key players and moments in this ongoing story. Dr. Hensley breaks this episode down with the following categories. *TikTok’s Role in Dr. Hensley’s Journey • Why TikTok feels like home and why it’s unique compared to other platforms. • The power of TikTok to amplify diverse and organic voices. • How the platform helped her connect with her audience authentically. *Origins of the TikTok Ban Discussion • Concerns over TikTok’s ownership by ByteDance, a Chinese company. • Fears about national security, data privacy, and the potential for Chinese government access to American user data. * Both former President Biden and President Trump’s Roles in how and why the tik tok ban is happening. *Congress and the Senate’s Role • Hearings with TikTok’s CEO and other stakeholders. • The bipartisan concerns about foreign influence, misinformation, and the need for stricter data privacy laws. • Differing perspectives on whether banning TikTok is a solution or a distraction. * The impact on Creators and Communities • The potential fallout for creators who rely on TikTok for connection and income. • How a ban could shift social media dynamics and stifle the organic reach that creators depend on. *Dr. Hensley’s Takeaway • Why it’s crucial for American people to be educated about the motivations behind these actions. • The broader implications of censorship and government overreach on free speech. • Her hope for a balanced solution that protects both privacy and the creative freedom of platforms like TikTok. Dr. Hensley concludes by sharing her unwavering belief in the power of creators and communities to adapt and thrive, no matter the platform. She encourages her listeners to stay informed, engaged, and proactive in understanding the policies that affect their digital lives as well as thier constitutional rights. This episode is a must-listen for anyone curious about the ongoing debate surrounding TikTok and its future in the U.S.

## *Episode 36, Season 1: Why They Cheat*

Published: 21 Jan 2025

Episode 36: Why They Cheat In episode 36 of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley takes a deep dive into the complex reasons behind infidelity, viewed through the lens of attachment theory. As a seasoned social psychologist and attachment expert, she offers a nuanced exploration of why individuals from different attachment styles might cheat, shedding light on the often-hidden wounds that drive this behavior. Why Each Attachment Style Might Cheat 1. Dismissive Avoidant: Dismissive avoidants often cheat as a way to maintain emotional distance and protect their independence. Deep down, they fear vulnerability and intimacy, and cheating allows them to avoid the commitment that comes with being fully emotionally present. They may rationalize their behavior as a way to preserve their sense of autonomy. 2. Fearful Avoidant: With a mix of longing for closeness and a fear of rejection, fearful avoidants may cheat due to their inconsistent emotional needs. They might seek validation or comfort from someone outside the relationship while simultaneously pushing their primary partner away out of fear of betrayal. Their inner conflict often leads to impulsive decisions driven by unresolved trauma. 3. Anxious Preoccupied: Anxious-preoccupied individuals are highly driven by a fear of being unloved or abandoned. They might cheat as a misguided attempt to get attention, reassurance, or to feel desired. Often, their infidelity stems from insecurity and an underlying belief that their partner isn't meeting their emotional needs. Recovering From Infidelity Midway through the episode, Dr. Hensley shifts gears to discuss the aftermath of cheating and how couples can work to rebuild trust—if they choose to do so. She explains that recovery from infidelity is an uphill battle, requiring immense effort, vulnerability, and accountability from both partners. • Steps to Recovery: Dr. Hensley outlines specific steps for couples attempting to heal: 1. Complete transparency and accountability from the unfaithful partner. 2. Commitment to honest communication, even when it's uncomfortable. 3. Addressing the root cause of the infidelity, often tied to individual attachment wounds. 4. Seeking professional guidance to navigate the intense emotions and triggers that surface during this process. However, Dr. Hensley candidly shares her professional opinion: full recovery from infidelity is rare. While some couples rebuild stronger relationships, most struggle to regain the trust and emotional safety necessary for long-term connection. Support for Those Impacted by Infidelity In the final segment, Dr. Hensley emphasizes the importance of compassionate, actionable support for individuals navigating the aftermath of infidelity. Whether listeners are healing from divorce, trying to mend a relationship, or contemplating leaving, Dr. Hensley's coaching practices offer a lifeline. She highlights how her tools and tactics—grounded in attachment theory and years of experience—equip clients to: • Regulate their nervous system amidst emotional turmoil. • Break free from self-blame and shame cycles. • Set and enforce healthy boundaries, regardless of their decision to stay or leave. Dr. Hensley assures her audience that while the pain of infidelity is profound, it is possible to heal, grow, and rediscover self-worth. Her compassionate approach provides both validation and practical strategies, empowering clients to navigate one of the most painful experiences in any relationship. Tune in to this episode for an eye-opening discussion that combines academic insight with heartfelt guidance for those grappling with the fallout of infidelity.

## *Episode 35, Season 1: The Fearful Avoidant*

Published: 14 Jan 2025

Episode 35: The Fearful Avoidant In episode 35 of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley dives deep into the world of the Fearful Avoidant (FA) attachment style, the most complex and variable of all attachment types. Known in earlier psychological frameworks as disorganized attachment, FAs oscillate between seeking closeness and pulling away, leaving both themselves and their partners in a cycle of confusion and pain. What Makes the Fearful Avoidant Unique? Dr. Hensley explains that FAs are the hardest attachment style to pinpoint because they embody traits from both anxious and avoidant types. Their deep inner conflict is rooted in a profound trust and betrayal wound, which makes it challenging for them to feel secure in relationships. • The Push-Pull Dynamic: FAs often seek connection, craving closeness, but then feel misunderstood or betrayed and instinctively push their partner away. This paradox creates a cycle of emotional highs and lows in their romantic relationships. Where Attachment Begins: The Childhood of an FA Dr. Hensley traces the origins of FA attachment back to childhood, often shaped by the most trauma-filled environments. These traumas can include: • Big T traumas (e.g., abuse, neglect, abandonment). • Little T traumas (e.g., invalidation, inconsistency, emotional neglect). She also emphasizes that FAs typically grow up with at least one emotionally dysfunctional caregiver, further complicating their ability to trust and feel safe. The Role of Parents: • Same-gender parent: Science suggests this parent leaves the deepest imprint on the child's attachment patterns. • Both parents: Combined, their behaviors create the template that teaches the FA that love is not safe, leading to deep-seated trust and betrayal wounds. The Negative Traits of an FA Dr. Hensley breaks down the challenging traits of FAs, especially how they manifest in adult romantic relationships: 1. Hypervigilance: • FAs are highly attuned to subtle cues but often catastrophize them. • This makes them extremely sensitive and easily triggered, as their deep wounds leave them vulnerable to perceived rejection or betrayal. 2. Trauma Responses: • Anxious-leaning FAs tend to react with anger and heightened emotional reactivity. • Avoidant-leaning FAs often dissociate, emotionally shutting down after feeling they've tried too hard for too long. 3. Negative Bias in Relationships: • FAs often approach their romantic relationships with a belief that betrayal is inevitable, leading to high levels of criticism and difficulty repairing conflicts. 4. Poor Partner Choices: • Subconscious patterns often lead FAs to pick emotionally unavailable or harmful partners, such as other FAs, dismissive avoidants, narcissists, or individuals struggling with substance abuse. The Positive Traits of an FA Despite their challenges, FAs possess incredible strengths, especially once they begin healing: 1. High Empathy: • Their ability to deeply understand and feel for others allows them to create profound connections. • Dr. Hensley cautions FAs to establish boundaries around their empathy to avoid co-dependency or self-abandonment. 2. High Emotional Intelligence (EQ): • FAs are often exceptional in careers requiring deep emotional awareness and social skills, such as sales, law, or politics. 3. Depth and Connection: • As deep feelers, healed FAs can foster rich, meaningful relationships that are both emotionally fulfilling and long-lasting. Final Thoughts Dr. Hensley concludes the episode by emphasizing that while FAs are complex and deeply wounded, their capacity for growth and transformation is unparalleled. They are true fighters, with a grit that comes only from thier deep feelings and high emotional IQ's. With healing and self-awareness, FAs can become some of the most empathetic, emotionally intelligent, and loving partners. "Fearful Avoidants," Dr. Hensley says, "are proof that beauty can emerge from brokenness. Their complexity is what makes them truly special." Tune in to hear more about how FAs can harness their strengths, heal their wounds, and build secure, lasting connections.

## *Episode 34, Season 1: Accountability*

Published: 07 Jan 2025

Episode 34: "Accountability" In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley dives deep into the concept of accountability, exploring what it means, what it looks like, and why it is essential for the success of all relationships. Dr. Hensley highlights that lack of accountability is at the root of most relationship issues, emphasizing that true accountability involves both a statement of acknowledgment and actionable change. Why Is Accountability So Difficult? Dr. Hensley explains that the core barrier to accountability is shame. Criticism is hard for anyone to hear, especially when it comes from someone they love. Yet, taking responsibility for how our actions impact others is vital for relational growth. She explores how accountability challenges manifest across attachment styles: • Fearful Avoidants: Often struggle due to complex trauma and high levels of shame, leading them to become defensive before accepting responsibility. • Anxious Preoccupied: Tend to take too much accountability, often self-abandoning or apologizing without understanding what they're apologizing for, in an effort to avoid conflict. • Dismissive Avoidants: The least likely to take accountability due to low emotional intelligence, making it hard for them to see their role in relational issues. The Role of Accountability in Conflict Repair Dr. Hensley delves into how resentment builds when neither party takes accountability, stressing that acknowledgment and action are the foundations for repairing conflict. This applies not just to romantic relationships but also to friendships and parent-child dynamics. She clarifies that accountability doesn't mean sacrificing your own beliefs or boundaries—it's about recognizing how your actions may hurt someone else and taking responsibility, even if the same behavior wouldn't affect you in the same way. Accountability as a Two-Way Street Towards the end of the episode, Dr. Hensley addresses common objections people have when confronted with accountability, such as: • "But what about their behavior?" • "My partner is so unreasonable." • "I never hear 'I'm sorry.'" While grace is essential in relationships, Dr. Hensley challenges listeners to reflect on why they continue to accept hurtful behaviors. Ultimately, accountability is a two-way street—it's about both taking responsibility for your actions and holding yourself accountable for staying in relationships that don't meet your needs. Key Takeaway: Accountability is the hallmark of emotional resilience and maturity, and it's fundamental for conflict repair and relationship success. Tune in for this powerful episode and learn how to cultivate accountability to strengthen your relationships and honor yourself.

## *Episode 33, Season 1: The Dismissive Avoidant*

Published: 31 Dec 2024

Episode 33: The Dismissive Avoidant In this episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley dives deep into the attachment style that many find both fascinating and frustrating—the dismissive avoidant (DA). While the DA is often seen as the most perplexing of the insecure attachment styles, Dr. Hensley explains that their behaviors are actually the most predictable. The episode begins with an exploration of two common childhood experiences that shape the dismissive avoidant attachment style. Many DAs report having a “good” childhood—parents who stayed married and supported instrumental needs like attending events. However, upon closer examination, it becomes clear there was little to no emotional support. From a young age, DAs learned that suppressing emotions kept them safe, as big emotions were unwelcome or even punished. Dr. Hensley then explains the infamous 4-6 month “bait and switch” often seen in DA relationships. In the early stages, they appear open and even vulnerable, but as the relationship deepens, they start to deactivate. These deactivation behaviors—feeling smothered, doubting the relationship, or fearing a loss of independence—are often unconscious yet highly predictable. The discussion moves to the DA’s core wound: defectiveness. Growing up, their emotions were invalidated, leading them to believe they were inherently flawed. In adult relationships, when their partner expresses intense emotions, the DA subconsciously feels responsible, thinking, “I must be bad if I made you feel this way.” Unfortunately, they lack the capacity to hold space for those feelings, perpetuating the cycle of disconnection. Dr. Hensley also tackles the topic of sex and intimacy in DA relationships. For some, sex feels like another expectation they’re unable to fulfill emotionally or physically. Others use sex as a way to meet their limited need for emotional and physical connection. A key highlight of the episode is Dr. Hensley’s explanation of the DA’s trauma responses, particularly their tendency to live in a state of functional freeze. They’re either “on,” constantly busy with tasks to avoid emotions, or “off,” dissociating from the important things in their lives. Midway through, Dr. Hensley addresses a small subset of DAs who experience severe trauma within the first five years of life. In these cases, the brain shuts down to protect itself, resulting in even deeper emotional challenges, through disconnection, later in life. The episode concludes with a path to healing for both DAs and their partners. Dr. Hensley provides actionable strategies for recognizing DA patterns in the dating phase and practical interventions for those in long-term relationships or marriages. Through her programs, she has witnessed countless transformations, with DAs finding genuine connection and their formerly anxious partners moving toward secure attachment. Additional topics include: • Why DAs are the attachment style most likely to cheat. • The motivations behind a DA’s decision to heal. • How the tools and strategies in Dr. Hensley’s coaching program enable true healing for DAs and their partners. This episode offers hope, clarity, and a practical roadmap for navigating relationships with dismissive avoidants and fostering secure attachment.

## *Episode 32, Season 1: Live Coaching Session with Rozerin*

Published: 24 Dec 2024

Episode 32: Live Coaching Session with Rozerin In this groundbreaking episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah invites listeners into her virtual coaching room for the first-ever live adult attachment interview with special guest Rozerin. A graduate of Dr. Sarah's hybrid group coaching program, Rozerin had long dreamed of experiencing a one-on-one assessment. Dr. Sarah opens this session to the public, giving listeners a firsthand look at the depth, insight, and transformation these sessions provide. Topics Explored in the Interview Dr. Sarah guides Rozerin through a detailed exploration of four key areas: 1. Childhood Experiences • Rozerin shares her upbringing, reflecting on trauma-related events, the dynamics between her parents, and how her caregivers influenced her ability to emotionally regulate as a child. 2. Previous Romantic Relationships • The session delves into Rozerin's two or three most significant relationships, unpacking their core challenges and the reasons they ended, and/or if she is currently still in any of them. 3. Emotional Vulnerability • Rozerin examines her capacity to share her deepest thoughts, feelings, and fears with her partner, discussing the ease or difficulty of achieving emotional intimacy. 4. Conflict Behaviors • The discussion covers the ways she and her partner respond to conflict, including levels of emotional reactivity, resolution strategies, and patterns that emerge during disagreements. Attachment Style Analysis Following the interview, Dr. Sarah determines that both Rozerin and her partner are fearful avoidants, with Rozerin leaning more anxious and her boyfriend more dismissive. Dr. Sarah provides an in-depth explanation of how fearful avoidant attachment is formed, highlighting the core wounds of betrayal and abandonment. She connects these wounds to Rozerin's childhood experiences and illustrates how they manifest in her current relationship dynamics. Exploring Healing Goals Acknowledging that healing is an ongoing journey, Dr. Sarah asks Rozerin to identify areas where she still feels gaps in her progress. Rozerin admits to struggling with a negative bias toward her partner, often assuming the worst-case scenario in their interactions. However, she shares that the tools and strategies from Dr. Sarah's group program have significantly improved her mindset, leading to increased happiness, positivity, and reduced anxiety. Concrete Tools for Overcoming Negative Bias Dr. Sarah closes the session with actionable interventions to help Rozerin stop negative biases in their tracks. She emphasizes the importance of catching and correcting old patterns, a hallmark of secure attachment, and equips Rozerin with practical tools to continue her healing journey. This powerful episode offers deep insights into attachment theory, personal growth, and the transformative potential of Dr. Sarah's coaching methods. Tune in for a raw, real, and inspirational look at Dr. Hensley's healing process in action.

## *Episode 31, Season 1: Forgiving the Unforgivable*

Published: 17 Dec 2024

Episode 31: Forgiving the Unforgivable In this deeply moving episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah tackles the profound challenge of forgiving the unforgivable. She explains why forgiveness is vital for personal healing—even when there's no apology—and how forgiveness is ultimately for your benefit, not for the person or situation that caused harm. Dr. Sarah begins by discussing the hope and transformation that true forgiveness can bring, clarifying that forgiveness doesn't mean becoming boundaryless. Instead, it's about releasing bitterness and resentment while maintaining respect for your own needs. She delves into the connection between forgiveness and attachment patterns, highlighting two common toxic responses: those who avoid forgiveness by leaving abruptly and those who stay in harmful situations due to anxiety. Dr. Sarah explores how bitterness often stems from a fear of being hurt again and acts as a shield that ultimately blocks healing. Drawing on research, she connects bitterness and unforgiveness to chronic illness, linking these emotions to an increased risk of stroke, heart attack, and even cancer. Dr. Sarah also reflects on her own experience with forgiveness after the death of her ex-husband, crediting her faith in God for helping her release anger and find peace. Midway through, Dr. Sarah explains how unforgiveness keeps us trapped in trauma responses and prevents nervous system regulation. She emphasizes that self-forgiveness is essential for true healing, describing the importance of "catch and correct" as a strategy for maintaining attachment security. The episode concludes with Dr. Sarah and Raina sharing personal reflections, including acknowledging positive qualities in their exes and taking accountability for their own past behaviors. They remind listeners that forgiveness isn't about excusing others—it's about freeing yourself. What is covered: ·What is true forgiveness. .The role forgiveness plays in our healing journeys. ·The toxic patterns of unforgiveness. ·The connection between chronic illness and unforgiveness. .How unforgiveness keeps us in a state of nervous system dysregulation. .The spiritual and psychological avenues to forgiveness. Consider/Ask Yourself: ·Am I holding onto resentment and bitterness within my relationship? .How can I seek more forgiveness with those that have hurt me? ·Am I exhibiting toxic behaviors associated with unforgiveness? .What resources can I seek out both spiritually and psychologically as a way to work on forgiveness?

## *Episode 30, Season 1: That's My Life: Part II - The Rising of the Phoenix*

Published: 10 Dec 2024

Episode 30: That’s My Life Part II – The Rising of the Phoenix In this deeply moving episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Sarah Hensley continues the intimate recounting of her life story, picking up from the tumultuous events shared in Episode 29. This chapter delves into the darkest period of her life, unveiling the profound struggles that ultimately paved the way for her transformation. Dr. Hensley opens the episode by sharing the fallout of her first marriage, marked by her ex-husband’s battle with addiction and abusive behavior. Their relationship ended in a bitter custody battle, during which Dr. Hensley did everything in her power to help him rebuild his life for the sake of their children. However, his sudden marriage to another woman and his decision to redirect his life insurance policies to her left Sarah financially and emotionally shattered, raising their children on her own. The spiral deepened with the tragic news of her ex-husband’s death—a revelation she learned only after others, including her dismissive-avoidant ex-boyfriend, who broke the news to her best friend Raina before Sarah even knew. Adding to her grief, her mother was battling pancreatic cancer, and Sarah was reeling from a breakup with the same boyfriend who continued to breadcrumb her during her most vulnerable moments. At her lowest point, Dr. Hensley’s physical health began to deteriorate rapidly. She woke up one day with debilitating symptoms—her world a blur, everything spinning, and a sensation of walking on a trampoline. After months of misdiagnoses, she was finally diagnosed with vestibular migraines, a condition she was told she might have to live with forever. This was the breaking point where Dr. Hensley felt utterly hopeless, unable to work or care for her daughters. Seeking answers, she turned to therapy, including EMDR and ART, but neither provided relief. She was left wondering why no one was connecting her physical condition to the immense emotional trauma she had endured. It wasn’t until she discovered Alan Gordon’s podcast Tell Me About Your Pain that she began to understand the link between emotional trauma and physical ailments. This discovery set her on a path of healing through faith, science, and self-compassion. Dr. Hensley recounts how a close friend introduced her to Be In Health Ministries, where she began to experience profound spiritual healing, regaining 80% of her health. The remaining 20% came through her study of neuroplasticity and its relationship to pain, empowering her to rewrite her body’s story of trauma and reclaim her life. In the final moments of the episode, Dr. Hensley shares the tools and practices that transformed her life and now form the cornerstone of her coaching and teachings. With a thriving business, a loving marriage, and a peaceful heart, Dr. Hensley’s journey is a testament to the resilience of the human spirit. She closes with a message of hope, encouraging listeners that no matter how dire the circumstances, they too can rise from the ashes like a phoenix. This episode is a powerful reminder that healing is possible, and even in the face of overwhelming adversity, a brighter future awaits. What is covered: ·The continuation of Dr. Hensley's story. .The death of her ex-husband and what led to it. ·The story of her experience dating a dismissive avoidant. ·The break up story between her and the dismissive avoidant after her mother's cancer diagnoses. .The spiraling of her life that eventually led to her sickness. .The discovery of "Be in Health Ministries" and Alan Gordman's podcast "Tell Me About Your Pain" both of which led to her path of healing. Consider/Ask Yourself: ·How can Dr. Hensley's life story inspire me to seek healing? .What resources can I utilize on my own healing journey? ·Am I stuck in a vicious cycle with a dismissive avoidant partner that is only adding to the turmoil of my life? .How can I seek help and healing through Dr. Hensley's services so I too can rise from the ashes like a pheonix?

## *Episode 29, Season 1: That's My Life: Part 1*

Published: 03 Dec 2024

In episode 29 of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show titled “That’s My Life,” Dr. Hensley takes listeners on an emotional journey through her life story. Beginning with her childhood, she candidly describes growing up with a bipolar father whose unpredictable moods created a home filled with anxiety and instability. She explores the dynamics between her parents, highlighting her mother’s unhappiness in the marriage, her Catholic faith that kept her from leaving, and the burdens she carried as the family’s financial provider. Dr. Hensley reflects on how these experiences shaped her early romantic relationships, sharing the trauma of her first love and the patterns that led her to tolerate toxic behavior. She dives into the pivotal moments of meeting and marrying her first husband, recounting the red flags she overlooked, the abuse she endured, and the heartbreaking decisions she made in an attempt to salvage the marriage—including having children during fleeting moments of sobriety. With raw honesty, Dr. Hensley shares painful details of domestic abuse, her ex-husband’s alcoholism, infidelity, and the events that ultimately led her to file for divorce. This deeply personal episode concludes with a teaser for part two, where she promises to share her inspiring journey of healing and resilience. Tune in if you’ve ever faced similar struggles and are ready to witness a story of rising from the ashes. What is covered: ·Dr. Hensley's childhood and how it shaped her. .Dr. Hensley's first romatic expereinces and how they shaped her. ·The story of how she met her first husband. ·The story of her abuse and her first husband's infidelity. .How she finally got the nerve to file for divorce. Consider/Ask Yourself: ·Can I relate to the type of childhood Dr. Hensley had? .How have my own childhood experiences shaped my choices in romantic partners? ·Can I relate to Dr. Hensley's first marriage? .If I can relate to Dr. Hensley's first marriage is it time for me to leave?

## *Episode 28, Season 1: The Self-Aware Narcissist with Special Guest "The Nameless Narcissist"*

Published: 26 Nov 2024

Episode 28: The Self-Aware Narcissist with Special Guest The Nameless Narcissist In this captivating episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley sits down with “The Nameless Narcissist,” a self-aware content creator diagnosed with Narcissistic Personality Disorder (NPD). Through his TikTok content, he shares raw and insightful accounts of living with NPD, and Dr. Hensley reflects on how his perspective has deepened her understanding of the condition, especially its origins and impact on relationships. The episode begins with The Nameless Narcissist recounting his journey to self-awareness, including his path to an NPD diagnosis after two years of therapy. He candidly discusses the challenge of being diagnosed due to the nature of NPD, where manipulation and deflection can mask the true symptoms. Dr. Hensley then poses a compelling question: “What’s the one thing you wish people knew about NPD?” His answer highlights the human side of narcissism—that beneath the harmful behaviors, people with NPD still seek connection, worth, and love. He explains that while experts often understand the behaviors, they sometimes miss the underlying motivations. The conversation shifts to the role of control in narcissism. Dr. Hensley brings up a fascinating point from The Nameless Narcissist’s content—that control isn’t about achieving specific outcomes but proving one’s capability to control. This stems from a need for self-esteem regulation, a recurring theme in the discussion. Dr. Hensley shares her personal experience with a narcissistic ex-partner who was a serial cheater. She theorizes his behavior stemmed from a need for constant external validation, which The Nameless Narcissist connects back to the “grandiose highs” that regulate self-esteem. The Nameless Narcissist also delves into his healing journey, including how exploring his caregivers’ pain and trauma helped him release some of his childhood wounds. This insight into intergenerational trauma is a powerful reminder of the complexities behind NPD. The episode touches on the rare self-awareness among those with NPD, with research suggesting only 1% reach this stage. However, The Nameless Narcissist argues the true number is likely higher, as many may feel too much shame to admit their struggles publicly. Finally, the discussion turns to theories of narcissism’s origins. The Nameless Narcissist shares his perspective, describing grandiosity as a safety mechanism to counter deep feelings of unworthiness—a way to feel anything at all. Dr. Hensley wraps up by thanking The Nameless Narcissist for his bravery and empathy, both for those with NPD and for those who’ve been hurt by narcissistic behavior. She encourages listeners to explore his content for further understanding of NPD and its complexities. This episode is a must-listen for anyone seeking to understand narcissism through a lens of compassion, insight, and healing. Please go follow The Nameless Narcissit on all platforms @thenamelessnarcissist. What is covered: ·Who is The Nameless Narcissit and what is his story. .The one thing you want people to know about Narcissitic Personality Disorder (NPD). · The role of control in narcissism. ·The theory behind why some narcissist are serial cheaters. .The theories behind why only 1% of those with NPD become self-aware. Consider/Ask Yourself: ·Am I dealing with someone who has true NPD or someone who just has narcissitic traits? .Do I possibly have NPD? ·What is some of the pain that those with NPD are experiencing? .Am I seeking understanding and forgiveness for the pain that I experienced from someone with NPD or am I holding onto resentment? ·How can I start to see more humanity in people who have diagnosed NPD? .Do I or someone I know need to seek help and intervention for NPD and/or narcisstic traits?

## *Episode 27, Season 1: The Anxious Pre-Occupied*

Published: 19 Nov 2024

Episode 27 "The Anxious Pre-Occupied." In this insightful episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley delves into the intricate world of the anxious preoccupied (AP) attachment style, which she refers to as the “least common” attachment style she encounters in her practice. While many clients initially come to her thinking that they are AP, Dr. Hensley explains that they often turn out to be fearful avoidant (FA), but think they are AP becuase thier anxiety is heightened due to a dismissive partner. She begins by distinguishing the anxious preoccupied from the fearful avoidant attachment, emphasizing how their formation and behaviors differ. Dr. Hensley provides a thorough explanation of the key factor behind the development of AP attachment: intermittent reinforcement. She describes how AP individuals often experienced inconsistent love and affection from one or both caregivers during childhood. This unpredictability created anxiety and a deep-seated fear of not knowing when they would receive the love they craved. How AP Behaviors Show Up in Relationships Dr. Hensley explains that anxious preoccupied behaviors in adulthood often stem from early coping mechanisms, including a fawning response. As children, they learned to please their caregivers to gain more consistent love and affection, which translates into adult tendencies of people-pleasing. During conflict, AP individuals often sacrifice their boundaries to maintain harmony and emotional safety, leaving them feeling as though their own needs are never met. A central wound of the AP is the fear of abandonment. Dr. Hensley shares how this manifests as a need to keep peace at all costs, leading AP individuals to apologize even when they don’t know what they’re apologizing for. The toxic trait of codependency frequently appears in their relationships, with APs adopting the belief that “if you’re not okay, I’m not okay.” This fear of abandonment drives them to prioritize their partner’s emotional state over their own, further entrenching unhealthy dynamics. Interestingly, Dr. Hensley notes that APs may sometimes appear dismissive or detached during conflict. However, this is not disassociation but rather a strategy to remain emotionally “safe” by staying silent. Internally, their nervous system is overwhelmed by intense emotions, but they struggle to release or process them. Steps Toward Healing Midway through the episode, Dr. Hensley shifts focus to practical strategies for AP individuals to heal and regain balance in their relationships. She emphasizes two foundational tools: 1. Setting and Maintaining Boundaries AP individuals must learn to set clear, firm boundaries and resist the urge to self-abandon to please others. 2. Improving Communication Dr. Hensley highlights the importance of speaking up and addressing dissatisfaction directly instead of resorting to passive-aggressive behaviors, which stem from their fear of abandonment. By recognizing these patterns and intentionally shifting their behaviors, APs can move away from toxic submissiveness and toward healthier relational dynamics. Why AP Is the Least Seen Attachment Style As the episode nears its conclusion, Dr. Hensley shares why the anxious preoccupied is the least common attachment style in her practice. She attributes this to the AP’s deep-seated pride and belief that they can “fix” themselves and their relationships without outside help. AP individuals often tie their self-worth to the success of their relationships, perpetuating a cycle of self-reliance and resistance to professional support. Listener Q&A: Can Attachment Styles Shift? Dr. Hensley wraps up by answering a common question about attachment: Can someone shift from being AP to FA or DA? She clarifies that while all attachment styles share overlapping traits, it’s rare for a person to completely shift styles, except when progressing toward secure attachment. The core wounds of attachment are formed in childhood and cannot be undone, but healing is always possible. This episode is a must-listen for anyone struggling with AP tendencies or seeking to understand the nuances of attachment in relationships. Dr. Hensley’s compassionate approach and actionable advice make this an empowering resource for personal growth. What is covered: ·The behaviors of the Anxious Pre-Occupied. .Intermittent Reinforcement as a key factor in the formulation of Anxious Pre-Occupied attachment style. · How AP's show up in relationships. ·Steps towards healing Anxious Pre-Occupied Attachment. .Why the Anxious Pre-Occupied is the least seen attachment style in Dr. Hensley's practice. Consider/Ask Yourself: ·Do you think that you are Anxious Pre-Occupied when you may actually be Fearful Avoidant? ·Did you grow up with a fairly good childhood but feel like you got inconsistent love and affection from one or both of your caregivers? .Are you self abadoning inside of your relationship? ·How can you start setting healthy boundries within your relationship and how can you start to stick to them? .How can I learn to express my needs and wants within my relationship in a healthy and compassionate way? .Do I need to seek help and intervention for my AP attachment style?

## *Episode 26, Season 1: Radical Acceptance*

Published: 12 Nov 2024

In episode 26, titled Radical Acceptance, Dr. Hensley delves into the powerful concept of radical acceptance and its impact on emotional well-being. She opens by defining radical acceptance as the practice of embracing reality without self-judgment, especially when it's challenging. Dr. Hensley explains how shame can disrupt our nervous system, often fueling a sense of failure that persists despite outward success. Sharing her personal journey, she reflects on moments of feeling inadequate, even while balancing a thriving career and family life, describing times she felt she "dropped the ball" as a parent and business owner. Drawing on insights from nervous system expert Dana Doswell from episode 19, Dr. Hensley underscores that how we approach our tasks, with grace and acceptance, is often more important than what we do. This foundation, she explains, is central to radical acceptance, where the practice becomes a conscious effort to recognize that one's efforts are "enough," even amid mistakes. Throughout the episode, Dr. Hensley and Raina share real-life stories, touching on childhood experiences of shame. They highlight how fostering radical acceptance in children—around mistakes and natural bodily changes—helps build resilience. Dr. Hensley then explores why radical acceptance is particularly difficult for overachievers and perfectionists. These individuals often link their self-worth to being "the best," struggling to relinquish control and falling into self-criticism when they cannot accomplish it all. In a candid segment, Dr. Hensley and Raina discuss their own experiences grappling with radical acceptance of past relationships, particularly with their children's fathers. Raina opens up about working through sexual shame from a past abusive relationship, acknowledging the growth in her journey to accept herself fully. Dr. Hensley explains that radical acceptance also means facing painful realities without minimizing their impact. It involves acknowledging trauma and choosing healing over victimhood, with radical acceptance serving as the foundation for this journey. Finally, Dr. Hensley emphasizes the importance of accountability in relationships as a form of radical acceptance. Owning one's mistakes and apologizing fosters authenticity and vulnerability, she explains, strengthening connections and creating a regulated nervous system. This journey of accountability and repair exemplifies radical acceptance as an honest acknowledgment of human fallibility—embracing, learning, and growing from each experience. What is covered: *What is radical acceptance. *How Dana Doswell, nervous system regulation expert, describes radical acceptance. *The importance of fostering radical acceptance in our children. *Why radical acceptance is so difficult for overachievers and perfectionist. *Radical acceptance of past selves . *Radical accountabilty equals radical acceptance. Consider/Ask Yourself: *Are you beating yourself up too often over things that are outside of your control? *Are you able to recognize when you are not practicing acceptance and how it affects your nervous system? *Are you an overachiever and perfectionist to the point where you are unable to reliquish control and properly delegate task? *How can I practice radical acceptance of my past self? *Can I start to take more radical accountability and radical acceptance inside of my romantic relationship?

## *Episode 25, Season 1: It's a Capacity Issue*

Published: 05 Nov 2024

In episode 25: “It’s a Capacity Issue,” Dr. Hensley takes listeners on an in-depth journey into the concept of building capacity, emphasizing that true change and healing require more than just awareness and understanding. She explains that building capacity is about bridging the gap between intellectual understanding and actionable change, which requires specific mediators between the pathways of knowledge and behavior. Dr. Hensley begins by discussing the psychoeducation she provides in her group coaching programs to help participants develop this capacity. She underscores that awareness alone doesn’t create transformation; instead, certain mental and emotional tools are essential to support lasting change. One of the first components she covers is self-regulation, which she describes as the ability to bring the nervous system to a place of safety. This can be challenging, she notes, particularly for those carrying attachment wounds from childhood, which shape their responses in adulthood. Using the dismissive avoidant (DA) attachment style as a key example, Dr. Hensley delves into how attachment wounds are formed and how those with DA tendencies can build capacity for change. She discusses how early experiences of suppression and dismissal impact the DA’s brain, leading them to default to a freeze response during conflict. This response reflects the limits of their nervous system’s capacity at that moment, which, though protective, often cuts off connection to their partner. At the midpoint of the episode, Dr. Hensley introduces the tools she provides in her hybrid group coaching program, highlighting metacognition as a crucial skill. She teaches clients to recognize and dismantle their trigger cycles, tracing the journey from trigger to trauma response. By giving the nervous system new, healthier experiences, clients can begin to build new neural pathways that reinforce these changes, helping them gradually shift their patterns. Dr. Hensley explains the science of neuroplasticity, emphasizing that everyone has the power to rewire their brains and reshape their behavior. However, she reminds listeners that the journey from awareness to actual change requires specific guidance and support. In the episode’s conclusion, Dr. Hensley explores the concept of radical self-acceptance. She encourages listeners to meet themselves where they are to start creating a sense of safety within their nervous system, which is foundational to building capacity. She also shares more about her coaching services, explaining how each program can support individuals or couples in their journey of growth, healing, and connection. What is covered: . What it means to build capacity. ·The difference in having awareness and knowledge versus true integration of changed behavior. ·The psychoeducation taught in Dr. Hensley's group services. ·Self regulation and what it means. .The example of the Dismissive Avoidant and how they can start to build capacity. .Metacognition and what it means. Consider/Ask Yourself: · Is your nervous system ready to start building capacity? . Have you had time to process your wounds, build awarness and knowlege around them so that you can start to change the behavior associated with them? . Are you practicing self regulation practices when triggered? . How can I start recognizing my triggers and the trauma responses associated with them? . How can I start attuning to my basic human needs and practicing radical self acceptance so that my nervous system can feel safe and I can start building better capcity for change?

## *Episode 24, Season 1: Unoffendable*

Published: 29 Oct 2024

In Episode 24: “Unoffendable” of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley dives deep into a candid exploration of our modern, easily-offended culture and the toll it takes on our nervous systems and resilience. She reflects on how people today are quick to take offense at differing opinions, which often disrupts our emotional balance and has created a deeply divided society. While Dr. Hensley emphasizes that true atrocities—such as murder, sexual abuse, and human trafficking—should rightfully offend us all, she raises concerns about the rise in offense over differences in thought and belief. This, she argues, is eroding respect and open-mindedness in society. Dr. Hensley introduces the importance of emotional resilience versus emotional suppression. She’s clear: she is not advocating for suppressing emotions but promoting emotional resilience. This means developing the capacity to accept others’ views, even when they differ from our own, without offense or alienation. She encourages introspection, urging listeners to question why certain things offend them. Offense, she explains, arises when we feel triggered or violated, highlighting the need for self-understanding as a way to manage these responses. In a thought-provoking segment, Dr. Hensley explains Terror Management Theory, which suggests that when our values or identity feel threatened, it subconsciously evokes fear of mortality, making us feel defensive and offended. Her aim is to help listeners understand that choosing offense can narrow our minds and breed hate, especially in the age of online exchanges where it’s easy to react harshly from behind a screen. Midway through the episode, Dr. Hensley emphasizes that these principles are vital in our closest relationships—particularly with partners, family, and friends. Constant offense, she warns, can rob us of joy and precious time. Instead, she encourages a spirit of curiosity, asking listeners to lean into understanding rather than immediate judgment. By challenging not just others’ thoughts but our own, we can foster genuine connection and potentially gain new insights. As Dr. Hensley wraps up Episode 24: “Unoffendable”, she drives home the importance of looking inward. She advocates for listeners to pause and reflect on why certain things offend them, encouraging them to get curious about others’ points of view rather than reacting. By exploring differing perspectives, she suggests, we can gain valuable insight into our own beliefs and responses. Her hope is that this practice can foster greater empathy and understanding, ultimately helping to bridge divides and bring us closer together in a more united world. This episode serves as both a challenge and a reminder from Dr. Hensley to practice resilience, self-reflection, and compassion in a world quick to divide. What is covered: · The spirit of offense in today's culture. · The toll that being easily offended takes on the nervous system. · The importance of creating grit and curiosity in our children so that can be open minded to others points of view. · What happens when we become offended. . Terror Management Theory. What is it and how does it apply to offensiveness. . The importance of gaining control and clarity around our offensivness within our most imtimate relationships. Consider/Ask Yourself: · Are you becoming too easily offended? · Are you able to recognize when you are offended and how it affects your day to day life? · How can I create more grit and curiosity within myself in order to teach my children the same practices? . How am I allowing offensivness to affect my most important relationships, and in turn how is it affecting my body and mind? . How can I gain more insight around why certain things offend me?

## *Episode 23, Season 1: Raising Secure Children*

Published: 22 Oct 2024

Episode 23 “Raising Secure Children,” Dr. Hensley delves into how attachment theory is not just relevant to romantic relationships but also plays a critical role in parenting. She explains that our attachment styles directly affect our children’s attachment styles, which can shape how they choose romantic partners in the future. Dr. Hensley emphasizes that achieving your own attachment security is essential for raising secure children. The episode begins with Dr. Hensley reflecting on what she would have done differently as a parent, starting with the importance of choosing the right partner. She highlights that secure individuals tend to attract secure partners, while insecure individuals often attract others with insecure attachment styles. Dr. Hensley notes that this choice of partner not only influences attachment but also affects overall life happiness and success. Raina shares a personal story about how triggers from a past relationship impacted her parenting recently. She discusses a situation where her unresolved emotional pain affected her interaction with her son. Raina describes the guilt she felt but focuses on the repair process, where she admitted her mistake to her son and explained that she is still working through her own challenges. Dr. Hensley stresses that mistakes in parenting are inevitable, but secure parenting lies in how we repair those mistakes—similar to how conflicts are resolved in romantic relationships. Dr. Hensley goes on to explain that our nervous systems remember trauma, which is why repairing emotional rifts with children is crucial. Children constantly seek emotional safety from their caregivers, so it’s important to show them that parents are human while ensuring that they don’t remain dysregulated or uncertain about the stability of the relationship. Dr. Hensley emphasizes the importance of teaching children how to regulate their emotions and modeling accountability when parents make mistakes. She also discusses parenting tactics she would avoid, starting with the “cry-it-out” method. Dr. Hensley admits she used this method with her first child but now challenges the approach, arguing that it can negatively impact a child’s nervous system and attachment security. She critiques sleep training specialists who promote this tactic, citing the scientific connection between crying it out and attachment insecurity. Another parenting pitfall Dr. Hensley would avoid is dismissing or punishing a child’s emotions. She explains that phrases like “You’re fine” or “Get over it” can invalidate a child’s feelings and hinder their emotional development. Instead, she recommends guiding children through the process of understanding and labeling their emotions, which aids in emotional regulation and prevents suppressing feelings, which can lead to avoidant attachment. Dr. Hensley provides a real-life example of how she helps her daughter process big emotions, emphasizing the importance of validating a child’s experiences. As the episode progresses, Dr. Hensley talks about teaching children how to feel and energetically move their emotions through their bodies. This practice, she says, is key to mood regulation, physiological health, and helping children develop a deeper awareness of their bodies. She also underscores the value of teaching children to set boundaries confidently so they grow up knowing how to prioritize their own needs and desires, rather than becoming people-pleasers. The episode wraps up with a discussion about the importance of teaching accountability. Dr. Hensley encourages parents to show children how to apologize sincerely, without shifting blame or including excuses. Raina and Dr. Hensley conclude by reiterating the significance of parents working on their own attachment security to model healthy, secure behavior for their children. They emphasize that it’s never too late to start teaching children what secure attachment looks like and how to nurture it. What is covered: · How attachment plays a role in how we parent our children. · The importance of choosing the correct partner to have or raise children with. · The importance of how we repair emotional situations with our children · The importance of teaching children emotional regulation. . Things Dr. Hensley would have done different or would never do on her quest to raising secure children. . The importance of reaching your own attachment security in order to raise secure children. Consider/Ask Yourself: · Are you allowing your own attachment wounds to influence how you parent your children? · Is your relationship with your current or ex partner influencing how you parent your children? · How can I start attuning to my children's emotional needs better? . Am I dismissing or even punishing my children's emotions at times? . Am I teaching my children how to set appropriate boundries and how to take accountability?

## *Episode 22, Season 1: Our Walks with God*

Published: 15 Oct 2024

Episode 22 – “Our Walks with God” In this heartfelt episode, Dr. Hensley and Raina take a deep dive into their personal faith journeys and how they became the strong Christian women they are today. They start by addressing the backlash they’ve received for speaking openly about their faith in previous episodes and dedicate this entire episode to explaining why their faith is so important. Right from the beginning, they provide a disclaimer, encouraging listeners who may not be interested in the topic to skip this episode without judgment. However, they also invite anyone who is curious about how people, including them, develop such strong faith to stay and listen. Dr. Hensley draws powerful connections between psychology and spirituality, highlighting how many psychological principles have roots in the Bible. She shares her belief that God speaks to us through our thoughts and that while He doesn’t interfere with free will, He gives us the chance every day to align with Him or with opposing forces. The episode then shifts to their personal stories, with both women reflecting on their upbringings. They also openly admit that their faith hasn’t always been easy. They discuss their past struggles, often questioning God’s existence, and wondering why bad things happen to good people. Dr. Hensley offers a candid, human perspective on these questions. Midway through, Dr. Hensley shares a transformative experience from a “Be in Health” retreat where she underwent deliverance. Initially skeptical and fearful, she describes how deliverance healed her from pain and debilitating vestibular migraines, leaving her feeling like a new person. This experience also deepened her understanding of the connection between spirituality, physiology, and psychology. To wrap up, Dr. Hensley delves into how her healing experience led her to explore the psychology of healing, uncovering profound parallels between the two disciplines. She emphasizes her practice’s inclusivity, where clients are welcome to choose between Christian or secular approaches to coaching, stressing the importance of acceptance and respect for all faiths. This episode is a vulnerable and insightful look into the personal walks of faith that have shaped these two women’s lives and their work. What is covered: · How each host experienced religion and spirtuality growing up. · Emphasized acceptance if you prefer to not listen to this episode. · The parallels between spirtuality and psychology. · Each host personal story of how and when their fiath shifted. . Deliverance and how Dr. Hensley personally experienced it through "Be In Health" a personal retreat that she attended that healed her pain and changed her life. . The importance of acceptance and how Dr. Hensley practices both a secular and spirtual coaching strategy for her clients. She allows the client to choose which they prefer. Consider/Ask Yourself: · Are you allowing your personal upbrining around faith to interfere with your relationship with God. · Even if you aren't a Christian, is this episode worth listening to in order to explore a deeper understanding around faith? · How can I start seeing the similarites in psychology and spirtuality, and how can I combine the two to make my relationships stronger? . Am I afraid to be on fire about my faith for fear of turning people away? . Regardless of my faith perspective, could Dr. Hensley's coaching strategies be right for me?

## *Episode 21, Season 1: Pop Psychology is Not Psychology*

Published: 08 Oct 2024

Episode 21: "Pop Psychology is Not Psychology." In this episode, Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher break down several misconceptions and misuses of psychological concepts that are often spread through social media and pop culture. “Not everyone you dislike is a narcissist.” Dr. Hensley explains how narcissistic personality disorder (NPD) is difficult to diagnose and measure, primarily because individuals with NPD are often manipulative and lack self-awareness. NPD exists on a spectrum, and while some people may show narcissistic traits, it doesn’t necessarily mean they have NPD. She encourages listeners to revisit episode 10, “Are They a Narcissist?” to learn the differences between narcissistic traits and attachment insecurities. “Not every unpleasant experience is trauma.” Trauma is highly nuanced and specific to each individual’s perception and experience. Labeling every unpleasant event as trauma can actually undermine one’s nervous system and create a victim mentality. Dr. Hensley and Raina discuss how their generation has raised children with an aversion to all discomfort, resulting in a generation with poor coping skills. Dr. Hensley advocates for attachment-based parenting and shares tools she used with her own children, emphasizing the importance of teaching regulation as a foundation for resilience. “Having needs does not make you co-dependent.” Dr. Hensley breaks down the difference between expressing needs and being co-dependent. Raina shares a personal story about her son and his young relationship, illustrating that stating your needs doesn’t make you a bad partner—sacrificing them to keep the peace, however, may indicate co-dependency. “Disagreeing does not mean someone is gaslighting you.” Disagreements are a normal part of communication, and differing perspectives don’t necessarily equate to gaslighting. Dr. Hensley explains that people view reality through their own lenses, shaped by experiences and upbringing. Just because someone has a different opinion doesn’t mean they are trying to manipulate you; they may simply be trying to convey their reality. “Not all conflict is abuse.” The hosts tackle the misconception that any form of conflict is abusive. Dr. Hensley highlights that voice inflation is a normal part of heated discussions and does not equate to abuse. She shares her own boundaries around conflict in her marriage, such as not tolerating yelling, cursing, physical aggression, or threatening divorce. Through her personal experiences, Dr. Hensley gives listeners a clearer picture of what abuse actually looks like. “Taking offense is not being triggered.” Being unoffendable is a key skill for regulating attachment insecurities. Dr. Hensley explains that being offended by someone’s words on social media doesn’t mean you’re being triggered. Understanding what a true trigger is—something that activates deep-seated trauma or unresolved issues—is crucial for emotional regulation. “Everything does not need to be normalized.” “Normal as in common does not always mean normal as in healthy,” Dr. Hensley states. The hosts discuss the societal push to “normalize” things that may not be healthy, sometimes confusing social acceptance with psychological wellness. Dr. Hensley emphasizes that some behaviors we try to normalize might be indicative of mental illness. “Speaking like an HR memo is not self-awareness.” Dr. Hensley shares a personal anecdote about falling into “teacher mode” in her own marriage and how her husband has to call her on it. She then realizes that it creates distance rather than connection. Speaking in an authoritative or clinical tone, even with good intentions, can come across as detached and lack vulnerability. Dr. Hensley wraps up by advising listeners to seek professionals who are well-versed in real psychological principles. She warns against the proliferation of self-proclaimed experts on the internet and encourages her audience to research credentials and ensure they’re working with someone who has the proper education and expertise. Tune in to this episode for a thought-provoking discussion on the difference between genuine psychological understanding and the oversimplified “pop psychology” narratives that dominate social media. What is covered: · What is pop psychology. · Not everyone you dislike is a narcissit. · Not every unpleasant experience is trauma. · Having needs does not make you co-dependent. · Disagreeing does not mean someone is gaslighting you. . Not all conflict is abuse . Taking offense is not being triggered. . Everything does not need to be normalized. . Speaking like an HR memo is not self-awareness. . The importance of finding trained and educated professionals in the field of psychology that can help you on your healing journey. Consider/Ask Yourself: · Are you allowing pop psychology to influence your feelings? · How is social media influencing your ideas and knowledge around mental health? · How can you take each of the topics discussed in this episode and digest them to ensure you are not allowing pop psychology to influence the way you feel and act? . Are you seeking out credible resources and doing your due diligence when it comes to finding the correct mental health professional?

## *Episode 20, Season 1: Taking Back Your Personal Power*

Published: 01 Oct 2024

Episode 20: "Taking Back Your Personal Power." In this compelling episode, Dr. Hensley dives deep into the concept of personal power, highlighting that no one can truly "take" our power; instead, we often surrender it, many times without realizing we're doing so. Dr. Hensley explains that certain relationship dynamics, especially those involving a narcissist or a dismissive avoidant, are more prone to creating a sense of lost power for one partner. Dr. Hensley gives an example used by a fellow influencer, called "The Namless Narcissit" Narcissists, how he explains that narcissiste don't try to control to achieve specific outcomes but rather as a way to prove to themselves that they can. This creates a dictatorial dynamic where the partner being dictated to often feels powerless and trapped. Dr. Hensley shares a vulnerable moment from her own life, discussing a recent experience where she found herself feeling desperate to regain her own sense of power. Admitting to returning to therapy, she explores the ruminating thoughts and the reasons behind her perceived loss of power. She emphasizes the importance of finding a good therapist—one who doesn't reinforce victimhood but instead helps clients understand that surrendering power is ultimately a choice. Therapists should challenge clients to take ownership of their decisions and help them reclaim their autonomy. Dr. Hensley then explores how different attachment styles manifest in relation to personal power. She notes that dismissive avoidants are typically the ones dictating the tone of the relationship and rarely visibly surrender their power. In contrast, anxious attachment styles, such as anxious preoccupied and fearful avoidant who lean anxious, are more likely to give up their personal power, leading to increased anxiety and emotional turmoil. As the episode progresses, Dr. Hensley discusses what a healthy balance of power looks like in relationships. She outlines three key components of balanced power: (1) both partners taking personal accountability for their behaviors, (2) avoiding blame-shifting, and (3) not getting trapped in rumination or self-pity. Furthermore, maintaining a balance of power includes equitable distribution of daily responsibilities and the ability to pick up slack without building resentment. When both partners can approach these behaviors with mutual respect, grace, and humility, the power dynamics within the relationship remain balanced, fostering a healthy and thriving partnership. To wrap up, both Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher share personal anecdotes about reclaiming their power and using failed relationships as opportunities for growth. They emphasize that taking back one's power means being secure in who you are and setting boundaries that limit access to oneself to only those who are willing to reciprocate honor, love, and respect. Ultimately, reclaiming personal power is about stepping into your authentic self and reinforcing your self-worth in every relationship dynamic. What is covered: · The difference in someone taking your personal power and surrendering it. · The most prevelant relationship dynamic where one partner feels a loss of personal power. · The importance of therapy, specifically good therapy, where the therapist does not reinforce victimhood, but instead helps you understand that surrendering personal power is a choice. . How the different attachment styles surrender thier personal power. . What a healthy balance of power looks like in relationships. . Real life examples from both host on how they reclaimed thier personal power after failed relationships. Consider/Ask Yourself · Are you choosing to surrender your personal power? · How are you losing your personal power based on your attachment style? . In what ways are you and your partner balancing power dynamics in your relationship? · Is staying in a state of victimhood stripping you of your personal power? . How can you reclaim your personal power and once and for all become securely attached?

## *Episode 19, Season 1: Nervous System Regulation with Expert Guest Dana Doswell*

Published: 24 Sep 2024

Episode 19: "Nervous System Regulation with expert guest Dana Doswell." In this powerful episode, Dr. Hensley welcomes special guest Dana Doswell, a nervous system expert and mentor. Dr. Hensley begins by sharing how much she's learned from Dana's expertise in nervous system regulation, expressing deep gratitude for the transformative knowledge that has not only enhanced her personal life but also strengthened her professional practice. Dana takes us back to the beginning of her journey, explaining how she first became aware of her own low-level nervous system dysregulation. Like many high-functioning, successful individuals, Dana describes how she went through life ignoring the signals her body was sending her—until a complete nervous system collapse forced her to seek help. She candidly discusses how traditional talk therapy only provided short-term relief, leading her to explore deeper interventions. Her search led her to discover polyvagal theory, which became a turning point in her healing journey. Dana delves into how she realized the disorganization of her nervous system and how somatic work—integrating the body into the healing process—became essential. This discovery ignited her passion for studying evolution, psychology, neuroscience, and somatic healing, which she applied directly to her own life with profound results. Dr. Hensley then shares her parallel journey, explaining how her personal experiences similarly inspired her to dive into spiritual, somatic, and nervous system healing, eventually shaping her work to help others heal. Dana highlights one of the most profound lessons she learned in her studies: the impact of shame on the nervous system. She discusses in detail how shame, particularly within the context of religion and basic bodily functions, deeply affects our bodies and behavior. Dana emphasizes the need to acknowledge our basic physiological needs and accept our "animalistic" nature, a fundamental step in healing an overtaxed nervous system that's often overlooked. She further explores the concept of "functional freeze," a state many high-functioning people find themselves in. Because high performers often attach their self-worth to their productivity and intelligence, they struggle with feelings of failure when they try to rest, triggering nervous system dysregulation. The conversation then turns to the topic of retraumatization and the role that rumination plays in nervous system imbalance. Dana provides practical, step-by-step guidance on how to address rumination from a somatic perspective, offering techniques to locate and resource the feelings in different parts of the body. Dana concludes by sharing that the best way to understand and regulate your nervous system is through relationships—whether that's with a partner, yourself, or even objects in your environment. She explains how every relationship has a "flavor," and that flavor influences how your nervous system responds. Dr. Hensley wraps up the episode by highlighting that the key to nervous system regulation is to deshame your experiences. Both women express their gratitude for the conversation, and Dr. Hensley shares ways for listeners to connect with Dana on social media. This episode is rich in insights on nervous system health, offering valuable tools for both personal and relational healing. You can find Dana Doswell, Nervous System Regulation Expert & Mentor on social media @danadozzyy or see all her services at www.danadozzy.com . What is covered: · Dana's background and how she became an expert and mentor with nervous system regulation. · How her learnings of somatic healing and the polyvagal theory played a big role in her own nervous system healing journey. · The role that shame plays on nervous system deregulation. . How high functioning, successful people sometimes end up in functional freeze and nervous system collapse. . Why and how rumination is such a large component of nervous system deregulation and how to deal with it. . The impact that realtionships with everything around you have on the nervous system. Consider/Ask Yourself · Are you acknowledging and meeting your basic physiological needs like when you have to use the bathroom, or when you are thirsty or hungry? · How are you allowing shame into your life in turn disregulating your nervous system? . Are you experiencing some level of functional freeze? · What flavor are you giving to the relationships to the people and things around you? . How can I seek help and safety to heal my nervous system once and for all?

## *Episode 18, Season 1: How to Handle the Haters*

Published: 17 Sep 2024

Episode 18: "How to Handle the Haters." Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher respond to their first negative podcast review. The criticism accused them of only discussing heterosexual relationships and being overly focused on their Christian faith. Dr. Hensley addresses this by clarifying that attachment theory is a universal framework, unaffected by gender or sexual orientation. Whether in same-sex or opposite-sex relationships, attachment behaviors remain consistent. Though both women have shared their own experiences as heterosexuals, they emphasize their inclusivity of all genders and sexual orientations. Raina also humorously addresses a claim in the review regarding her husband's influence over her reproductive choices, setting the record straight that such decisions are entirely her own. Both hosts laughed at the assumption and used the moment to assert their independence. The episode then tackles the criticism about the role of Christianity in their podcast. Dr. Hensley acknowledges her faith but explains that she provides both spiritual and secular approaches in her coaching, respecting the beliefs of her clients. She asserts that while her faith is part of her identity, it doesn't dictate her coaching unless requested by the client. The conversation then shifts toward how to handle negative comments or "haters" in general. Dr. Hensley ties this to attachment security, highlighting the importance of not internalizing others' judgments. She shares personal stories of dealing with criticism and emphasizes the power of showing up authentically. She explains that secure attachment allows people to accept rejection without it affecting their self-worth, and that curiosity toward others' negative behavior can often reveal their own insecurities and pain. The episode concludes with Dr. Hensley's advice: Don't let the haters dictate your emotional state, and choose joy despite negativity. By embracing secure attachment, listeners can free themselves from being offended by the ignorance and hate of others. What is covered: · The negative review and how it affected both Raina and Dr. Hensley. · Setting the record straight on the comments in the negative review. · How attachment insecurites are not gender specific, nor sexual orientation specific. . How Dr. Hensley approaches her Chritian perspective within her practice. . The importance on achieving your attachment security when dealing with haters and/or offensiveness. Consider/Ask Yourself · How are you allowing others to dictate your joy based on what they may say or think about you? · How often are you allowing people who may differ from you to offend you? . How can you lean into people with more curiosity versus reactivity? · Are you allowing someones narrative of you to ruminate in your own thoughts? . Do I need Dr. Hensley and her resources to achieve my attachment security?

## *Episode 17, Season 1: Post Separation Abuse*

Published: 10 Sep 2024

Episode 17: "Post Separation Abuse." In this deeply personal and raw episode, Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher delve into the harrowing reality of post-separation abuse, particularly when children are involved. They shed light on the abuse that often continues long after separation or divorce, manifesting in ways that are often overlooked or misunderstood by the justice system. Dr. Hensley and Raina draw from their own experiences, providing a candid discussion on how the justice system failed them in the aftermath of their separations from their children's fathers. They recount how the courts, lacking proper professionals equipped to handle the emotional complexities of post-separation dynamics, tend to revictimize families. The episode explores the challenges surrounding child custody, time-sharing, and financial arrangements, revealing how the system frequently falls short of protecting those most vulnerable—especially the children. Challenging common misconceptions, Dr. Hensley debunks the notion that post-separation abuse is solely a male-to-female phenomenon. She highlights cases where women are the abusers post-separation, suggesting that in these instances, they may have been the abusers during the relationship as well. This perspective invites listeners to rethink the narratives often presented in cases of domestic and post-separation abuse. The discussion then turns to reactive abuse, where Dr. Hensley explains how extreme stress and provocation can drive individuals to act violently, often in ways that are completely out of character. This phenomenon, she argues, is a critical aspect of understanding the dynamics of abusive relationships and the fallout that can occur even after separation. The impact of post-separation abuse on children is a central theme in the episode. Dr. Hensley emphasizes the long-term effects on children who are used as pawns in their parents' conflicts, which can lead to significant emotional and psychological problems as they grow up. She explores the psychology of abusers, who often manipulate reality to the point of believing their own lies, perpetuating a cycle of abuse that can have devastating consequences for their children. Dr. Hensley also distinguishes between attachment issues and personality disorders, such as narcissism, explaining how the latter can make co-parenting nearly impossible. She argues that the court system is often ill-equipped to recognize these psychological nuances, leading to decisions that may not be in the best interest of the children. The episode underscores the need for professionals trained in psychology, rather than solely relying on legal experts, to make informed decisions in family court cases. As the episode draws to a close, Dr. Hensley and Raina discuss the deep injustices within the family court system, particularly the ease with which false allegations can be weaponized to alienate and control. Raina shares her own painful experience of being falsely accused, detailing the profound impact it had on her and her young son. In the final segment, Dr. Hensley advocates for systemic change, calling for the inclusion of doctorate-level professionals, skilled in psychological assessment, in family court proceedings. The episode concludes with a powerful message: the ultimate goal must be to protect the children, ensuring that they are not collateral damage in the ongoing battles between their parents. This episode is a must-listen for anyone navigating the complexities of post-separation, offering crucial insights into the emotional and psychological challenges that persist long after the end of a relationship. What is covered: · What is post separation abuse. · How the justice system fails certian people who are dealing with post separation abuse. · Post seperation abuse is not soley a male to female phenomenon. . The difference in abuse and reactive abuse. · The impact of post serparation abuse on children. . Dr. Hensley's opinion on how to change the leagal system to properly advocate for the victims of abuse and post separtation abuse. Consider/Ask Yourself · Are you dealing with post separation abuse? · Are you someone who has used your children as a pawn in the family court system? . How can you start becoming a better co-parent for the sake of your child or children? · Are you seeking the proper resources to deal with your post seperation abuse? . How can Dr. Hensley help you in your post separation abuse journey?

## *Episode 16, Season 1: What it Looks and Feels Like to be Securely Attached*

Published: 03 Sep 2024

Episode 16: "What It Looks and Feels Like to Be Securely Attached." In this insightful episode, Dr. Hensley explores the profound transformation that occurs once you achieve secure attachment. She begins by discussing the inner peace and resilience that come with attachment security, providing listeners with a glimpse into the deep sense of emotional stability that emerges. Drawing from the core components of her hybrid group coaching program, Dr. Hensley offers a clear roadmap to secure attachment. The episode starts with an in-depth discussion on nervous system regulation, highlighting its pivotal role in achieving secure attachment. Dr. Hensley then reveals a powerful, often closely-guarded secret: meta-cognition. She explains how gaining conscious control over your thought patterns enables you to retrain your brain and provide your nervous system with new experiences of love, safety, and connection. Dr. Hensley also covers crucial concepts such as cognitive distortions and catastrophic thinking, noting that many of her clients discover how their thoughts are predominantly negative, creating feelings of insecurity within their relationships. She emphasizes that mastering these skills begins with everyday self-talk. Only by practicing these techniques daily can you successfully apply them in moments of emotional trigger, especially within romantic relationships. A key takeaway from the episode is Dr. Hensley's "The Two Question Test" for challenging your thoughts: "Is this thought true?" and "Is this thought productive?" She encourages listeners to reframe any thought that doesn't pass this test. As the episode progresses, Dr. Hensley dives into the powerful emotions of shame and rejection, explaining how they keep us trapped in a dysregulated state. She reveals that shame is a major barrier to secure attachment, often fueling feelings of unworthiness and blocking emotional growth. In closing, Dr. Hensley outlines practical ways to begin regulating the nervous system and releasing the burden of shame. She explains the scientific basis for achieving attachment security, underscoring its importance not just for mental health, but for overall psychological amd physical well-being. She wraps up the episode by encouraging listeners to build their capacity for secure behaviors, which she explores in greater depth in her course and hybrid group coaching program. What is covered: · What does Secure Attachment feel like. · The two biggest components in secure attachment: nervous system regulation and meta-cognition. · How negative thinking keeps you stuck in attachment insecurities. · The role that shame plays in nervous system disregulation. · In depth tools and ideas around how to regulate your nervous system and start achieving attachment security. Consider/Ask Yourself · What does your inner voice sound like? · Are you able to consciously capture your thoughts? . What are some childhood wounds that are contributing to your attachment insecurities and keeping you stuck from acheiving your attachment security. · Is shame keeping you stuck, and are you shaming yourself for feeling shame? . How can you start the practice of observing and taking authority of your thought world?

## *Episode 15, Season 1: How Poor Self Image is Affecting Your Relationships*

Published: 27 Aug 2024

Episode 15: "How Poor Self Image is Affecting Your Relationships." Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher dive deep into the pressures that modern social norms place on self-image. They discuss how both women and men are harder on themselves than ever before, constantly critiquing their appearance in the age of Botox, fillers, and testosterone injections. In a candid conversation, Dr. Hensley and Raina openly admit that they have both had Botox and lip filler, sharing how their husbands have questioned their motivations for these choices. The episode takes a personal turn as Dr. Hensley and Raina reveal their own struggles with self-image and how it has impacted their self-worth and relationship choices. They explore how a lack of self-esteem led them to choose unhealthy partners and stay in toxic relationships in the past. Dr. Hensley also sheds light on the often overlooked issue of men's body image struggles, sharing her husband's experiences and discussing how men, too, can be victims of abuse—both topics that are rarely acknowledged in society. The conversation then shifts to the root causes of self-image issues, including the influence of upbringing and the way caregivers' views on appearance can shape a child's self-perception. In this heartfelt and vulnerable episode, both hosts reflect on their ongoing battles with shame, negative self-talk, and perfectionism, emphasizing that healing is a journey they are still on. Toward the end, Dr. Hensley and Raina tackle the trending topic of weight loss injections, discussing their own experiences with these interventions and how emerging research suggests they might help release inflammation in those with severe trauma, who often hold onto stress hormones like cortisol. They conclude the episode by stressing the importance of not idolizing beauty and self-image above one's relationship with self, partner, and God, and they encourage listeners to let go of the pursuit of perfectionism. What is covered: · How social norms are affecting your self image. · How both women and men are under tremendous pressures to keep up with social norms. · How poor self worth leads to poor partner choices and staying in toxic, unhelathy relationships. · The root causes of poor self image issues. · How to let go of the pursuit to perfectionism. Consider/Ask Yourself · How are you speaking to yourself? · What does your internal voice sound like? . Are you allowing poor self image to affect the way you treat your partner and children? · Are you idolizing beauty? . Are you placing how you look above relationship to self, relationship to partner, and relationship to God?

## *Episode 14, Season 1: Why We Choose the Partners We Choose*

Published: 20 Aug 2024

Episode 14: "Why We Choose the Partners We Choose," Dr. Hensley delves deep into the psychology behind partner selection, focusing on how attachment styles influence our romantic choices. She begins by explaining how each attachment style—, the fearful avoidant, the anxious pre-occupied, and the dismissive avoidant, —guides us toward certain types of partners, often driven by subconscious wounds formed in childhood. Dr. Hensley provides an in-depth analysis of the dynamics between fearful avoidants and dismissive avoidants, exploring why fearful avoidants are often drawn to partners who exhibit avoidant, narcissistic, or even abusive behaviors. She emphasizes how these dynamics are rooted in unresolved childhood needs, where the subconscious mind seeks to recreate familiar scenarios in an attempt to achieve a "happy ending." One of the key points Dr. Hensley discusses is how attachment insecurities can lead people to confuse anxiety with chemistry, resulting in strong attachments to the wrong individuals. She further examines the dismissive avoidant attachment style, shedding light on why dismissive avoidants choose the partners they do, and the patterns that emerge in these relationships. As the episode progresses, Dr. Hensley shifts focus to what happens when a securely attached person enters your life. She highlights the red flags of attachment insecurities and explains how, once you achieve attachment security, these red flags become more apparent, leading to a natural aversion—or "the ick"—toward unhealthy relationships. In the second half of the episode, Dr. Hensley dives into the characteristics and feelings that arise when the "right" person, or a securely attached partner, shows up in your life. She discusses how recognizing this kind of healthy connection is crucial for building fulfilling and lasting relationships. Dr. Hensley’s passion shines through as she expresses her mission to help as many people as possible find attachment security, ultimately leading them toward more meaningful and loving relationships. What is covered: · Why each attachment style chooses the partner they choose. · What role the subconscious mind plays on partner choice. · An in depth review of the most common attachment insecurity dynamic Dr. Hensley sees in her practice, the FA/DA dynamic. · The confusion between anxiety and chemistry. · What it looks like and feels like to attract someone who is securely attached. . Dr. Hensley's mission on helping as many people as possible find healthy, lasting, and fulfilling relationships. Consider/Ask Yourself · What types of partners am I attracting? · What childhood wounds have contributed to my partner choices and am I trying to rewrite a happy ending to my childhood trauma? · How are my attachment insecurities contributing to my partner choices? . How can I start becoming securely attached so that I can start attracting a secure partner?

## *Episode 13, Season 1: What Happens to the Brain After Relational/Emotional Trauma*

Published: 13 Aug 2024

Episode 13: What Happens to the Brain After Relational and Emotional Trauma. In this insightful episode of "The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show", Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher explore the profound impact that relational and emotional trauma has on the brain, particularly when abuse is involved. Dr. Hensley takes listeners on a deep dive into the neurological science behind trauma, focusing on the roles of the prefrontal cortex, the amygdala, and the hippocampus. Dr. Hensley explains how these critical areas of the brain are affected by trauma, describing in detail how they may grow or shrink in response to sustained emotional stress. This transformation within the brain can lead to significant consequences, such as poor impulse control, heightened anxiety, depression, memory loss, and even addiction. The episode also includes personal reflections from both Dr. Hensley and Raina Butcher, as they share their own experiences with relational trauma. They discuss how some memories remain vivid while others fade, offering a personal perspective on the impact of trauma on memory. The discussion progresses to the effects of retraumatization, where Dr. Hensley uses the analogy of breaking an arm in the same place to illustrate how the brain becomes more susceptible to re-injury if and when it is exposed again to any level of emotional trauma. Even though the impact of retraumatization might not be as severe, it can trigger a resurgence of specific issues or ailments within the body, particularly due to the reactivation of existing neural grooves. As the episode wraps up, Dr. Hensley emphasizes the interconnectedness between brain health and the central nervous system. She underscores the importance of healing the brain to improve overall nervous system function, thereby reducing the risk of disease. The episode concludes on a powerful note, with Dr. Hensley and Raina highlighting the importance of healing for the sake of future generations. They stress that providing children with emotional stability and teaching them about the value of secure attachments is one of the greatest gifts a parent can offer. Tune in for an episode that blends scientific insight with heartfelt personal stories, all aimed at helping listeners understand the profound effects trauma has on the brain and the importance of healing. What is covered: · How each part of the brain is affected by relational/emotional trauma. · How emotional/relational trauma on the brain lead to things like anxiety, depression, poor impulse control, and even addictions. · What happens to the brain and how it reacts when there is a retraumatization. · The effects the brain has on the central nervous system. · How healing the brain and central nervous system can reduce the risk of disease. . The importance of healing relational/emotional trauma for future generations. Consider/Ask Yourself · How has/is my relational/emotional trauma affecting me? · Have I experienced memory loss due to my emotional trauma? · Am I currently focused on the correct work to heal my nervous system and train my brain to know when I am experiencing a true threat to my well-being? . How can I explore further healing for my own well-being and the well-being of my children and future generations?

## *Episode 12, Season 1: Dating in the Modern World*

Published: 06 Aug 2024

Episode 12: Dating in the Modern World. In this insightful episode of "The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show," Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher delve into the complexities of modern dating. Recently married, both hosts reflect on their own experiences from just a few years ago, noting how challenging the dating scene was—and likely even more so today. Dr. Hensley highlights the struggles faced by those with insecure attachment styles, particularly the dismissive-avoidant. She explains how their limited emotional needs can complicate the use of dating apps, often leading to ghosting without explanation. The hosts share personal stories about their own challenges with dating apps and how they eventually met their husbands. Raina Butcher recounts her organic meeting with her husband, prompting Dr. Hensley to offer listeners practical advice on meeting potential partners outside of dating apps. Dr. Hensley provides extensive guidance on approaching someone you're interested in. She offers concrete tips for initiating conversations and gauging mutual interest, as well as advice on enhancing attractiveness on dating apps. Drawing on the science of attraction, she discusses common physical traits that tend to be appealing. Wrapping up the episode, Dr. Hensley emphasizes the importance of earning your attachment security in the dating process. She warns that those with anxious attachment often mistake red flags for chemistry and describes how avoidants may come on strong initially only to pull away later. With both issues contributing to the complexities of the dating world. Both hosts discuss how achieving secure attachment helps in recognizing red flags and avoiding time-wasters, ultimately attracting the right partner. What is covered: · The complexities of the dating world. · Why the dismissive avoidant does what they do in the dating phase of a relationship. · Organic ways that you can meet someone. · Attraction science and what makes someone attracted to you based on physical appearance alone. · Why ghosting is never okay. . The importance of achieving your attachment security in the modern dating world. Consider/Ask Yourself · Are dating apps working for me? · Am I putting myself out into the world in a way that would allow for me to meet someone organically? · Does my dating app profile reflect an appearance that someone would find attractive? . Am I securely dating? Meaning am I showing up as my honest, unapologetic self, while also being honest with others? If not, is it time to work on healing my attachment wounds so that I can attract the right partner?

## *Episode 11, Season 1: Let Them*

Published: 30 Jul 2024

Episode 11: Let Them. In Episode 11 of "The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show," Dr. Hensley explores the concept of "let them" and its profound impact on relationships. She begins by addressing the common question she encounters in her practice: "How do I get my partner to [insert behavior]?" Dr. Hensley emphasizes that trying to change someone else's behavior is futile. Instead, she advises listeners to "let them" show up in their chosen way and then evaluate if that behavior aligns with their needs and desires. If it does, the relationship can flourish. If not, she discusses healthy ways to move on. Dr. Hensley explains that secure individuals do not abandon their own needs or compromise their desires in a romantic relationship. She delves into how different attachment styles struggle with the idea of "letting them." Fearful avoidant and anxious preoccupied individuals often grapple with high anxiety and fear of rejection, making it difficult for them to relinquish control. On the other hand, dismissive avoidants often fail to create an emotionally safe environment for their partners. The episode underscores the importance of achieving attachment security to navigate these complex dynamics. Continuing, Dr. Hensley highlights how modeling secure behavior can positively influence a more insecure partner, sometimes bringing about substantial change. She stresses the significance of setting boundaries and then being comfortable with others' perceptions of you and the relationship you share. By "letting them" hold their own narratives, you can find peace and freedom in living your truth. This of course does not go without your own self reflection to ensure that you are also showing up in a healthy, secure way. Dr. Hensley and co-host Raina Butcher share personal anecdotes about friends and ex-partners they have had to let go, allowing these individuals to maintain their own (sometimes erroneous) narratives. The episode concludes with Dr. Hensley addressing a popular question: "How do I get my ex back?" She breaks down the science of attraction and offers practical steps to assess whether rekindling a past relationship is worthwhile. Dr. Hensley also introduces her upcoming course, "How to Get Your Ex Back," set to release this fall. In the end, both Dr. Hensley and Raina Butcher emphasize the importance of letting go of people and things not meant for you, making room for what truly is. They reflect on how finding their own attachment security and practicing "letting them" ultimately led them to a deep sense of self love and to finding their husnands. What is covered: · The ideas and importance behind the statement "let them." · Addressing how the statement "How do I get my partner to" is the wrong approach when entering coaching. · "Let them" behave how they choose to behave, then take inventory of how this aligns with you own wants and needs. · The difference between how insecure attachment styles struggle with the idea of "let them" versus the securley attached. · Letting go of certian people in your life and the narrative they may have about you and the relationship you shared. . Is the effort on trying to get your ex back warrented and if so steps and advice on how to do so. Consider/Ask Yourself · Are anxiety and a strong need to control things standing in the way of your true healing? · Does it bother you when someone thinks poorly of you when you try to set an appropriate boundary? · Have you stated your needs and wants compassionatley and then let them (your partner) show up, and then taken real inventory? If so, how is your partner showing up for you? . Are you holding onto your relationship simply so you can hold onto the narrative that you feel is the right one? Sometimes it is okay to be the villian in someone else's story as long as it grants you your peace and freedom.

## *Episode 10, Season 1: Are They A Narcissist?*

Published: 23 Jul 2024

Episode 10: Are They a Narcissist? In this enlightening episode of "The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show," Dr. Hensley dives into the complex world of narcissism. Drawing from a rich array of perspectives, including social psychology, evolutionary psychology, developmental psychology, and clinical psychology, Dr. Hensley explores the intricate nature of narcissism and why it's such a widely studied yet frequently misunderstood field. Dr. Hensley begins by examining the various theories that explain how narcissism develops in individuals. She highlights how the term "narcissist" is often overused in contemporary discourse, leading to confusion between narcissistic traits and Narcissistic Personality Disorder (NPD). This distinction is crucial, as NPD can be both over-diagnosed and under-diagnosed. True narcissists possess a remarkable ability to manipulate those around them, including their therapists, making accurate diagnosis challenging. A significant portion of the episode is dedicated to discussing how romantic relationships can exacerbate narcissistic traits. Dr. Hensley explains that the degree of perceived threat within these relationships can amplify existing narcissistic behaviors, complicating the dynamics between partners. One of the highlights of the episode is Dr. Hensley's in-depth analysis of attachment styles and their potential to be misinterpreted as NPD. She clarifies that attachment behaviors, while sometimes similar to narcissistic traits, are rooted in changeable behaviors that primarily manifest in romantic relationships. In contrast, true narcissism permeates all areas of a narcissist's life, including relationships with authority figures. Dr. Hensley also sheds light on the differences between overt and covert narcissists, offering her perspective on which type she considers more dangerous. This segment provides listeners with a nuanced understanding of how narcissistic behaviors can vary widely and the specific risks associated with each type. Throughout the episode, both Dr. Hensley and her co-host, Raina Butcher, share their personal experiences with narcissists, adding a relatable and practical dimension to the discussion. In the final segment, Dr. Hensley addresses the profound impact of narcissism on children, emphasizing how narcissists often use their children to exert control and manipulate, resulting in deep psychological scars. Dr. Hensley and Raina conclude the episode with a message of hope, providing practical advice and resources for those dealing with narcissistic abuse. They emphasize that understanding and addressing narcissism can lead to healthier relationships and personal growth. Join Dr. Hensley and Raina Butcher for this compelling and insightful exploration of narcissism, offering valuable perspectives for anyone navigating relationships with narcissistic individuals. What is covered: · The science behind narcissism. · The theories that explain how narcissism develops. · The threat that narcisstic traits play in our romatic relationships. · The difference between behaviors of specific attachment styles and the narcissist. · The difference between the overt and covert narcissist. Consider/Ask Yourself · What are the differences between Narcissitic Personality Disorder and narcissitic traits? · Is your partner a true narcissist or do they just have attachement wounding and insecurities? · If dealing with a narcissitic partner how can I seek intervention for myself and my children?

### *Episode 9, Season 1: Settling the Confusion Between the Fearful Avoidant and the Dismissive Avoidant*

Published: 16 Jul 2024

Episode 9 (announced as Episode 8 in audio): "Settling the Confusion between the Fearful Avoidant and the Dismissive Avoidant." In this enlightening episode Dr. Hensley delves deep into the often misunderstood world of attachment styles, focusing specifically on the Fearful Avoidant (FA) and the Dismissive Avoidant (DA). While their names suggest similarity, Dr. Hensley reveals the significant differences in the behaviors and motivations underlying these two styles. Dr. Hensley meticulously describes how the Fearful Avoidant (FA) exhibits both anxious and avoidant behaviors due to a complex mix of fear and anxiety, often oscillating between seeking closeness and sometimes pushing away when they feel betrayed. This oscillation can be heavily influenced by various factors, including the attachment style of their partner. In contrast, the Dismissive Avoidant (DA) maintains distance primarily as a means of preserving independence and autonomy, showing little interest in emotional closeness. Through vivid examples and detailed explanations, Dr. Hensley highlights the typical dynamics seen in FA/DA partnerships. These relationships are often marked by one partner's pursuit of intimacy and connection, which can manifest as anxious behaviors or even aggression, while the other partner retreats further into avoidance. This push-pull dynamic creates a cycle of misunderstanding and frustration, leaving partners feeling perpetually out of sync. Drawing from her extensive experience in relationship coaching, Dr. Hensley shares how she navigates these complex dynamics in her hybrid group coaching program. She provides actionable tools and strategies to help couples achieve a balance that honors both the DA's need for autonomy and the FA's desire for intimacy. Through structured guidance and support, she helps partners break the vicious cycle and cultivate a harmonious and fulfilling relationship. Join Dr. Hensley in this episode as she unpacks the intricacies of these attachment styles and offers practical solutions for creating lasting change and deeper connection in romantic partnerships.

### *Episode 8, Season 1: Be Kind but Take No Sh!t*

Published: 09 Jul 2024

Episode 8: Be Kind but Take No Shit. In this compelling continuation of our two-part series, we dive deeper into the critical topic of how to cope when someone wrongfully hurts you. While the previous episode centered on the Faith perspective—emphasizing forgiveness, kindness, and holding strong to scripture as a way to stay out of the spirit of revenge and bitterness—this episode shifts focus to the essential practice of setting hard boundaries when someone wronfully hurts you. Join Dr. Hensley as she explores the art of being kind while taking no shit. She delves into the importance of establishing boundaries, recognizing when it’s time to set them, and understanding what these boundaries look like. Drawing on both psychological insights and biblical teachings, Dr. Hensley illustrates how even Jesus advocated for lovingly setting boundaries. With raw honesty, Dr. Hensley shares her personal journey of dealing with a recent painful experience. She explains how she enforced consequences for the wrongful actions of others toward her and her family, embodying the principle of being kind but firm. As the episode continues, Dr. Hensley touches on why setting boundaries can be particularly challenging for those with attachment insecurities and how fear can hinder a persons ability to set, and stick to a boundary, sometimes resulting in them being unable to protect themselves from being hurt over and over. She explores why boundary setting is so important for both the person setting the boundary and the person that the boundary is set against. She gives concrete, real life examples of what a boundary looks like, and even what to say in particular situations within romatic relationships. Prepare to be empowered by this authentic episode, which will inspire you to establish your own personal boundaries, enabling you to live a life where you remain kind but uncompromising. What is covered: · What it looks like to stay kind, while also taking no shit. · Ways in which Jesus and scripture spoke about setting firm boundaries. · When is the right time to set a boundary and what does a firm boundary look and sound like. · Why setting boundaries for specific attachment styles is so difficult. · Why boundary setting is so important in all of your relationships. Consider/Ask Yourself: · Are you able to set the correct boundaries with the people in your life? · Are you being your partners doormat and in turn enabling your partner's behavior by not setting firm boundaries? · Are you setting boundaries out of bitterness, rebellion, or as a way to seek revenge against someone who hurt you? · How committed are you to your boundaries? Are you setting them and staying stedfast in your follow through, regardless of the natural consequences?

### *Episode 7, Season 1: How to Cope When Someone Wrongfully Hurts You*

Published: 02 Jul 2024

Episode 7: How to Cope When Someone Wrongfully Hurts You (Part 1) In this heartfelt episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, Dr. Hensley dives deep into the faith perspective on coping when wrongfully hurt by someone. Drawing from a current, profoundly painful personal experience affecting her family, Dr. Hensley shares candid real-life examples of how she navigates the challenging emotions of hate, fear, and the desire for revenge. She emphasizes the importance of transcending these feelings by embracing the spirit of God. Dr. Hensley delves into specific Bible verses that have provided her solace and guidance during times of heartache and loss of control. She also integrates a psychological perspective, offering practical tools to manage your thoughts and regulate your nervous system during distressing situations. This episode is a must-listen for anyone seeking to deepen their faith and find spiritual strategies to cope with pain. Dr. Hensley's insights help listeners move from the flesh to the spirit of the Lord, fostering inner peace and resilience. What is covered: · The right ways to cope when someone hurts you. · How to escape your flesh and move into the spirt and word of God to heal. · Psychological perspecitves of how to cope when someone hurts you. · How the different attachment styles deal with the pain of when someone wrongfully hurts them. · How to overcome feelings of hate, fear, and wanting to seek revenge. Consider/Ask Yourself: · How are my thoughts contributing to feelings of hate and fear when someone wrongfully hurts me? · Am I seeking the word of God in my healing journey? · Have I had ruminating thoughts around seeking revenge against the person who hurt me? · How is my attachment style contributing to me staying in my flesh instead of seeking the word of God?

### *Episode 6, Season 1: Understanding How You Want to be Loved Through Your Attachment Style*

Published: 25 Jun 2024

Episode 6: Understanding How You want to be Loved Through Your Attachment Style. In this insightful episode of "How Do You Want to Be Loved," we delve into the profound ways people seek and experience love based on their attachment styles. Drawing from our personal journeys in marriage and past relationships, we reflect on how each relationship has been a stepping stone in understanding our own needs and desires, ultimately leading us to our wonderful husbands. Dr. Hensley, expands the conversation by emphasizing that truly loving your partner goes beyond the five love languages. She explains that these languages are just the beginning, a surface-level understanding. To genuinely connect, one must delve deeper. For example, a Fearful Avoidant might cherish gifts, but not just any gift—they desire something unique that mirrors their individuality, showing that you truly see and understand them. Dr. Hensley highlights the importance of studying your partner, gathering insights, and learning to avoid their triggers. This attentive approach, focused on meeting your partner's specific needs, is essential for a thriving relationship. She underscores the necessity of earning attachment security, which involves a radical self-discovery journey and a mindset shift from "how do I get them to" to "what is it about me that accepts this circumstance." Further, Dr. Hensley discusses the power of "speaking life" into your relationship. This means actively communicating with your partner about how they wish to be loved, what feels good to them, and how you can love them better. Co-host Raina Butcher wraps up the episode by affirming Dr. Hensley's insights and sharing the tangible results her clients have achieved through her guidance. Dr. Hensley's expertise in teaching people how to love one another authentically is not just theoretical; it's transformative. Join us for this episode to explore how understanding and nurturing attachment styles can lead to deeper, more meaningful connections in your relationships. What is covered: · How each attachment style prefers to be loved. · Why Attachment Style is the number one predictor of people's love needs. · How the five love languages are only the surface of understanding how someone wants to be loved. · The deeper meaning behind all the love languages. · How to avoid your partners triggers so that they feel more loved. · How to gather data and take inventory on your partner so you can discover on a deeper level how they prefer to be loved. Consider/Ask Yourself: · How is that you prefer to be loved? · Is your partner willing to understand how it is that you prefer to be loved? . What is the deeper meaning of your love language? · Are you actively working on avoiding your partners triggers as a way to show them that you see and understand them. · Are you speaking up to what your needs are, so that your partner is aware of how you want to be loved? · How important is it to me that I achieve my attachment security so that both mine and my partners love needs are met?

## *Episode 5, Season 1: Living in Victimhood*

Published: 18 Jun 2024

Episode 5: Living in Victimhood Episode 5 “Living in Victimhood," is where we delve into this profound and often painful topic. Join Dr. Hensley as she draws from both her extensive coaching experience and her deeply personal journey to explore why some people get stuck in a state of victimization while others rise above it to experience post-traumatic growth. In this emotional and revealing episode, Dr. Hensley opens up about her own struggles with victimhood. She shares intimate stories of her past, candidly discussing how she played a role in her own victimization and the steps she took to break free from it. Her vulnerability offers listeners a rare glimpse into the person behind "Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services," showcasing her resilience and determination to transform her pain into a powerful tool for helping others. Dr. Hensley also dives into the psychology behind victimhood, explaining the pathologies that keep individuals trapped in a cycle of suffering. She explores the factors that lead some people to experience post-traumatic stress, while others find a way to grow and thrive after trauma. Through real-life examples from her coaching practice, Dr. Hensley illustrates common patterns of victimhood and provides actionable strategies to overcome them. This episode is not just about understanding victimhood; it's about empowering listeners to recognize and break free from their own cycles of self-victimization. Dr. Hensley's personal triumph story serves as a beacon of hope, demonstrating that it is possible to heal, grow, and transform even the deepest relational traumas into a source of strength and purpose. Tune in to Episode 5 of "The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show" for a heartfelt, insightful, and inspiring conversation that will challenge you to look within, confront your own victimhood, and embark on a journey towards healing and empowerment. Don't miss this opportunity to connect with Dr. Hensley on a deeper level and gain valuable insights that can help you or someone you love break free from the chains of victimhood. What is covered: · Victimhood and why some people get stuck in it. · Why some people experience post traumatic growth versus post-traumatic stress after a traumatic event. · How victimhood is an antidote for our pain. · The difference between being a victim and a volunteer. · How the different attachment styles live in victimization. · How to overcome victimhood within your own relationship. Consider/Ask Yourself: · How have a contributed to my own victimhood? · Am I looking within to understand and evaluate my own choices to stay in a perpetual state of traumatization? · Have I been using victimization as an antidote to my pain? · Am I shaming myself into healing? (Shame and healing do not mix) · How is my attachment style contributing to me staying in a place of victimization?

## *Episode 4, Season 1: Why Women Won't have Sex with their Husbands/Partners*

Published: 11 Jun 2024

In this enlightening episode Dr. Hensley delves into a controversial topic that many couples struggle with: the decline in sexual intimacy over time. She begins by exploring why attraction and sex come so easily during the dating phase of a relationship, but often wane as the relationship matures. Dr. Hensley highlights a significant gender difference in sexual experiences, focusing on the primary reason many women lose interest in sex with their husbands. She explains that unmet attachment needs lead women to feel emotionally unsafe, which in turn affects their desire for sexual intimacy. To fully understand this episode, listeners are introduced to key concepts of attachment. Dr. Hensley details how different attachment style dynamics, such as Fearful Avoidant/Dismissive Avoidant and Fearful Avoidant/Fearful Avoidant, impact sexual intimacy when it comes to their individual needs. She also discusses why both men and women seek sex for validation, albeit for different reasons. The episode covers several critical points: - The challenges women face in experiencing pleasure during sex. - The roles of feminine and masculine energy in sexual intimacy. - The characteristics of the wounded masculine energy versus true masculine energy, emphasizing the importance of a man being a trusted decision-maker, who deeply understands and sees his wife. Dr. Hensley provides a broad perspective on what a happy marriage with a healthy sex life looks like and concludes by offering specific insights into what each female attachment style needs for sexual intimacy and emotional safety. While acknowledging the controversial nature of this topic, Dr. Hensley aims to help couples achieve true sexual intimacy, leading to a beautiful and healthy sex life. Tune in for an episode filled with valuable insights and practical advice for rekindling the spark in your long-term relationship. What is covered: · The gender difference with sexual needs. · One of the main reasons why wives won’t have sex with their husbands. · The different attachment style pairings when it comes to sexual intimacy needs. · How feminine and masculine energy play a role in sexual intimacy. · What the wounded masculine looks like versus the true masculine. · What each female attachment style needs to experience sexual pleasure and emotional safety. Consider/Ask Yourself: · Am I contributing to my partners emotional safety to keep our spark alive? · Have I ever used sex as a band aid to avoid bigger problems in our relationship? · What does it mean for my wife to experience true sexual pleasure? Hint: it is more than just a physical need. · For husbands: am I being the emotional leader in my household? · For wives: am I allowing my husband to take on a leadership role or am I criticizing him too much? · What are my partners attachment needs and am I contributing to meeting them?

## *Episode 3, Season 1: How Does this Hurt You?*

Published: 04 Jun 2024

In a profound exploration of relationship dynamics, *Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services* podcast presents Episode 3: "How Does This Hurt You?" Dr. Hensley embarks on a transformative journey into the heart of conflict resolution, revealing how a single question can hold the key to unlocking deeper understanding and connection in romantic partnerships. The episode opens with Dr. Hensley's poignant reflection on the transformative power of asking the question, "How does this hurt you?" Drawing from her own personal experiences, she shares a compelling real-life example of how this simple yet profound question allowed her to dismantle her own trigger cycle with her husband, leading to breakthroughs in communication and emotional intimacy. Listeners are invited to explore how this question serves as a catalyst for empathy, compassion, and curiosity within relationships, offering partners the opportunity to truly see and hear each other's perspectives. Through vivid storytelling and insightful analysis, Dr. Hensley illuminates how embracing vulnerability and openness can pave the way for resolved conflict resolution and deeper emotional connection. Delving deeper into the complexities of relationship dynamics, Dr. Hensley unpacks why so many couples find themselves trapped in never-ending conflict cycles. She shines a light on the destructive nature of defensiveness and the tendency to perceive one's own reality as the only truth, ultimately leading to stagnation and disconnection in relationships. As the episode unfolds, Dr. Hensley offers practical strategies and tools for breaking free from the cycle of conflict and forging a path towards lasting resolution and harmony with your partner. From fostering active listening skills to cultivating a mindset of empathy and understanding, listeners are empowered to navigate conflict with grace and compassion. By the episode's conclusion, listeners are equipped with a newfound understanding of the transformative power of vulnerability, empathy, and open communication in romantic partnerships. Through Dr. Hensley's expert guidance and heartfelt wisdom, *Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services* podcast Episode 3 serves as a beacon of hope for couples seeking to heal, grow, and thrive in their relationships. What is covered: Dr. Hensley’s real life experience on how she used this question with her husband. How this question translates into showing empathy towards your partner in the mist of conflict. How this creates space to show love and compassion towards your partner versus defensiveness. How this question creates space for introspection and growth with you and your partner. Letting go of offensiveness. How conflict should create more closeness and trust in your relationship. Why so many couples get stuck in the never ending conflict cycle. Consider/Ask Yourself: What is your level of offensiveness/defensiveness within conflict? Are you considering how the things you say may hurt your partner? Are you willing to apologize within conflict? Be the change you want to see in your relationship. Why does being right within conflict matter so much to you? Reality is subjective. How can I be non-defensive enough to ask my partner the question of “how does this hurt you”? Am I allowing my thoughts to ruminate and make me more defensive with my partner?

### *Episode 2, Season 1: Unveiling the Subconscious Mind*

Published: 28 May 2024

In the captivating second episode of *Dr. Sarah Hensley Relationship Coaching Services* podcast, listeners are taken on an enlightening journey into the depths of the subconscious mind. Dr. Hensley, a specialized social psychologist and host of the show, delves into the intricate workings of this elusive part of the brain, unraveling its mysteries and shedding light on its profound influence on our relationships and emotional well-being. The episode begins with a comprehensive exploration of what exactly the subconscious mind is, backed by solid scientific research and insights. Dr. Hensley breaks down complex concepts into digestible chunks, offering listeners a clear understanding of the subconscious and its role in shaping our thoughts, feelings, and behaviors. Drawing from years of coaching experience and psychological expertise, Dr. Hensley highlights the profound impact that our early caregivers and childhood wounds have on the development of the subconscious mind. Listeners are invited to reflect on their own upbringing and how it might have influenced their subconscious patterns and beliefs. As the episode progresses, Dr. Hensley unveils the fascinating ways in which the subconscious mind comes to the forefront during times of conflict, illuminating why it can be so challenging to access and understand. Through compelling examples and real-life anecdotes, listeners gain valuable insights into their own subconscious processes and how they manifest in their relationships. One of the most compelling aspects of the episode is Dr. Hensley's exploration of how the subconscious mind operates with each attachment style, but perhaps the most anticipated moment of the episode comes when Dr. Hensley shares powerful strategies for hacking the subconscious mind, empowering listeners to become more securely attached individuals in their relationships. What is covered: What is the subconscious mind and the science behind it. Why the subconscious mind controls nearly 90% of human behavior. How our childhood wounds imprint the subconscious mind. The impact our caregivers have on the subconscious mind. The different sections/types of the brain. How the subconscious mind operates with each attachment style. Understanding how to hack the subconscious mind. Consider/ Ask yourself How am I responding in conflict? What are some childhood wounds that are influencing my subconscious mind? Are there things I need to forgive my parents for? Is my attachment style influencing how I behave during conflict? How can I start dismantling my own trigger cycle in order to be a better partner and parent?

### *Episode 1, Season 1: Should I Stay or Should I Go?*

Published: 21 May 2024

In the debut Episode of The Dr. Sarah Hensley Show, "Should I Stay, or Should I Go" Dr. Hensley and Raina Butcher explore the timeless dilemma of whether to remain in a relationship or to part ways. Drawing from her expertise in attachment theory and relationship dynamics, Dr. Hensley examines the various factors that contribute to relationship satisfaction and longevity. Listeners will learn to recognize signs of a healthy relationship, understand red flags indicating it may be time to move on, and gain valuable insights into the decision-making process when it comes to matters of the heart. Listeners can expect engaging discussions, expert insights, and actionable advice that will empower them to make informed decisions about their relationships and personal growth. What is covered: The trauma bond and how the brain operates within a trauma bond The cycle of intermittent reinforcement Toxic hope The different psychological pathologies that create toxic environments The psychological science behind infidelity Why each attachment style cheats Consider/Ask Yourself: Dr. Hensley’s two non-negotiables……. Is there emotional, physical, sexual or financial abuse happening in the relationship? Has there been repeated infidelity? What does emotional and financial abuse look like? What have you and your partner already tried? How committed is your partner to the process of improving your relationship?